



Localization Study on Nepal's Disaster Risk Management Governance



Nepal Government
Ministry of Home Affairs
National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority
Singhadurbar, Kathmandu

Localization Study on Nepal's Disaster Risk Management Governance 2024



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FOREWORD

On the behalf of the study team, as the Lead Advisor for the Localization study on Nepal's Disaster Risk Management Governance Study, it is my honor to present this comprehensive study of Disaster Risk Reduction and Management (DRRM) Governance. In a country prone to various natural hazards, understanding the significance of local-level involvement in disaster preparedness and response is paramount.

This study represents a collaborative effort between the National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA) and the National Housing and Settlements Resilience Platform (NHSRP), underscoring the importance of partnerships in addressing complex challenges. Through a mixed-method approach encompassing desk reviews, interviews, focus group discussions, and surveys, we have sought to discuss deeply into the barriers, opportunities, and dynamics of DRRM localization.

Nepal's transition to a federal system of governance has reshaped the landscape of disaster management, necessitating a clear delineation of roles and responsibilities among federal, provincial, and local governments. While this decentralization holds promise for effective and contextually relevant responses, it also presents challenges, particularly in terms of capacity building and resource allocation at the local level.

The findings and recommendations presented in this study aim to inform policy, planning, and action towards enhancing disaster resilience at all levels of governance. From clarifying roles and responsibilities to empowering vulnerable communities and streamlining resource mobilization, each recommendation is crafted with the intention of catalyzing tangible change on the ground.

As we navigate the complexities of disaster risk management in Nepal, let us remain guided by the principles of inclusivity, collaboration, and resilience. May this study serve as a roadmap towards a safer, more resilient future for all Nepali citizens.

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I would like to extend my heartfelt appreciation to the dedicated team behind the Localization study on Nepal's Disaster Risk Governance. This report stands as a testament to their unwavering commitment, rigorous research, and tireless efforts to advance disaster risk reduction and management (DRRM) in Nepal.

I am deeply grateful to each member of the research team for their dedication, expertise, and passion in conducting this study. Their meticulous analysis, insightful recommendations, and comprehensive assessment provide invaluable insights that will undoubtedly inform and shape our ongoing efforts to enhance disaster resilience at all levels of governance.

I would also like to acknowledge the collaboration and support of our partners, including the National Housing and Settlements Resilience Platform (NHSRP) and Catholic Relief Services, CRS Nepal whose expertise and collaboration have been instrumental in the success of this study.

Furthermore, I extend my sincere appreciation to all stakeholders who participated in this study, including government officials, local authorities, community leaders, and representatives from civil society organizations. Your valuable input and perspectives have enriched our understanding of the challenges and opportunities in DRRM localization in Nepal.

Last but not the least, I would like to express my gratitude to the international community, donors, and development partners for their continued support and commitment to building resilience in Nepal.

Together, we remain steadfast in our resolve to create a safer, more resilient future for all Nepali citizens. This report serves as a guiding light in our collective efforts to strengthen disaster resilience and mitigate the impacts of disasters in Nepal.

With deepest appreciation,
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Executive Summary

Local governments and communities play a crucial role in identifying and responding to hazards and disasters, making disaster risk reduction and management (DRRM) a fundamental part of their responsibilities. To achieve long-term disaster-resilient development, it is imperative to "localize" preparedness by placing local governments at the forefront of DRRM efforts. They are best positioned to execute local plans that can reduce casualties, limit property damage, and facilitate swift and effective recovery. The COVID-19 pandemic highlighted the urgency of localization, as mobility restrictions necessitated local responses. Target E of the Sendai Framework of Action (2018-2030) underscores the significance of local-level involvement in DRRM, aiming to bolster national DRRM efforts by 2030 through international cooperation and support.

The 2030 Agenda on Sustainable Development emphasizes the need for local actors and actions to address various challenges at the local level, aligning with the slogan "think globally, act locally." The New Urban Agenda, adopted by UN Habitat in 2016, underscores the vital role of local governments in disaster risk reduction, crisis mitigation, sustainable development, climate action, and the creation of a resilient and inclusive future. In Nepal, the federal system of government established in 2015 delineates responsibilities among the Federal Government, Provincial Government, and Local Government, with disaster management being a shared responsibility. In this backdrop, the Localization Study on Nepal's Disaster Risk Management Governance, conducted by the National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA) in collaboration with the National Housing and Settlements Resilience Platform (NHSRP), seeks to identify barriers and opportunities for enhancing local government capacity in reconstruction, recovery, and disaster risk management. This study aligns with Nepal's National Disaster and Climate Resilience Framework (NDCRF) and Disaster Risk Reduction Management Strategic Plan of Action 2030, aiming to guide NDRRMA's localization strategy to better address the nation's disaster resilience needs.

The Localization Study on Nepal's Disaster Risk Management Governance has brought to light significant challenges, complexities, and opportunities related to Disaster Risk Reduction and Management (DRRM), in Nepal. The study underscores the growing recognition of the importance of localization as mandated by Nepal's constitution and the DRRM Act of 2017. It reflects the consensus among respondents that localization is essential for effective DRRM implementation within the new federal structure. However, it also highlights the limitations faced by provincial and local governments in terms of technical knowledge and resources, lack of complete authority, and calls for capacity building from the national level. This study aims to assess and enhance the institutional capacity of local governments in disaster risk management, with a specific focus on housing reconstruction and recovery, aligning with Nepal's evolving political landscape and transition to a federal governance system. Additionally, the study addresses various stakeholder interests, such as capturing localization insights for earthquake and multi-hazard preparedness, examining relationships and resource-sharing dynamics among national, provincial, district, and local governments, and identifying collaborative approaches to strengthen local disaster risk management capacity. The findings of this study will contribute to the Government of Nepal's strategic planning and budgeting but

also guide donor funding decisions and support strategies for disaster risk management and recovery in Nepal, serving as a roadmap for disaster management funding within the country's evolving policy landscape.

This study aims to provide valuable insights and evidence-based recommendations to support the implementation of Nepal's localization agenda, as outlined in the draft National Disaster and Climate Resilience Framework (NDCRF). Through a mixed-method approach encompassing both qualitative and quantitative research methods, including desk reviews, key informant interviews, focus group discussions, and surveys, the study examines various aspects of localization. It explores network analysis, capacity assessments, and stakeholder perceptions to uncover the current state of disaster risk management at different levels of governance. The study aligns with NDRRMA's goals to contribute to the NDRF, strengthen its Strategic Plan of Action, and improve annual planning and budgeting. It also provides valuable input for donor funding priorities and supports the development of a roadmap for disaster management funding in Nepal, emphasizing the importance of local capacity in disaster resilience efforts.

While the NDRRMA collaborates effectively with national-level actors, District Administration Offices (DAOs) and municipalities are actively involved at the local level. However, the capacity of local governments is hindered by limitations in human resources, technical expertise, budgeting, and policy formulation for post-disaster reconstruction and DRRM integration.

The report also points out barriers such as unclear roles and responsibilities, insufficient coordination, inadequate budget allocation for reconstruction, and limited fund mobilization for recovery. To address these issues, the study recommends a clear delineation of responsibilities among the different levels of government, strengthening the capacity of local governments, and the development of integrated national guidelines for reconstruction. It emphasizes the need for technical and financial support to local governments from both NDRRMA and international organizations, as well as a focus on building resilient structures during reconstruction efforts. Additionally, recommendations for NDRRMA include organizational restructuring, localized resource allocation, multi-ministerial resource mobilization strategies, and the development of standardized operating procedures and risk assessments.

To achieve this, a clear delineation of roles and responsibilities among the three levels of government (federal, provincial, and local) is essential, aligning with constitutional and legal frameworks. Specific disaster scale-specific responsibilities should be defined to ensure effective coordination during various disaster scenarios, with a shift towards proactive risk reduction rather than primarily responding to disasters. Comprehensive and integrated national guidelines for reconstruction and recovery, multi-hazard standard operating procedures, and climate mainstreaming policies should be developed. Coordination and collaboration should be improved through the restructuring of the National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA), empowering local governments, and streamlining resource mobilization. Vulnerable and marginalized populations must be prioritized, with incentives for resilient housing, accessibility features for people with disabilities, and pre-identification of vulnerable individuals. Lastly, a robust monitoring and evaluation system

should be established to track the effectiveness of disaster resilience localization efforts, ensuring continuous improvement and adaptation to evolving challenges. These recommendations aim to enhance Nepal's disaster resilience and preparedness, fostering a proactive and collaborative approach to disaster risk reduction and management.

Key actions include restructuring the organogram of the National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA) to align with strategic areas defined in the National Strategic Plan of Action (NSPOA) and establishing integrated reporting systems to track DRRM efforts nationwide.

Furthermore, prioritizing vulnerable and marginalized populations is highlighted as a critical imperative, with proposed measures such as the implementation of disaster-responsive social security guidelines and the allocation of resources to support the most vulnerable individuals. Empowering local governments for local leadership in DRRM is also emphasized, with recommendations to support municipalities in developing their own Disaster and Climate Resilience Frameworks and implementing DRRM by-laws tailored to their unique risks and vulnerabilities.

In the domain of Disaster Relief and Recovery, recommendations revolve around delineating clear roles among governmental bodies at all levels and prioritizing the needs of vulnerable populations in recovery efforts. Streamlining resources management and tracking systems is identified as crucial for efficient response and recovery, with proposed measures including the establishment of dedicated units for disaster funding management and the simplification of fund mobilization processes.

These recommendations serve as a roadmap for the Government of Nepal and its partners, providing actionable steps to strengthen disaster resilience and ensure effective preparedness, response, and recovery efforts across the country.

Implementing these recommendations will significantly enhance Nepal's capacity to respond to and recover from disasters effectively. By aligning efforts with the NSPOA and NDRF objectives, stakeholders can collaborate more effectively to strengthen disaster resilience. These recommendations serve as a roadmap for government entities, development partners, and local communities to work together towards a more resilient Nepal.

Acronyms

ADB	Asian Development Bank
AHA Center	ASEAN Coordinating Centre for Humanitarian Assistance on Disaster Management
APF	Armed Police Force
ASEAN	Association of Southeast Asian Nations
BBB	Build Back Better
BS	Bikram Sambat
CRS	Catholic Relief Services
DCC	District Coordination Committee
DDMC	District Disaster Management Committee
DLPIU	District level project implementation unit
DM Fund	Disaster Management Fund
DRM	Disaster Risk Management
DRR	Disaster Risk Reduction
DRRM	Disaster Risk Reduction and Management
EC	Executive Committee
FCDO	Foreign, Commonwealth & Development Office
FG	Federal Government
FGD	Focus Group Discussion
GLOF	Glacial Lake Outburst Flood
GMALI	Grant Management and Local Infrastructure
GoN	Government of Nepal
ICS	Incident Command System
IFRC	International Federation of Red Cross and Red Crescent Movement
INGO	International Non-Governmental Organization
KII	Key Informant Interview
LDCRP	Local Disaster and Climate Resilience Plan
LDMC	Local Disaster Management Committee

LED	Local Economic Development
LEOC	Local Emergency Operation Center
LG	Local Government
MOFAGA	Ministry of Federal Affairs and General Administration
MOHA	Ministry of Home Affairs
MoU	Memorandum of Understanding
MUAN	Municipal Association of Nepal
NARMIN	National Association of Rural Municipalities In Nepal
NDRF	National Disaster Resilience Framework
NDRR	Nepal Disaster Risk Reduction
NDRRMA	National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority
NGO	Non-Governmental Organization
NHSRP	National Housing and Settlements Resilience Platform
NPC	National Planning Commission
NRA	National Reconstruction Authority
OCHA	Office for the coordination of Humanitarian Affairs
OPMCM	Office of the Prime Minister and Cabinet of Ministers
PDNA	Post Disaster Needs Assessment
PG	Provincial Government
PM Relief Fund	Prime Minister Relief Fund
RHRP	Rural Housing Reconstruction Program
RQ	Research Question
SFDRR	Sendai Framework on Disaster Risk Reduction
UM	Urban Municipality
UN	United Nations
UNDP	United Nations Development Program
USAID	U.S. Agency for International Development
VDC	Village Development Committee

1. Introduction

1.1 Overview

The Nepal National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA), with technical support from National Housing and Settlements Resilience Platform (NHSRP) has undertaken a study entitled **Localization Study on Nepal's Disaster Risk Management Governance** to explore the barriers and opportunities for effective local-led reconstruction and recovery efforts and disaster risk management in Nepal. At the request of NDRRMA, the Study's overarching goal is to provide findings and recommendations that will guide NDRRMA's localization strategy aligned with the National Disaster Resilience Framework and Disaster Risk Reduction Management Strategic Plan of Action 2030.

The Study is situated within the contexts of the National Disaster Risk Reduction (NDRR) Strategic Plan of Action 2018-2030, the formal handover of the NRA's responsibilities to the Department of Urban Development and Building Construction and NDRRMA in December 2021, and the emergent Nepal National Disaster Resilience Framework (NDRF). In the context of restructuring Nepal's political landscape, and with remaining gaps specific to localization of reconstruction, the study reflects localization findings for earthquake and multi-hazard preparedness, response, recovery, and reconstruction in Nepal.

The Study Objectives are to:

- Identify opportunities and existing constraints to improve localization of disaster risk reduction and management (DRRM) and disaster relief and recovery (DR&R) processes; and
- Provide recommendations to the Government of Nepal and Partners for practical approaches to strengthen local capacity in DRRM and DR&R process, that will contribute to multi-stakeholder planning and funding prioritization for localization.

The Study explores and sheds light on both barriers to, and factors contributing towards, effective localization. The Study's findings and stakeholder-wise recommendations are envisioned to help shape and prioritize NHSRP and Partners' support strategies vis-a-vis NDRRMA within Nepal's localization agenda aligned with existing and emerging Policies and Guidelines of the Government of Nepal (GoN) and contribute to the development of a roadmap for disaster management funding in the country.

1.2 Background: Why a Study on Localization in Nepal?

Nepal is exposed to seismic and hydro meteorological hazards due to its geo-climatic system (Bank, 2020) coupled with the country's steep terrain, heavy monsoon, and social economic conditions of the people. Climate change has exacerbated this vulnerability in recent years. The Government of Nepal's national disaster information management system Bipad Portal (bipadportal.gov.np) shows 1,511 flooding and 2,560 landslide events having occurred during the last ten years. The catastrophic 2015 earthquake resulted in damaging USD 7 billion worth of infrastructure, causing the loss of 8,790 lives, and leaving 22,300 people injured. (NRA, 2021). National Reconstruction Authority (NRA) concluded the reconstruction of nearly

760,000 private houses (92%), nearly 7000 school buildings (88%), nearly 800 health buildings (65%), nearly 400 government buildings (94%) and nearly 600 heritage monuments (64%). The milestone reconstruction program of NRA has left its legacy of five approaches from its key learnings of earthquake reconstruction. It includes i) Utilization of technology for rapidly understanding reconstruction needs; ii) Building back better through owner-driven approach; iii) Providing targeted socio-technical assistance for the most vulnerable; iv) Investing in structural integrity assessments for public infrastructure; and v) Moving towards resilience.

Localization as a Priority

Nepal has adopted an inclusive and bottom-up approach to disaster risk reduction, preparedness, and reconstruction through policy, structures, and capacity- building measures. The Constitution of Nepal, 2015 has mandated municipal governments with sole authority over the DRRM as well as shared roles and responsibilities between federal, provincial, and municipal level. Local Government Operation Act, 2017 and National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Act, 2017 are the main national DRRM legal basis for placing the municipal government in the driving seat of national DRRM architecture. However, there is no clear delineation of roles, responsibilities between the three tiers of government. (Bhandari, S, Hayes, Regmi, & Marker, 2020).

Existing Governance System of Nepal

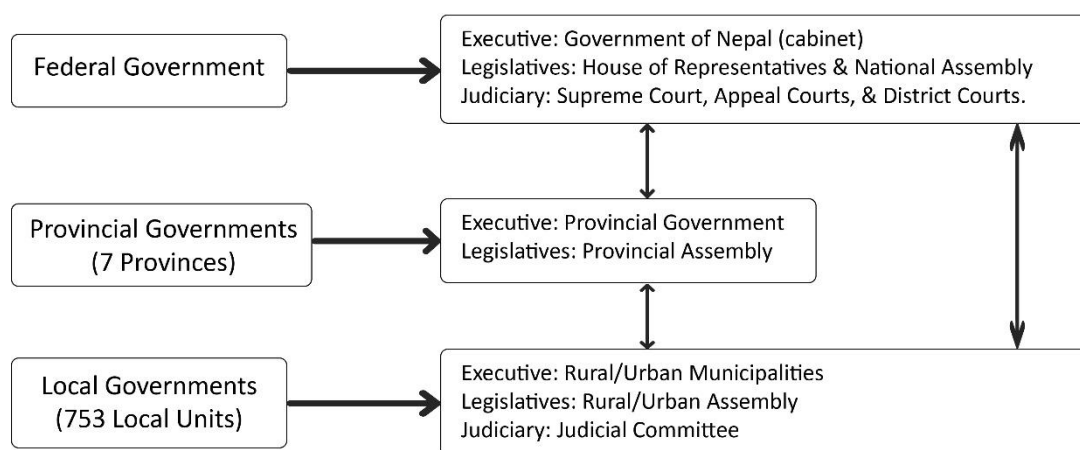


Figure 1: Existing Governance System of Nepal

The provincial and municipal governments in Nepal were formed by 2017 local election. This was when Nepal entered federal structure, two years after the 2015 Gorkha earthquake. Three tiers of government were formed- federal, provincial and local. The Constitution of Nepal stipulates that DRM is the shared responsibilities at all levels of government but with the sole responsibilities concentrated at the local level. National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Act, 2017; also sets out the formal structures, roles and responsibilities at all three levels of government. Nepal completed 2015 earthquake reconstruction in 2022. However, there are still gaps specific to localization of reconstruction, particularly need to increase focus on multi-hazard risk reduction.

In this evolving context, clear roadmaps, with insight into resource implications are needed for operationalization of GoN's three-tiered federal structure for the recovery and reconstruction process, multi-stakeholder coordination on reconstruction and information management of recovery and reconstruction activities for district and municipal governments. Localization of

DRM to the district and municipal levels requires correspondingly supportive policies as well as human and financial resources to implement the policies; specifically, the DRRM Act 2017 and DRR Policy 2018. The roles and responsibilities of the various actors in Nepal's DRM structure are outlined in the DRM Act 2017 and much discussion has centered on the alignment between theory and practice.

In this context, the **Localization Study on Nepal's Disaster Risk Management Governance** identifies approaches that support stakeholders in joining forces to strengthen local capacity in DRM with a specific focus on reconstruction and recovery processes. A Study Consultation and Inception Workshop was held on March 29, 2022, to formalize expressed interest in NDRRMA and NHSRP's partnership to implement this Study based on the mutually agreed Objectives and Research Questions.

The Study is framed to build on the learnings of existing initiatives and aligns in scope with past and current complementary research and investigations into localization and DRR Governance in Nepal to date, conducted by government as well as non-government actors, bilateral agencies etc.

1.3 Study Objectives and Key Research Questions

The overarching **Goal** of the Study is that its findings and recommendations will guide the NDRRMA's localization strategy in alignment with Nepal's National Disaster Resilience Framework (NDRF) and DRRM Strategic Action Plan 2030.

The main **Study Objective** is to inform multi-stakeholder through learning and generate evidence-based recommendations to support the implementation of NDRRMA's localization agenda as articulated in the draft NDRF.

The specific objectives of this study are:

- Identifying opportunities and existing constraints to improve localization of disaster risk reduction and management (DRRM) and disaster relief and recovery (DR&R) processes; and
- Providing recommendations to the Government of Nepal and Partners for practical approaches to strengthen local capacity in (DRRM and) the disaster relief and recovery process (DR&R), which will contribute to multi-stakeholder planning and funding prioritization for localization.

This study posed four **Research Questions (RQs)** to capture key elements for nuanced exploration, including relationships and networks, internal institutional and technical capacities, the impacts of external factors affecting the operationalization of policy into practice, and partnerships that can support effective **localization of DRRM and DR&R**.

The **Nepal Localization Framework (2019)** is seen as complementary to the Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Act of the Government of Nepal, with the government expected to take the **localization agenda** into National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA) policy and practice. While there is not one universal definition for localization, one of utmost relevance to this Study includes the ASEAN Coordinating Center for Humanitarian Assistance on Disaster Management (AHA Center)'s definition of localization as “a process of recognizing, respecting, strengthening the independence of leadership and decision making of local actors in humanitarian and disaster response. Local actors include national actors, subnational actors, local authorities, local communities and local civil society organizations” (Boey, et al., 2021). The Grand Bargain¹ is committed “to getting more funds into the hands of people in need while enhancing the effectiveness and efficiency of humanitarian actions”. Key pillars of Grand Bargain for transforming humanitarian aid are: quality funding, localization, anticipatory actions, participation, nexus; and innovative funding. Grand Bargain aims to promote localization by ensuring local engagement, increasing access to finances for both national and local actors, and fostering equitable collaborations. According to IFRC, (IFRC, 2020)² states that there is no specific definition for localization. It can be “strengthening roles of local actors in the context of international aid for increasing the reach

¹ Grand Bargain is an agreement between some of the major donors and humanitarian organizations during World Humanitarian Summit (WHS) in 2016 in Istanbul. <https://interagencystandingcommittee.org/node/40190>

² <https://resourcecenter.undac.org/wp-content/uploads/2020/12/Localization-external-policy-brief-4-April-2.pdf>

of humanitarian action and reducing costs. In broader sense, it is *reimagining humanitarian sector from bottom up acknowledging the efforts and value of local actors.*”

For this study purpose “localization of DRRM and DR&R” is aligned and defined as:

- Provincial and Local governments lead on advancing their disaster risk management activities as stipulated in the DRM Act and Disaster Risk Reduction National Strategic Plan of Action 2018-2030 including the National Disaster Resilience Framework 2021-2030.
- Provincial and Local governments have improved disaster risk governance for effective disaster preparedness and for building back better with clear DRR-related roles and responsibilities and have systems and strategies to be more resilient to the impacts of disaster and climate emergencies.

Under the DRRM Act and DRR Policy 2017, Provincial Governments in collaboration with District Disaster Management Committees (DDMC), are responsible for coordinating, facilitating, and guiding municipal risk reduction initiatives and mainstreaming these through the application of mitigating and preventive measures. Through the DRRM Act 2017, the GoN established Disaster Management Fund (clause 23) has called for allocation of disaster management funds in every province, district, and local level for disaster management. Increased responsibility at the local level requires correspondingly supportive policies, guidelines, and standards regarding relief, recovery, funds mobilization, monitoring and assessment, recovery, and rehabilitation.

Through this research, NDRRMA and NHSRP have generated recommendations that are applicable for nationwide implementation, utilizing practical approaches and leveraging partnerships to strengthen the localization process of DRRM and DR&R process in Nepal in 2024 and beyond.

2. Literature Review

2.1 Theories on Localization

There is an increasing push in global development and humanitarian activities to emphasize localization, broadly understood as the provision of support, tools, and funding to the closest, most local level to the community being served. There is also a push to “recognize and strengthen local leadership” so that they may take on the primary role in an emergency response.³

There are many arguments in literature in support of localization in development and humanitarian work. Financial - cost-effectiveness of responses, strategic - efficiency and speed of a response, and moral – principled argument for equality of all participating actors – are the most typical arguments used in prioritizing and advancing localization.⁴ Besides speed and access, local actors are also best placed to “link preparedness and response” as they remain long after other actors have left and can “play a key role in both recovery and longer-term achievement of development goals”.⁵ However, the overall goal of localization is “improved humanitarian response”.⁶

A seminal work from 2018, ‘Localization in practice: emerging indicators and practical recommendations’, lays out several helpful concepts in understanding localization, including the seven dimensions of localization, and the levels of change that must be undertaken to achieve it. The seven dimensions of localization laid out in the report are:

1. Participation
2. Relationship quality and partnerships
3. Funding/financing
4. Capacity strengthening
5. Coordination/ task forces/collaborative capacities
6. Visibility
7. Disaster & humanitarian policies, plans and standards

The report provides several indicators in each dimension which can be used to assess localization and advance it. For humanitarian practice, including recovery and reconstruction work, to be considered “localized” the report suggests, changes beyond the operational level must be made, including efforts in the three other levels as shown in the figure.



Figure 2: Levels of Change

³ Local leadership for disaster resilience. (2020) UN Office for Disaster Risk Reduction (UNDRR). Retrieved from: https://www.preventionweb.net/files/73001_localleadershipfordisasterresilienc.pdf

⁴ Van Brabant, K. & Patel, S. (2018). Localization in practice: emerging indicators and practical recommendations. GMI. Retrieved from: <https://reliefweb.int/report/world/localisation-practice-emerging-indicators-and-practical-recommendations>

⁵ Localization – what it means and how to achieve it. (2018). International Federation of the Red Cross (IFRC). Policy brief. Retrieved from: <https://media.ifrc.org/wp-content/uploads/sites/5/2018/05/Localization-external-policy-brief-4-April-2.pdf>

⁶ Localization in humanitarian practice. (2016). International Council of Voluntary Agencies (ICVA). Retrieved from: <https://www.icvanetwork.org/resources/localisation-humanitarian-practice>

While a lot of focus on localization in humanitarian efforts is moving from INGOs and international donors to local actors, localization processes can also include decentralizing knowledge, resources, and activities from national governance to local actors. The 'Grand Bargain' from 2016 imagines localization as a "reinforcing rather than replacing" of local capabilities as well as design and management decisions which are "responsive to the views of communities and people".⁷

2.2 Localization in Nepal

The status of localization in DRRM in Nepal indicates ongoing efforts but there are significant challenges too. Localization refers to the process of empowering or strengthening local actors both local government and communities, to take ownership of disaster risk reduction and management initiatives. Research conducted by partner organizations for ECHO⁸ project acknowledges that there is no consensus on definition of localization in humanitarian sector and has defined localization as, "local and national humanitarian actors increasingly empowered to take a greater role in the leadership, coordination and delivery of humanitarian preparedness and response in their countries".

In Nepal, there have been strides towards decentralization, empowering local government in disaster management, there are still notable gaps in terms of capacity, resources and coordination. Most of the local government in Nepal, often do not have sufficient capacity and resources to effectively handle disaster management. They face challenges such as limited funding, inadequate training and insufficient infrastructure. Additionally, coordination among different levels of government and between government agencies and non- governmental agencies can be fragmented, leading to inefficiency and gaps. However, there have been efforts to address these challenges and strengthening localization of DRRM in Nepal. Initiatives such as capacity building of local government, community-based disaster risk management programs, and integration of disaster risk reduction into local development plans are underway. Furthermore, there is increasing recognition of the importance of local government, community participation and empowerment in disaster management process.

The study on DRRM in Nepal emphasizes that significant institutional capacity gaps exist in all three levels of government, and it cannot be overlooked while designating and delineating authorities including for reconstruction and rehabilitation.⁹ This study has assessed the existing capacity of all three levels of government using a framework based on qualitative indicators across four components: i. DRRM governance, ii. Risk and vulnerability reduction iii. Knowledge and education iv. Preparedness and response as low, moderate and high.

Another study conducted by DPNet and Action Aid in 2022, has identified gaps and highlighted that policy documents are available at federal level but the formulation and operation of

⁷ Grand bargain. (2016). Inter-Agency Standing Committee. Retrieved from: <https://interagencystandingcommittee.org/grand-bargain>

⁸ European Civil Protection and Humanitarian Aid Operations (ECHO), Accelerating Localization Through Partnerships (ECHO, IRMA)

⁹ [Disaster risk reduction and management in Nepal: Delineation of roles and responsibilities](#)

required laws and policies at provincial and local level, is quite low. The challenges associated in formulating and implementing DRM policies and plans are, limited knowledge and skills of local government representatives and bureaucrats; understaffing and high staff turnover; their priority to infrastructure building over DRM; and limited budget.

The specific needs of local government in DRRM include legal framework, collaborative engagement both horizontal and vertical, investments on risk reductions, institutional and individual capacity building of local municipalities. (MoFAGA & IOM, 2019). Based on these identified needs and capacity Ministry of Federal Affairs and General Administration (MoFAGA) has prepared a Disaster Risk Localization Manual for DRM capacity of local government. The study of partner organizations of ECHO project, 2019 highlights those linkages, understanding and partnership between should be fostered between local actors and partner organizations for humanitarian response. Similarly, donor agencies to support local and national actors for achieving financial sustainability.

A detail review of existing policies at federal level and across three selected provinces shows that Government of Nepal has established some provisions for disaster victims' settlement, recovery, and localization at the federal level, but they are deemed insufficient. There are issues with procedural lapses and overlapping responsibilities among agencies. Additionally, there is no dedicated institution, like NDRRMA, for managing these tasks. Implementation often occurs on an ad hoc basis. Provincial governments have some authority in this area but have not taken significant action. Local governments are burdened by the lack of support from higher levels of government and struggle with delineating roles and responsibilities for these tasks, leading to duplication and confusion.

Existing efforts to bolster localization efforts by supporting the work of Provincial Disaster Management Committees (DMCs)s, District DMCs (DDMCs), Ward DMCs (WDMCs), and Local DMCs (LDMCs) under the oversight of the NDRRMA include support from the formerly named Housing Recovery and Reconstruction Platform (HRRP), now NHSRP; USAID (Tayar Nepal – Improved Disaster Risk Management); DPNET: Disaster Preparedness Network (DPNet-Nepal); Asian Disaster Preparedness Center; UNDP; IOM; I/NGOs; and Donors: FCDO, USAID, ADB, World Bank, JICA, and Australian Aid.

3. Research Methodology

The **Localization Study on Nepal's Disaster Risk Management Governance** poses four **Research Questions (RQs)** to capture key elements for nuanced exploration. The four RQs were designed to guide the exploration towards the objective of this study. Each RQ underwent a thorough validation process involving multiple stakeholders to ensure comprehensive coverage of essential elements, including relationships and networks, internal institutional and technical capacities, impacts of external factors on policy implementation, and supportive partnerships for effective Disaster Risk Reduction and Management (DRRM) localization.

The outcomes of RQs 1-4 were designed to scaffold learning and deeper investigation onto one another and to be combined into one collective Action Plan, providing practical recommendations to align funding priorities aimed at streamlining the efforts to localize the DRRM and DRR&R process via policy change and alignment of strategic and periodic plans. **The Action Plan is articulated as a set of Recommendations for funding prioritization in Section 5: Recommendations.**

3.1 Research Questions (RQ)

RQ 1: What networks exist within the government and development partners at both the institutional and individual competency levels in the context of DRRM localization, and what measures can be implemented to enhance these networks for optimal functionality and performance?

This RQ attempted to identify all actors involved in the process of localization of DRRM and DR&R process, bring them together, and map out their relationships to identify strengths, challenges, gaps, and successes as they pertain to implementing the DRRM Act 2017 and achieving the mandate of the DRRM Strategic Plan of Action 2030. This research question finds an answer through a network analysis tool and produces different types of network maps based on the survey conducted.

RQ 2: What capacities in DRRM in relation to localization exist within the local government at the institutional level and at the individual competency level; and based on this, what steps could be taken to further strengthen capacities to the level needed for optimum functionality and performance?

The purpose of this RQ was to show how NDRRMA will be able to understand the existing levels of relevant capacity within key collaborating agencies. The expected outcome of this analysis would highlight common capacity or competency gaps or strengthen across similar institutions levels or functions. NDRRMA will be able to identify critical areas for capacity improvements and guide improvement plans. This will allow for making recommendations in targeted areas to prioritize investment. Capacity assessment tool was used for this research question and different capacity assessment plans were produced.

RQ 3: How does local capacity for DRRM connect with national-level policy so that the local strategies and implementation plans are meaningfully aligned and effectively carried out?

This RQ aims to identify bottlenecks and main challenges – as well as cases of success in implementation of DRRM strategic Plan of Action at local level considering restructuring process by the Government of Nepal. This analysis has enabled an in-depth understanding of relationship between NDRRMA, federal and district authorities and the policy implementation methodology in place which will help to identify areas for additional support. This will help prioritize investment of the development partners.

RQ 4: Considering the changed political landscape in Nepal, what would be the most effective short-term and long-term approaches for GoN (at different levels and different departments) and Partners (Donors, INGOs, Private Sector) to contribute to the successful localization of DRRM and DR&R process?

The purpose of the research question is to recommend funding prioritization for evidence-based promising effective strategies.

3.2 Methods

The Study employed a mixed-method approach, integrating both quantitative and qualitative research methods to comprehensively study the localization process of DRRM. The integration of quantitative and qualitative methods enabled a comprehensive analysis of localization dynamics, combining the statistical rigor of quantitative analysis with the nuanced insights gained from qualitative approaches. This holistic approach aimed to provide a multifaceted understanding of the subject, enriching the study's findings and conclusions. Specifically:

Quantitative Method: Quantitative frameworks were utilized to gather structured data through survey questionnaire to different targeted respondent audiences. This method facilitated the collection of empirical data pertinent to network analysis and capacity assessment.

Qualitative Methods: The qualitative dimension of the study encompassed various techniques aimed at delving into subtle aspects of localization. These methods included:

- **Desk Review of Related Literature:** A comprehensive examination of existing literature was conducted to contextualize the study within the broader learning discourse.
- **Key Informant Interviews (KIIs):** Interviews were conducted with key stakeholders possessing expert insights and experiences relevant to the subject matter.
- **Focus Group Discussions (FGDs):** Group discussions were facilitated to explore diverse perspectives and generate rich insights into localization practices and perceptions.

3.3 Sampling Design

The Constitution of Nepal has "Structure of State and Distribution of State Power" in Part 5. The Schedule-4 (Relating to clause (3) of Article 56) has defined states and districts. Nepal is divided into seven provinces with 753 local governments.

The three provinces Bagmati, Gandaki, and Lumbini were selected as a sample for this study, as these were working areas of NHSRP when the research was conducted. NHSRP had existing teams on the ground with formally established relationships.

- **District Sampling:** A total of ten districts (five districts from Bagmati Province, two districts from Gandaki Province, and three districts from Lumbini Province) were selected purposely based on the highest multi hazard recovery and reconstruction caseload and presence of partner organizations working in the DRRM sector. For detail, please see Annex 8.2.1, Table 4: Selected Districts and Municipalities for the Study.
- **Municipal Sampling:** Within each district, one municipality (palika) was selected. Municipalities were selected based on highest local level disaster ranking. Indicators to determine this ranking includes frequency of incident, casualties, injury, missing persons, number of affected people, total estimated losses due to the eight major disasters (avalanche, earthquake, fire, flood, forest fire, landslide, lightning, windstorm) and the highest caseload for multi hazard recovery and reconstruction. The caseload that has occurred throughout the past ten years within the 313 total municipalities that make up these three provinces. Each municipality was scored and provided with its proportional local level disaster ranking by assigning a score based on the cumulative total of the weighted indicators. Municipalities with the highest score were selected for each district. For a detailed breakdown of selected municipalities please refer to Annex 8.2.1, Table 4: Selected Districts and Municipalities for the Study.

While this selection is not statistically representative, it aims to reflect the experiences of both earthquake affected and non-earthquake affected districts and municipalities that lie within three ecological belts. Please refer Annex 8.2.1, Table 3: Municipal Selection Criteria for the Study.

Furthermore, a total of 83 organizations were involved in this research. The organizations were invited to participate in the research.

Table 1: Details of Tools and Respondent for respective Research Question (RQ)

Research Question (RQ)	Tools Used	Respondents
RQ1: What networks exist within the government and development partners at both the institutional and individual competency levels in the context of Disaster Risk Management (DRM) localization, and what measures can be implemented to enhance these networks for optimal functionality and performance?	Network Analysis Tool	Representatives from Provincial and Municipal Government and Partner Organizations of Bagmati, Gandaki and Lumbini Provinces (DRR Focal Persons within the organizations)

RQ2: What capacities in DRRM in relation to localization exist within the local government at the institutional level and at the individual competency level; and based on this, what steps could be taken to further strengthen capacities to the level needed for optimum functionality and performance?	Capacity Assessment Tool	Representatives from Partner Organizations (DRR Focal Persons within the organizations)
RQ3: How does local capacity for DRRM connect with national-level policy so that the local strategies and implementation plans are meaningfully aligned and effectively carried out?	Literature review for setting benchmarks and develop final questionnaires for KII and FGDs	Representatives from Federal, Provincial and Municipal Governments, Municipality associations, UN Agencies, Donors and Partner Organizations
RQ4: Considering the changed political landscape in Nepal, what would be the most effective short-term and long-term approaches for GoN (at different levels and different departments) and Partners (Donors, INGOs, Private Sector) to contribute to the successful localization of (<i>DRM and</i>) the housing and the settlement recovery process?	Key Informant Interviews (KII) Focus Group Discussions (FGDs)	

3.4 Data Collection, Quality Control and Procedure

Three primary **data collection** tools and methods were employed. Their methodology and operationalization in the Study is described as follows. The tools and summary results are appended.

3.4a Network Analysis (Foundation for Research Question 1)

Network analysis was utilized as a key data collection tool for examining the localization process. Specifically, RQ1 investigation was operationalized via a Network Analysis, which provided a key foundation to further investigation of policies, roles, capacities, and external factors explored in RQs 2-4.

The Network Analysis approach allowed for the study to explore how different elements within a system interact and influence one another. Through key data collection from participating network actors, the structure and dynamics of the organizational network was investigated by capturing activities and relationships as nodes and their connections as edges. This method enabled the identification of central nodes, measurement of the flow of information and resources, and uncovering of patterns of collaboration and communication among stakeholders involved in the localization process. Through network analysis, insights into the factors that facilitate or hinder effective localization efforts are sought, contributing to a deeper understanding of localization dynamics and strategies.

The Network Analysis aimed to collect necessary data, refine the study's direction, and produce meaningful data with potential applications beyond the study period. The operationalization

plan included contextualizing the tools, presenting them to stakeholders, conducting data collection through various methods, consolidating, and analyzing the data, classifying, and prioritizing partners, and developing Network Strengthening Recommendations. Internal and external consultations were conducted to validate and finalize the recommendations.

For this study, the NDRRMA-NHSRP study team adapted CRS Partner Mapping and Organizational Network Analysis tools. This included a workshop co-facilitated by a Technical Expert. The facilitators supported workshop participants in data collection.

The data collection and validation of information was conducted through national level and provincial level workshops. An online data collection for entities unable to attend the workshops was also done. The aim was to gather relevant stakeholders involved in policy implementation (as much as possible, in-person; and their input in writing) and conduct a collaborative network analysis based on the written input collected. Analysis of data and its consolidation helped to construct a visual mapping of relationships between entities involved in DRRM policy implementation.

This research attempted to contact and conduct survey by sending emails as well as face to face meetings with relevant stakeholders. A consultation workshop was held at national level. At the provincial level, these organizations were invited to participate during the provincial level consultation conducted in Pokhara, Hetauda and Butwal. Altogether, three provincial level consultations

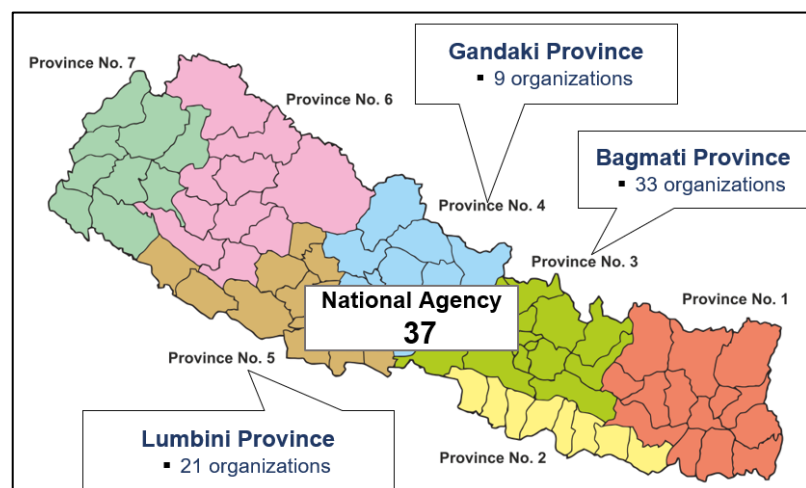


Figure 3: Number of organizations consulted at national and provincial level

were held. The consultation meeting for Gandaki Province was held on 18 April 2022 in Pokhara. Bagmati Province consultation meeting was held on 20 April 2022 in Hetauda. Similarly, consultation meeting at Lumbini Province was held on 25 May, 2022 at Butwal. Government actors, development partners, local government representatives, security agencies, NGOs, INGOs, UN agencies, media were the participants of these consultation meetings. The participants were identified and invited by NDRRMA at national level and Ministry of Internal Affairs and Law (MOIAL) at Province level.

Following five different Network Maps of Collaboration were created from the collected data:

- Collaboration at National Level,
- Collaboration on Disaster Risk,
- Collaboration on Emergency Response,
- Collaboration on GEDSI,
- Collaboration on Housing and Settlement,
- Collaboration on Partner Capacity Strengthening.

The subsequent analysis focused on identifying bottlenecks in relationships among the central authority, central entity, and local representatives, such as communication, resources, and capacities. For a detailed understanding of the tool, please refer to Annex 8.2.2: Tools developed and used for RQ1_Network Analysis.

3.4b Capacity Assessment Tool (Foundation for Research Question 2, building on Network Analysis of RQ1)

3.4a The main purpose of RQ2 was to enable NDRRMA understand the existing levels of capacity within its key collaborating agencies, to help highlight common capacity or competency and gaps or strengths. It will also help NDRRMA to identify critical areas for capacity improvements, guiding improvement plans and providing recommendations for capacity strengthening in targeted areas to prioritize investment. The approach for this investigation was built on the outcomes of the literature review and Network Analysis (RQ1) and conducting a Collective Capacity Assessment (RQ2) involving all the key stakeholders. Data from stakeholders were collected during the workshops through a self-assessment process. This helped in identification of capacities, strengths, gaps, and challenges.

The capacity assessment tool draws upon CRS' Holistic Capacity Assessment Instrument (HOCAI) Manual and Engaging Government Guide (EGG). This method evaluates the capacity of entities involved in Disaster Risk Management (DRM) and post-disaster housing and settlement recovery processes in Nepal. By assessing capacity, strengths, gaps, and challenges within organizations, this tool provides valuable insights for enhancing disaster response and recovery efforts.

At national level, a facilitated self-assessment workshop was conducted with NDRRMA using the contextualized version of the EMPOWER Government Partner Emergency Response Capacity Assessment Tool. Targeted capacity areas were mutually agreed upon prior to the workshop and include 1) Identity and Governance, 2) Human Resources, 3) Finance and Operations, 4) Programming, 5) Monitoring and Evaluation, 6) Communications, 7) Safeguarding, and 8) ICT.

The three consultative meetings at provincial level and an inception meeting at national level helped to introduce the Network Analysis and Capacity Needs Assessment processes and tools to the relevant stakeholders and partners. The workshops were followed up by facilitated self-assessments, using the Network Analysis Survey and the Government Partner Emergency Response Capacity Assessment Tool. Self-assessments and completion of the Network Analysis survey were led internally by each selected organization's Focal Point with assistance and follow-up from the study team both in physical presence and virtually. Written guidance was provided to capacity assessment survey respondents. National partners and local partners who could not attend the provincial workshops were included through a facilitated self-assessment approach, using the above-described adapted limited version of the adapted Partner Capacity Assessment Tool.

3.4c KIIs and FGDs

For R.Q.3, Qualitative data collection method was adopted using Key informant interview (KII) and Focus Group Discussion (FGD) as tools.

Key Informant Interview (KII): KII was conducted by identifying the knowledgeable person within the institutions/organizations considering the factors like person who could provide insights, who had institutional memory on DRRM. Some of the key government actors and other national stakeholders and DRM actors who possessed expert insights and experiences relevant to the localization process were identified and in-depth interviews were conducted. The main purpose was to understand the bottlenecks and challenges for policy implementation and impact of external challenges and opportunities on the operationalization of policies at different levels. A semi structured questionnaire was used that covered four research themes: policy, structure, operation, coordination and collaboration, and funding.

For e.g., KII was conducted with DRR focal person at Office of Prime Minister and Cabinet of Ministers (OPMCM), Ministry of Urban Development (MoUD), Ministry of Federal Affairs and General Administration (MoFAGA), Ministry of Home Affairs (MoHA). Through KIIs, valuable firsthand information was gathered, enriching the understanding of localization dynamics, and informing strategic decision-making.

Focus Group Discussion (FGDs): The Focus Group Discussions were conducted with the relevant stakeholders of Provincial and municipal government stakeholders. An open-ended questionnaire was used for FGDs based on four themes: i. policy, ii. structure iii. operation, coordination and collaboration, and iv. funding.

These discussions provided qualitative data to complement quantitative findings, offering deeper insights into stakeholder perspectives, experiences, and challenges associated with localization efforts.

3.5 Ethics and Consent Procedures

The ethical standards upheld throughout this study were rigorously adhered and guided by key principles of research ethics such as informed consent, confidentiality maintenance, and the commitment to do no harm. Below are some highlights of the ethical standards observed during the process:

- Clear information regarding the survey's objectives was provided to all respondents.
- Contact information of NHSRP was shared with stakeholder and partner organizations for necessary follow-up communication.
- Consensus was obtained before commencing the survey.
- Data was compiled exactly as presented in the completed surveys to maintain accuracy.
- Confidentiality of shared information was assured and translated as needed.
- Efforts were made during Focus Group Discussions (FGDs) to ensure equitable participation and minimize participation burdens for all involved.

3.6 Study Limitations

While the Nepal Disaster Resilience Localization Study aims to provide valuable insights and evidence-based recommendations to enhance reconstruction and settlement recovery process with extended scope to cover DRRM governance and plan, policies, and framework

implementation. The study has limitations in scope, methodology, data availability, targeting, resource constraints as follows:

- i. The primary focus of the study is on DRRM and DR&R in Nepal, largely looking into housing and settlements sector. Other aspects of DRRM such as infrastructure resilience, community preparedness, early warning systems, and other technical focus may not receive equal attention.
- ii. The study was targeted in three provinces (Bagmati, Gandaki and Lumbini) per initial NHSRP presence at local level. The findings are assumed to be representative, applicable across the country. The findings and recommendations of the study may not be fully generalizable to all regions and contexts within Nepal, as disaster risks, governance structures, and community dynamics vary across different geographic areas.
- iii. The case study was not conducted per TOR. The study considered that sufficient information was collected through RQ1-4 using various tools and methodologies.
- iv. The data collection process was launched in 2021 and still are believed to be relevant to current technique.
- v. The study may be constrained by limited resources, including funding, time, and personnel. These constraints could impact the breadth of research conducted, the number of stakeholders consulted, and the geographic coverage of the study.
- vi.
- vii. Despite efforts to maintain objectivity, the study may be influenced by researcher bias or subjectivity in data interpretation, stakeholder engagement, and recommendation formulation.
- viii. Municipality (Geographic Selection) was not conducted per Human Development Index whereas the focus was on geographic disaster vulnerability.

4. STUDY FINDINGS

4.1 RQ1: Findings on the Relationship of Federal, Provincial, and Local Government and their counterpart government and partner organizations

Research Question 1 explored via Network Analysis: What networks exist within the government and development partners at both the institutional and individual competency levels in the context of Disaster Risk Reduction and Management (DRRM) localization, and what measures can be implemented to enhance these networks for optimal functionality and performance?

4.1a Survey Results Summary

Detailed Survey Results by Question are available in **Annex 8.3.1: Results to the Network Analysis Questionnaire**. Survey respondents included 67 organizations in total, of which 28 self-identified as government/ public organizations, 22 as non-governmental organizations (NGOs), 4 as international organizations, 3 as UN Agencies, 1 as research organization and 1 as Donor. Of the respondents, 43% count a workforce of 5-50 staff; 19% more than 100; 16% between 50-100; and 15% less than 5.

4.1b Results of the Network Analysis

Based on the data results of the Survey, a Network Analysis was done to map the existing relationship of NDRRMA and various actors working in the DRRM sector.

The following interrelationship mapping was drawn, based on the sample of institutional respondents:

- Institutional collaboration (in general around DRRM) at national level
- Institutional collaboration on Disaster Risk
- Institutional collaboration on Emergency Response
- Institutional collaboration on GEDSI
- Institutional collaboration on Housing and Settlement
- Institutional collaboration on Partner Capacity Strengthening

Full-sized versions of each network analysis diagram can be found in Annex 8.3.2: Network Analysis Graphics

Table 2: Key Findings from the Inter-relationship mapping done through Network Analysis

<i>Collaboration at National Level</i>
• Collaboration at national level shows that in DRRM, NDRRMA plays a central role. • The District Administration Office (DAO) has a highly important role in coordination with the government at national level. • Role of development partner/INGOs are also of prime importance in disaster risk reduction and management.
<i>Collaboration on Disaster Risk</i>
Collaboration on disaster risk reduction shows that there are two actors that have central role in DRRM. • NDRRMA has central role with supporting roles from District Administration Offices (DAO), different sectoral ministries and departments; NGOs and INGOs. • Municipal governments are central for DRRM at local level with support from other adjoining municipal government, DAO, NGOs/INGOs. The linkages between municipalities and province government whereas is very less.
<i>Collaboration on Emergency Response</i>
• NDRRMA, Municipalities and District Administration Offices are key actors for collaboration on emergency response. • There is no clear and strong indication on collaboration with provincial government. • NGO/INGO have clear prominent role in emergency response. • The network pattern is not regularized and different per context at various local level.
<i>Collaboration on GEDSI</i>
• NDRRMA, Municipalities and District Administration Offices are key actors for collaboration on GEDSI. • There is no clear and strong indication on collaboration with provincial government. • NGO/INGO have clear prominent role in GEDSI.
<i>Collaboration on Housing and Settlement</i>

- NDRRMA, Municipalities and District Administration Offices are key actors for collaboration on Housing and Settlement.
- There is no clear and strong indication on collaboration with provincial government.
- NGO/INGO have clear prominent role in Housing and Settlement.

Collaboration on Partner Capacity Strengthening

- The network diagram indicates the UN, I/NGOs direct collaboration with NDRRMA, municipalities and district office on partner capacity strengthening.
- The analysis indicates NDRRMA contributes on partner capacity strengthening to municipalities and districts but not clearly visible support to provinces.

4.2 RQ2: Findings around self-assessed strengths and identified opportunities for capacity sharing, in support of Nepal's national localization agenda.

Research Question 2 explored via Capacity Self-Assessments: What capacities in DRR in relation to localization exist within the local government at the institutional level and at the individual competency level; and what steps could be taken to further strengthen capacities to the level needed for optimum functionality and performance?

In total, 63 organizations participated in RQ2 by completing a capacity needs self-assessment survey (33 in Bagmati, 9 in Gandaki; 21 in Lumbini Province), which homed in on eight spheres of institutional capacity: Identity and Governance; Human Resource Management; Finance and Operations; Programming; Monitoring and Evaluation; Communications; Safeguarding; and ICT.

For the detailed list of questions, please refer to Annex 8.2.3: Institutional Capacity Assessment Questions already introduced in the Methodology section.

4.2a Self-Assessment Results Summary

Detailed Survey Results by Question are available in **Annex 8.4.1: Results to the Capacity Self-Assessment Questionnaire (by individual question)**

The survey engaged diverse stakeholders involved in disaster risk reduction and management (DRRM) efforts in Nepal. This included related government agencies, I/NGOs, humanitarian organizations, NRCS, provincial and local authorities, disaster affected communities and experts. Their participation ensured a comprehensive assessment of disaster risk reduction and management capacities across various sectors and regions in Nepal. Summary of key findings of R.Q 3 are as follows:

Summary of the Results (Scores) & Discussion of observed Trends:

1. Organizational Structure: Over half (50%) lacked dedicated DRR divisions at municipal and provincial level.
2. Staff Capacities: Majority possessed required skills, but 46% needed strengthening to meet NDRRMA technical capacity benchmark.
3. Coordination Strategies: Most had strategies for collaboration but has not practiced adequately.
4. Action Plans: Majority lacked DRR-aligned action in line strategic action plan on DRR2018-2030.
5. Financial Resources: 56.71% faced financial constraints to implement DRR and emergency response program activities.
6. Clear Delineation of roles and responsibilities: 50 % are not clear on delineation of roles and responsibilities between federal, provincial and local government clearly defined and communicate.
7. ICT Capacity on data collection: 43 % had ranked themselves as an organization with medium level capacity, 33% with good capacity and 13 % only had excellent capacity on ICT for data collection. One of the organizations had very poor capacity while three organizations were unaware on ICT.

8. ICT Capacity on data, IT equipment management and troubleshooting: All respondents except 3 have the capacity on ICT.
9. Monitoring and Evaluation: 43% lacked DRM monitoring systems.

Further detail can be found in **Annex 8.4.2: Comparison Overview of Results from RQ2 Self-Assessment/Guided Capacity Questionnaires**

4.3 RQ3: Findings on Policy Alignment - National, Provincial, and Local Government

Research Question 3 explored via Key Informant Interviews and Focus Group Discussions: How does local capacity for DRM connect with national level policy so that the local strategies and implementation plans are meaningfully aligned and carried out? This was explored to identify the existing bottlenecks, impact of external challenges and opportunities on the operationalization of policies at different levels.

The Study identified some of the key government actors and other national stakeholders and DRM actors and interviewed them to understand the bottlenecks and challenges around policy implementation.

4.3.1 Performance Benchmarks: Policy, Structure, Operations, Coordination and Collaboration, Funds

The Key Informant Interview and Focus Group Discussion tools for these discussions were prepared following a thorough Literature Review (and analysis of findings from RQs1 and 2 to hone on key issues around potential bottlenecks, external challenges, and opportunities.

Key Informant Interviews and Focus Group Discussions were held with representatives of OPMCM, MoUD, MoFAGA, and MoHA and other stakeholders:

- *Office of Prime Minister and Cabinet of Ministers (OPMCM)*
- *Ministry of Urban Development (MoUD)*
- *Ministry of Federal Affairs and General Administration (MoFAGA)*
- *Ministry of Home Affairs (MoHA)*

Similar interviews were conducted with relevant stakeholders at the provincial and local government level during consultation held at Pokhara, Hetauda, and Butwal in 2022.

All discussions were structured around four key topics: 1) policy; 2) structure; 3) operation, coordination, and collaboration; and 4) funding.

The benchmarks were developed to systematically assess and capture capacity in the aggregate, please see **Annex 8.5.1: Supporting Documentation to Findings from National Level Consultations** on Table A: Study-developed Benchmarks for measuring capacity at different levels-RQ3.

4.3.2 Emergent Themes from Interview with National Government Actors on Policy, Structure, Operations, Coordination and Collaboration, and Fund

The following is a summary of the findings from the Literature Review and consultations with national government actors. For further details, review **Annex 8.5.1: Supporting**

Documentation to Findings from National Level Consultations for the Summary documentation of KIIs with OPMCM, MoUD, MoFAGA, MoHA, and NDRRMA.

4.3.2a Legal Provisions for Localization of DRRM in Nepal

- **The Constitution of Nepal** has provisioned disaster management in its national policy under article 51 (G) (9) as the “shall do early warning for risk reduction of natural hazards, preparedness, rescue, relief, and recovery”. It was the first time provisioning such disaster management affairs into the content of the constitution. Likewise, its annexes of the power divisions have mentioned that the local government has exclusive jurisdiction over disaster management, and the concurrent roles of disaster management are allocated among the federal, provincial, and local governments. Similarly, the common power between federal and provincial governments is provisioned on preparedness for natural and unnatural disasters, rescue, relief, and recovery affairs.
- **Disaster Risk Reduction and Management (DRRM) Act, 2017** has provisioned a few sections on disaster recovery and settlement issues. It has provisioned roles and responsibilities of the Executive Committee for DRRM chaired by the home minister about the formulating integrated recovery policy, plan, and program and implementation. Likewise, there are few roles in the resettlement of risky inhabitants and conducting recovery programs in disaster victims’ area (s). This act has provisioned a provincial disaster management executive committee chaired by the concerned provincial minister to look after disaster response, recovery, rehabilitation, reconstruction, and resettlement-related tasks. The DRRM Act has provisioned a few roles and responsibilities on settlement and recovery at both federal and provincial executive committees. There are no roles and responsibilities allocated to NDRRMA on recovery and settlement issues. The NDRRMA is undertaking such tasks as the delegated responsibilities by the Executive Committee.
- **Local Governance Operation Act, 2017** has provisioned a short and clear statement that the local government has a role, responsibility, and power to do rehabilitation and reconstruction of local-level disaster(s). The government of Nepal has not yet categorized the level of disasters to operate on time accordingly.
- **Disaster Risk Reduction National Strategic Plan of Action (2018-2030)** has prioritized localization under Priority action 2 which identifies need of strengthening disaster risk governance at federal, provincial and local level through establishment of institutional structures, formulating legal and regulatory framework, capacity development, and through collaboration and partnership for DRRM.

4.3.2b Existing Governance Mechanisms for Localization of DRRM in Nepal

- Ministry of Home Affairs (MOHA) is the nodal agency for DRRM. In December 2019, National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA) was established under MOHA. Since then, DRRM roles have been shifted to NDRRMA and it has been

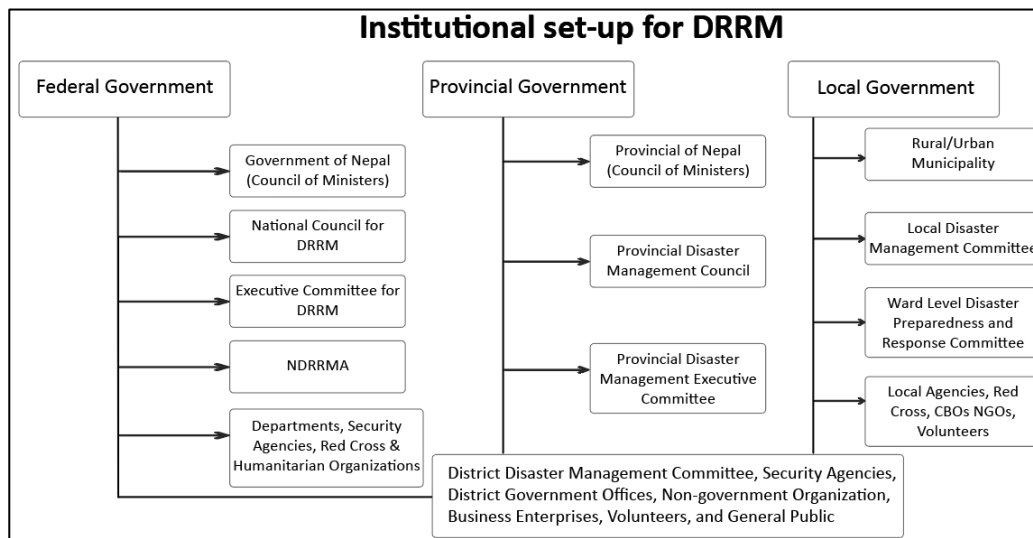


Figure 4: Institutional Set-up for DRRM in Nepal

initiating policy processes and leading DRRM roles, responsibilities and accountabilities between three levels of the government through coordination between them for disaster risk reduction, recovery and reconstruction. It has also been working with UN organizations, INGOs, NGOs, media and individual experts to help local governments for their capacity building on DRRM. This has helped local governments to rapidly take up their roles and mandates provided by the Constitution and Local Government Operations Act, 2017. For the emergency response related actions, it is directly guided by MOHA through Nepal Police and Armed Police Force (APF) and as its first responders. Depending on the disaster events, Nepal Army (under the Ministry of Defense) is also mobilized as first responders during emergency.

- National Planning Commission (NPC)** has issued guidelines to integrate DRRM into local government's (LG's) annual development plans.
- The **Ministry of Federal Affairs and General Administration (MOFAGA)** has prepared and shared Local DRR Strategic Action Planning Guidelines (2021) to localize SFDRR at local level.
- The **Ministry of Federal Affairs and General Administration (MOFAGA)** has been supporting the local governments with model policy documents. Local Governments have utilized these models as an example to prepare their own policies. As the result:
 - Local laws and policies on DRRM have been formulated by all 753 local governments (LG).*
 - Disaster Management Fund is allocated and operated by all local governments (LG) for disaster preparedness, response, reconstruction and resettlement. A sum total of around USD 16 million is estimated to be mobilized by local government as disaster management fund. This fund was effectively utilized for COVID-19 response by the local government.*

- *Among 753 local government, only 319 have prepared their Local Disaster and Climate Resilience Plan (LDCRP)¹⁰*
- *Local Emergency Operation Center (LEOC) has been established and is in operation by 116 local governments.*
- *The Humanitarian Cluster Approach is also in the process of localization through appropriate guidelines and institutional structures.*
- MOFAGA is coordinating a nationwide DRRM orientation program to the local government (LG) leaders. The elected leaders from 753 Local Governments (LG) have already been trained through this program. This program aims to cover all 753 Local Governments in 2022. Governments, civil society actors including private sectors and international organizations have worked together who represent in the planning and execution through formal committees, humanitarian clusters, and various task groups. Emphasis will be placed on showcasing how local and indigenous knowledge in disaster risk reduction and management planning can improve outcomes and build inclusive resilience.

4.3.2c Provisions and Mechanisms around Housing Reconstruction in Nepal

- NDRRMA has adopted a post -earthquake reconstruction model in the reconstruction of private houses that are damaged due to monsoon related disasters and fire.
- The recent earthquakes (Lamjung, Khotang, Doti and Jajarkot) are awaiting policy reforms and procedure development from NDRRMA for reconstruction. The current provision provides a cash grant of 5 lakhs in Himalayan region, 4 lakhs in hilly region, and 3 lakhs in terai region for reconstruction of houses, based on the recommendation and assessment received from DDMC. These grants are disbursed in three installments. “Monsoon Induced Disaster Private Housing Recovery and Reconstruction Grant Disbursement Guideline 2077, Fire Induced Disaster Private Housing Recovery and Reconstruction Grant Disbursement Guideline 2078, the Grant Distribution Guideline for Monsoon and fire affected Private Housing Reconstruction and Rehabilitation, 2021 also has a provision of providing grant of NPR 50,000 for maintenance or retrofitting and an additional grant of NPR 50,000 for temporary shelter construction which is disbursed in two in two tranche.
- Another important provision is providing a maximum grant of NPR 300,000 for purchasing land to the beneficiaries who have to be resettled in a newer location and that they do not own any other land parcel in the country.
- For the reconstruction of private housing, the concurrent contribution of different level of government is expected. The federal government must cover 50% or more than that of tranche amount, provincial government must cover 30% and local government (metropolitan or sub-metropolitan or municipality) must cover 20% of the reconstruction tranche for all disasters except for earthquake whereas the federal government covers 100% of reconstruction tranche for houses affected by earthquake.

¹⁰ LDCRP is a planning tool for local government that has organized program of action with both delineated responsibilities and budget for disaster risk reduction, climate change adaptation, emergency response as well as post disaster recovery and reconstruction.

4.3.3 Findings about Alignment at Provincial Level from Consultations with Provincial Government

For reference to Benchmarks by Topic at Province level, and corresponding Questionnaire please refer to: Annex 8.5.2.: Supporting Documentation regarding Status of Policy, Structures, Operations and Fund (Province)

4.3.3a DRRM related Policies at Provincial Level

The assessment aimed to evaluate the understanding of DRRM policies and procedures at the national level among the Chief Minister's office of Bagmati Province and the Ministry of Internal Affairs (MoIAL) in three provinces: Bagmati, Lumbini, and Gandaki. The respondents claimed to be aware of the relevant acts, regulations, procedures, standards, and guidelines. However, there is a shortage of capable human resources in the DRRM section of the ministry, with only one or two individuals responsible for DRRM activities in all provinces. This lack of personnel hampers the development of DRRM by-laws at the provincial level. To address this issue, capacity development activities involving the national government, NDRRMA, and development partners should be implemented.

In terms of technical and financial resources, only Lumbini provincial ministry reported allocating funds for the development of DRRM by-laws, but these resources are still inadequate. The other provinces expressed a lack of both financial and technical resources for developing DRRM by-laws at the ministry level. As a result, the provinces are unable to formulate provincial-level DRRM policies, procedures, and by-laws effectively. The conclusion emphasizes the necessity for the national ministry, NDRRMA, and development partners to provide technical support, offer capacity development training, and allocate sufficient resources to facilitate the development of DRRM-related by-laws at the provincial government level. Despite these challenges, the province governments are making efforts to develop different DRRM by-laws with technical support from partner organizations.

In Bagmati Province, the DRRM Act, DRRM Policy, and Strategic Action Plan are available. However, DRR Regulation, Relief Standard, Fund Mobilization Procedure, Recovery and Reconstruction Guideline, Rescue and Relief Distribution, and Provincial disaster response plan are not yet in place.

Gandaki Province lacks the DRRM Act and DRRM Policy, but has the DRR Regulation, Strategic Action Plan, Fund Mobilization Procedure, and Provincial disaster response plan. Similarly, Relief Standard, Recovery and Reconstruction Guideline, and Rescue and Relief Distribution are not available in Gandaki Province.

Lumbini Province has the DRRM Act but lacks DRR Regulation, DRRM Policy, Strategic Action Plan, Relief Standard, Fund Mobilization Procedure, Recovery and Reconstruction Guideline, and Provincial disaster response plan. However, it does have Rescue and Relief Distribution in place.

For details on these Findings, please refer to the following Annexes:

Annex 8.5.2.: Supporting Documentation regarding Status of Policy, Structures, Operations and Fund (Province).

Table 10: Status of Existing DRRM Policy at Provincial Level

4.3.3b DRRM Governance Structure at Provincial Level

Bagmati, Gandaki, and Lumbini province have established Provincial Disaster Management Committees (PDMCs), although the frequency of PDMC meetings is not defined and they occur annually or as needed. These provinces have integrated Gender Equality and Social Inclusion (GEDSI) into their PDMCs. They have also established Provincial Emergency Operation Centers (PEOCs) and emergency warehouses with management guidelines or standard operating procedures (SOPs). However, the PEOCs in all provinces are not yet linked with the District Emergency Operation Centers (DEOCs), Local Emergency Operation Centers (LEOCs), and the Bipad Portal.

All provinces have provisions for Disaster Risk Reduction (DRR) volunteers at the provincial government level. However, Bagmati, Gandaki, and Lumbini provinces lack specific guidelines for volunteer mobilization. Furthermore, none of the provinces have allocated a dedicated budget for DRR volunteer mobilization.

Regarding recovery and reconstruction activities, there is no separate unit available within the provincial government. The role of the provincial government is primarily limited to financial contributions as outlined in the reconstruction guidelines. Consequently, they mainly coordinate with the District Administration Office (DAO) and, if necessary, with the respective municipalities. Notably, there is currently no coordination between the provincial government and the NDRRMA regarding the recovery and reconstruction process.

For details on these Findings, please refer to the following Annexes:

Annex 8.5.2.: Supporting Documentation regarding Status of Policy, Structures, Operations and Fund (Province)

Table 10: Status of Structures at Provincial Level

4.3.3c Operation, Coordination, and Collaboration for DRRM at Provincial Level

The analysis of the data reveals that in Bagmati, Gandaki, and Lumbini, there is a lack of reported coordination and collaboration with the national level for disaster preparedness activities. However, all provinces demonstrate coordination and collaboration with the District Disaster Management Committees (DDMCs). Bagmati and Lumbini province also exhibit such collaboration with the Local Disaster Management Committees (LDMCs). This indicates a decentralized approach to disaster preparedness at the provincial level, with more emphasis on local coordination.

Regarding reconstruction and recovery efforts, none of the provinces report coordination and collaboration with the federal government. However, all provinces demonstrate coordination and collaboration with both DDMCs and LDMCs for reconstruction and recovery activities. This suggests that the provincial governments are primarily relying on local-level coordination mechanisms for post-disaster reconstruction and recovery.

Overall, the analysis underscores the varying levels of coordination and collaboration among the provinces in Nepal concerning disaster preparedness and reconstruction and recovery. There is a need to enhance coordination and collaboration with the national level, particularly for disaster preparedness activities. Additionally, strengthening coordination mechanisms with the federal government would contribute to more effective reconstruction and recovery efforts.

Despite these challenges, all provinces have made progress in implementing disaster preparedness and reconstruction activities, signifying their commitment to mitigating the impacts of disasters and facilitating post-disaster.

For details on these Findings, please refer to the following Annexes:

Annex 8.5.2.: Supporting Documentation regarding Status of Policy, Structures, Operations and Fund (Province)

Table 12: Status of Operations, Coordination and Collaboration at Provincial Level

4.3.3d DRRM Fund available at Provincial Level

The data analysis indicates that the Provincial Governments have both a dedicated fund, known as "**Bipad Kosh**," and annual budget allocations for Disaster Risk Reduction and Management (DRRM) purposes. The mobilization of the DRRM fund is conducted through the district level and sometimes directly from the Minister level. However, there is no reported development of a fund mobilization guideline.

In terms of reconstruction and recovery, all provinces have allocated a dedicated fund for these purposes. The mobilization of the reconstruction and recovery fund is carried out through the District Administration Office (DAO) under the Ministry of Internal Affairs and Law (MoIAL). The funds are transferred from MoIAL to the DAO, which oversees the mobilization process. However, there is no provision for cash distribution and in-kind support mentioned in the data.

To summarize, the Provincial Governments have dedicated funds and budget allocations for DRRM and reconstruction and recovery. The DRRM fund is mobilized through the district and sometimes at the ministerial level, while the reconstruction and recovery fund are mobilized through the DAO from MoIAL. However, there is no specific guideline developed for fund mobilization, and there is no provision for cash distribution or in-kind support mentioned in the data.

For details on these Findings, please refer to the following Annexes:

Annex 8.5.2.: Supporting Documentation regarding Status of Policy, Structures, Operations and Fund (Province)

Table 10: Status of Funding at Provincial Level

4.3.4 Findings about Alignment at Local Level from Consultations with Local Government

For reference to Benchmarks by Topic at Province level, and corresponding Questionnaire please refer to:

Table A: Study-developed Benchmarks for measuring capacity at different levels-RQ3

Annex 8.5.3: Supporting Documentation regarding Status of Policy, Structures, Operations and Fund (Local)

4.3.4a DRRM related Policies at Municipal/Local Level

Based on the information received from different type of municipalities on their awareness of DRRM Acts, Regulations, Procedures, Standards (By-laws) developed at the national level, the development of DRRM by-laws by each municipality (*Palika*), the endorsement and implementation of local disaster preparedness and response planning, the mainstreaming of

these plans into annual development plans, the availability of human resources for developing DRRM by-laws, and the availability of technical and financial resources for the same.

Based on the analysis of data received from different types of municipalities:

- **Metropolitan municipalities** have reported no awareness or development of DRRM by-laws. There is no endorsement or implementation of local disaster preparedness and response planning, and no mainstreaming of such plans into annual development plans. Additionally, there are no reported human resources or technical and financial resources available for the development of DRRM by-laws.
- **Sub Metropolitan municipalities** show moderate awareness of DRRM Acts, Regulations, Procedures, Standards developed at the national level. Some progress has been made in the development of DRRM by-laws, but there is no reported endorsement or implementation of local disaster preparedness and response planning, and no mainstreaming of these plans into annual development plans. Limited human resources are available for developing DRRM by-laws, but technical and financial resources are insufficient.
- **Municipalities** demonstrate a higher level of awareness of DRRM Acts, Regulations, Procedures, Standards developed at the national level. There is significant progress in the development of DRRM by-laws, with some municipalities reporting the endorsement and implementation of local disaster preparedness and response planning, as well as the mainstreaming of these plans into annual development plans. However, there is a lack of human resources available for developing DRRM by-laws in most municipalities. While technical resources are generally sufficient, financial resources for development are lacking.
- **Rural municipalities** exhibit the highest awareness of DRRM Acts, Regulations, Procedures, Standards developed at the national level. However, the development of DRRM by-laws is limited, and there is no reported endorsement or implementation of local disaster preparedness and response planning or mainstreaming of these plans into annual development plans. There is a lack of both human and financial resources for developing DRRM by-laws.

Overall, the analysis suggests that there is a need for increased efforts across all types of municipalities to further develop and implement DRRM by-laws, endorse and implement local disaster preparedness and response planning, and allocate sufficient human, technical, and financial resources to ensure effective disaster management at the local level.

For details on these Findings, please refer to the following Annexes:

Annex 8.5.3: Supporting Documentation regarding Status of Policy, Structures, Operations and Fund (Local)

Table 14: Status of Existing DRRM Policy at Local Level

4.3.4b DRRM Governance Structure at Municipal/Local Level

From the given data information on various aspects related to disaster response and preparedness at different types of municipalities. Here is a summary of the analysis:

- **Metropolitan:** One metropolitan municipality has reported the availability of an LDMC at the Palika level. However, no special wing for reconstruction and recovery,

WDMC, dedicated committee/unit/wing for disaster response, LEOC, emergency warehouse, stockpiling of emergency equipment, or provisions for DRR volunteers are reported. In summary, the analysis indicates that there is variability in the availability of disaster management infrastructure and resources among different types of municipalities. While some municipalities have established LDMCs and provisions for disaster response, many lack dedicated committees or units and sufficient resources. Furthermore, the availability of emergency warehouses, stockpiled equipment, and trained DRR volunteers is limited. These findings suggest the need for enhanced preparedness measures and resource allocation to strengthen disaster response capabilities at the municipal level.

- **Sub Metropolitan:** Two sub-metropolitan municipalities have reported the availability of LDMCs at the *Palika* level. One sub-metropolitan municipality has a special wing for the reconstruction and recovery of disaster-affected households. One sub-metropolitan municipality has a WDMC, but none of the sub-metropolitan municipalities have a dedicated committee/unit/wing for disaster response. Only one sub-metropolitan municipality has an LEOC. One sub-metropolitan municipality has an emergency warehouse, and one has stockpiled emergency equipment and materials. There are no guidelines or SOPs available for emergency warehouse management. One sub-metropolitan municipality has provisions for DRR volunteers, but their training and necessary equipment are not mentioned.
- **Municipalities:** Four municipalities have reported the availability of Local Disaster Management Committees (LDMCs) at the *Palika* level. Only one municipality has a special wing dedicated to the reconstruction and recovery of disaster-affected households. None of the municipalities have a dedicated committee/unit/wing for disaster response, and only three municipalities have Local Emergency Operation Centers (LEOCs). One municipality has an emergency warehouse, and three municipalities have stockpiled emergency equipment, search and rescue materials, WASH Kits, NFI Kits, and Health Kits. Two municipalities have guidelines or Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) for managing emergency warehouses. One municipality has provisions for DRR (Disaster Risk Reduction) volunteers at the municipal government level, but they are not adequately trained or equipped with necessary search and rescue and emergency equipment.
- **Rural Municipalities:** Eight rural municipalities have reported the availability of LDMCs at the *Palika* level. Two rural municipalities have a special wing for the reconstruction and recovery of disaster-affected households. Only one rural municipality has a Ward Disaster Management Committee (WDMC), and none of the rural municipalities have a dedicated committee/unit/wing for disaster response. Two rural municipalities have an emergency warehouse, and two have stockpiled emergency equipment and materials. However, there are no guidelines or SOPs available for emergency warehouse management. No provision of DRR volunteers or their training and equipment is reported in rural municipalities.

For details on these Findings, please refer to the following Annexes:

Annex 8.5.3: Supporting Documentation regarding Status of Policy, Structures, Operations and Fund (Local)

Table 15: Status of Structures at Local Level

4.3.4c Operation, Coordination, and Collaboration for DRRM at Municipal/Local Level

The assessment question focuses on various aspects related to coordination, collaboration, and resources in disaster response and recovery activities at different types of municipalities. Here is the analysis:

- **Metropolitan:** The single metropolitan municipality has reported coordination and collaboration between the municipal government/LDMC and the DDMC/CAO and the Province Government for disaster response. Similarly, it has reported coordination and collaboration with the DDMC, Province Government, and the federal government for reconstruction and recovery. There is no mention of sufficient technical human resources for reconstruction and recovery activities at the Palika level, nor any mention of human resources trained on the process of reconstruction and recovery. The metropolitan municipality has implemented both disaster preparedness activities and reconstruction and recovery activities.
- **Sub Metropolitan:** Both sub-metropolitan municipalities have reported coordination and collaboration between the municipal government/LDMC and the DDMC/CAO and the Province Government for disaster response. Likewise, both sub-metropolitan municipalities have reported coordination and collaboration with the DDMC, Province Government, and the federal government for reconstruction and recovery. None of the sub-metropolitan municipalities have sufficient technical human resources for reconstruction and recovery activities at the Palika level. One sub-metropolitan municipality has reported having human resources trained on the process of reconstruction and recovery. One sub-metropolitan municipality has implemented disaster preparedness activities, while the other has implemented reconstruction and recovery activities.
- **Municipalities:** Three municipalities have reported coordination and collaboration between the municipal government/LDMC and the District Disaster Management Committee (DDMC)/Chief Administrative Officer (CAO) and the Province Government for disaster response. The same three municipalities have also reported coordination and collaboration with the DDMC, Province Government, and the federal government for reconstruction and recovery. None of the municipalities have sufficient technical human resources for reconstruction and recovery activities at the Palika level. Only one municipality has reported having human resources trained on the process of reconstruction and recovery. Two municipalities have implemented disaster preparedness activities, and three municipalities have implemented reconstruction and recovery activities.
- **Rural Municipalities:** All eight rural municipalities have reported coordination and collaboration between the municipal government/LDMC and the DDMC/CAO and the Province Government for disaster response. Similarly, all eight rural municipalities have reported coordination and collaboration with the DDMC, Province Government, and the federal government for reconstruction and recovery. None of the rural municipalities have sufficient technical human resources for reconstruction and recovery activities at the Palika level. Only one rural municipality has reported having human resources trained on the process of reconstruction and recovery. None of the

rural municipalities have implemented disaster preparedness activities, but all eight have implemented reconstruction and recovery activities.

In summary, the analysis shows that municipalities, rural municipalities, and sub-metropolitan municipalities have reported coordination and collaboration with various levels of government for disaster response and reconstruction and recovery. However, the availability of technical human resources and trained personnel for reconstruction and recovery is generally limited across the different types of municipalities. The implementation of disaster preparedness activities varies, with some municipalities showing progress in this area. The implementation of reconstruction and recovery activities is more prominent among rural municipalities. These findings suggest the need for increased technical resources, training programs, and efforts to strengthen disaster preparedness activities across all types of municipalities.

For details on these Findings, please refer to the following Annexes:

Annex 8.5.3: Supporting Documentation regarding Status of Policy, Structures, Operations and Fund (Local)

Table 16: Status of Operations, Coordination and Collaboration at Local Level

4.3.4d DRRM Fund available at Municipal/Local Level

The analysis indicates the following findings across different types of municipalities:

- **Metropolitan:** The study team had conducted assessment with only one metropolitan city i.e. Pokhara metropolitan city. The metropolitan city is reported to have both a dedicated fund (*Bipad Kosh*) and annual budget allocations for Disaster Risk Reduction and Management (DRRM). They have also developed a fund mobilization guideline. However, there is no mention of a dedicated fund for reconstruction and recovery. The metropolitan city has a provision for cash distribution and in-kind support. In terms of budget allocation, they have allocated 0.5% or more of the total budget for DRRM.
- **Sub Metropolitan:** Both sub-metropolitan municipalities have reported having both a dedicated fund and annual budget allocations for DRRM. However, there is no information regarding the development of a fund mobilization guideline or the allocation of a dedicated fund for reconstruction and recovery. The provision of cash distribution and in-kind support is mentioned. They have also allocated 0.5% or more of the total budget for DRRM.
- **Municipalities:** Three municipalities have reported having both a dedicated fund and annual budget allocations for DRRM. They have also developed a fund mobilization guideline. All three municipalities have allocated a dedicated fund for reconstruction and recovery and have provisions for cash distribution and in-kind support. They have allocated 0.5% or more of the total budget for DRRM.
- **Rural Municipalities:** All eight rural municipalities have reported having both a dedicated fund and annual budget allocations for DRRM. They have also developed a fund mobilization guideline. Similarly, all rural municipalities have allocated a dedicated fund for reconstruction and recovery and have provisions for cash distribution and in-kind support. They have allocated 0.5% or more of the total budget for DRRM.

In summary, the analysis demonstrates that most municipalities, sub-metropolitan municipalities, and rural municipalities in the region have established a dedicated fund and annual budget allocations for DRRM. Additionally, the majority have developed fund

mobilization guidelines. Moreover, the allocation of a dedicated fund for reconstruction and recovery is prevalent across municipalities and rural municipalities. The provision of cash distribution and in-kind support is also widespread. It is encouraging to note that most municipalities have allocated 0.5% or more of their total budget for DRRM, indicating a commitment to disaster risk reduction and management efforts.

For details on these Findings, please refer to the following Annexes:

Annex 8.5.3: Supporting Documentation regarding Status of Policy, Structures, Operations and Fund (Local)

Table 17: Status of Funding at Local Level

4.4 RQ4: Findings on Partnership (R.Q. 4 explored via a review of the findings captured through RQs 1-3):

Considering the changed political landscape in Nepal, what would be the most effective short-term and long-term approaches for GoN (at different levels and different departments) and Partners (Donors, INGOs, Private Sector) to contribute to the successful localization of (*DRM and*) the housing and the settlement recovery process?

Based on the network analysis, capacity assessment and findings on the status of existing DRM policies and its alignment at three levels of government and four levels of DRM governance structure, the study has identified key opportunities for further priorities and future engagement of relevant stakeholders with GoN to contribute to the successful localization of DRRM process. Some of the key areas identified are as follows:

- Efficient and effective information management system to track DRRM activities across the country to support decision making on external and internal resources allocation and its maximization.
- Systematized monitoring and evaluation system of DRRM actions across the country, including integrated reporting system for DRRM activities at NDRRMA.
- Strengthen NDRRMA to support in effective localization of inclusive DRRM by capacitating provincial and local government to enhance their effective leadership in local DRRM activities. This includes developing standard tools and techniques on inclusive disaster preparedness, relief, response and recovery for DRRM localization.
- Standardization and operationalization of integrated climate and DRRM policies & guidelines at three levels of government, multi-hazard risk assessment, detailed damage assessment, and investment for inclusive disaster preparedness, response, reconstruction and recovery.
- Strengthen and support NDRRMA and local government for tracking loss and damage caused due to climate induced disasters and accessing loss and damage fund for Nepal.

5. RECOMMENDATIONS

The findings from the **Localization Study on Nepal's Disaster Risk Management Governance** centers on the inter-relationship among federal, provincial, and local governments and policy regulation for partner organizations' involvement. In consideration of these findings and their immediate and more long-term implications within the context of effective implementation of the Disaster Risk Reduction National Strategic Plan of Action (NSPoA) 2018-2030, the following Recommendations one in on common strengths, gaps, driving factors, and best opportunities. These recommendations are therefore proposed as priorities for the Government of Nepal (GoN) and Partners (Donors, International and National Non-Governmental Organizations, and Private Sector) as a roadmap for funding to increase the impact of the country's NSPoA. Recommendations are presented according to emergent themes as revealed in the study, within their corresponding domains of Disaster Risk Reduction and Management (DRRM) including Disaster Relief and Recovery (DR&R):

- Delineation of Roles and Responsibilities
- Measuring Resource Allocation and Impact
- Measuring Improvement Priorities in DRRM Performance
- Prioritization of Vulnerable and Marginalized Populations
- Finalization of NDCRF at National Level and its Roll-Out
- Empowering Local Governments for Local Leadership in DRRM
- Standardization of Tools and Techniques for Greater Impact
- Resources Management and Tracking

5.1 Recommendations - Disaster Risk Reduction and Management (DRRM)

5.1.1 DRRM Recommendation 1 - Delineation of Roles and Responsibilities on DRRM between three levels of government

The network analysis shows the position of NDRRMA as Nepal's apex DRRM institution. Its influence at the at the province level is however weak. In context of federalization, there should be a clear delineation of roles and responsibilities between three levels of government depending on the nature and extent of disasters.

Aligned with the National Strategic Plan of Action (NSPOA) Priority Area 2, it is recommended that the Ministry of Home Affairs (MoHA) and NDRRMA should clearly define the roles and responsibilities of federal, provincial, and local governments within the DRRM constitutional and legal framework. This should focus on effective decentralization to the local level based on a proposed four-level disaster grading system (L0-L3), as well as the implementation of a coordinating mechanisms to avoid duplication of DRRM efforts.

- **DRRM Sub-Recommendation 1.a**

It is recommended that NDRRMA revise its organogram with a clear delineation of roles and responsibilities that are in alignment with the NSPoA.

5.1.2 DRRM Recommendation 2 – Measuring Resources Allocation and Impact

Capacity assessment shows that there is a need of skilled and trained human resources as well as financial resources at provincial and municipal level. Though municipal government and

provincial government have some budgetary allocation for DRRM, it is only directed towards disaster response. The need of skilled and trained human resources is a requirement in all four stages of preparedness, response, reconstruction and recovery. Municipal government should have multi-hazard approach in understanding risk, developing governance structure, preparedness for emergency response and in reconstruction and recovery for building back better and leaving no one behind. NDRRMA also needs to build its technical capacity and have adequate budget so that it can support at federal, provincial and municipal level in DRRM. E.g, multi-hazard risk assessment, early warning systems for multi-hazard, anticipatory actions, etc.

- **DRRM Sub-Recommendation 2.a**

In alignment with NSPoA Priority Area 4 and National Disaster and Climate Resilience Framework (NDCRF) Priority Area 5, it is recommended as a key priority that National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA) establish an information management system to track DRRM efforts across the country to support decision making on external and internal resources allocation.

As an integral component to systematized monitoring and evaluation of DRRM efforts across the country it is recommended that an integrated reporting system for DRRM activities be created at NDRRMA with provincial and municipal control and access to provincial government to support the accounting of all investments made per Sendai Framework and other national commitments.

- **DRRM Sub-Recommendation 2.b**

As an integral component to systematized monitoring and evaluation of DRRM efforts integrating investment of Partners of the Government of Nepal (GoN) across the country, it is recommended that an integrated reporting system for DRRM activities and proposals to be tracked jointly with the Social Welfare Council with support from the Association of International Organizations and the National Housing and Settlements Resilience Platform (NHSRP).

- **DRRM Sub-Recommendation 2.c**

It is recommended to develop the integrated proposal and activity tracking system with budget for all GoN Partners that are implementing disaster risk reduction activities. With system access for internal and external actors to update information, the public will have access to general information related to all disaster risk reduction projects approved to operate in Nepal.

5.1.3 DRRM Recommendation 3 – Measuring Improvement Priorities in DRRM Performance

As an integral component of standardized monitoring and evaluation of disaster risk reduction and management (DRRM) efforts in the country, it is recommended as a key priority that National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA) should establish protocols and define roles and responsibilities to report on the NSPoA performance indicators and define milestones towards achieving objectives till 2030.

- **DRRM Sub-Recommendation 3.a**

Correspondingly, as an integral component to measuring improvement priorities in DRRM performance at local level, it is recommended that the Ministry of Federal Affairs and General Administration (MoFAGA) revise the Local Government Institutional Capacity Self-Assessment (LISA) assessment tool to include a DRRM performance indicator to create an incentive for Local Government to increase their DRRM initiatives and impact.

- **DRRM Sub-Recommendation 3.b**

It is recommended that municipal level capacity assessment results be published annually by each municipality and the Ministry of Federal Affairs and General Administration (MoFAGA) on their websites, indicating categorized and prioritized areas jointly identified for capacity strengthening.

- **DRRM Sub-Recommendation 3.c**

It is recommended that the Ministry of Home Affairs (MoHA), in coordination with NDRRMA, ensure a systematic annual reporting process against the NSPoA performance indicators. The use of a standardized reporting template is recommended as part of an integrated management system that can efficiently generate progress reports as needed.

5.1.4 DRRM Recommendation 4 – Prioritization of Vulnerable and Marginalized Populations in DRRM

It is recommended as a key priority that in alignment with the Social Security Act, 2018, Local Governments identify and maintain database on vulnerable individuals as well as regularly update this database for anticipatory action and DRM project implementation.

- **DRRM Sub-Recommendation 4.a**

It is recommended to National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA) to develop Guidelines for Shock -responsive social protection system to be implemented by all local authorities for the identification of vulnerable populations within their municipalities, and to guide investment in the mechanisms to support vulnerable populations to ensure that no one is left behind during preparedness, response, reconstruction and recovery.

- **DRRM Sub-Recommendation 4.b**

It is recommended for Partners of the Government of Nepal (GoN) to prioritize their support towards operationalizing the shock-responsive social protection Guidelines (*Sub-Recommendation 4.a*), particularly via the provision of inclusive socio-technical support in DRRM. It is recommended for GoN Partners to invest in supporting the most vulnerable, to ensure that no one is left behind during preparedness, response, reconstruction and recovery.

5.1.5 DRRM Recommendation 5 – Finalization of NDCRF at National Level and its Roll-out

It is recommended as a key priority that National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA) allocate resources to finalize the National Disaster and Climate

Resilience Framework (NDCRF), a single integrated framework for both climate change and disaster risk reduction and management during preparedness, response, reconstruction, and recovery, with a series of consultations with stakeholders, provincial, and local government.

- **DRRM Sub-Recommendation 5.a**

In complement to a finalized NDCRF, to standardize the process for development of local level resilience plans and processes, it is recommended for NDRRMA to support all seven provinces to develop Provincial Disaster and Climate Resilience Frameworks (PDCRF), and to support all 753 municipalities to develop Local Disaster and Climate Resilience Frameworks (LDCRF).

- **DRRM Sub-Recommendation 5.b**

As part of the NDCRF development, it is recommended to establish a Development Assistance Coordination and Facilitation Committee (DACFC) to jointly coordinate foreign investment in the presence of Ministry of Foreign Affairs representatives. It is recommended that Partner members of the DACFC include multilateral banks, bi-lateral government authorities, and I/NGOs.

- **DRRM Sub-Recommendation 5.c**

In complement to a finalized NDCRF, it is recommended that Partners of GoN support in capacity strengthening of government at all levels to standardize the process and framework in all seven provinces to develop PDCRFs, and to support all 753 municipalities to develop LDCRFs.

5.1.6 DRRM Recommendation 6 – Empowering Local Governments for Local Leadership in DRRM

It is recommended, in alignment with the National Disaster and Climate Resilience Framework (NDCRF), that Municipalities be supported by National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA) and Government of Nepal (GoN) Partners to develop their own Local Disaster and Climate Resilience Frameworks (LDCRF), which will guide their annual planning and implementation of both climate change and DRRM programs.

- **DRRM Sub-Recommendation 6.a**

To support the empowerment of Local Government for DRRM, it is recommended that NDRRMA in collaboration with one focal agency (with space for more Partners to support) prioritize the operationalization of municipal capacity assessments to inform the development of a comprehensive support package for rural municipalities, municipalities, sub metropolitan and metropolitan cities.

- **DRRM Sub-Recommendation 6.b**

As part of the LDCRF development, it is recommended as a key priority that Municipalities prioritize the development and implementation of DRRM by-laws outlining regulations and guidelines for DRRM within their jurisdictions, with by-laws tailored to the unique risks and vulnerabilities of each municipality.

- **DRRM Sub-Recommendation 6.c**

As part of LDCRF development, it is recommended as a key priority that Municipalities institutionalize actively developing and implementing local disaster preparedness and response planning. This includes the creation of comprehensive and up-to-date disaster response plans that are regularly reviewed, implemented, and updated as needed.

5.1.7 DRRM Recommendation 7 – Effective localization of DRRM requires standardized tools and techniques for Greater Impact

As a key priority and in alignment with the Disaster Risk Reduction National Plan of Strategic Action (NSPoA) it is recommended that National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA) establish standard operating procedures for multi-hazard risk assessment, applicable across the country. These procedures provide a consistent framework for disaster preparedness and early action.

5.2 Recommendations - Disaster Relief and Recovery

5.2.1 Disaster Relief and Recovery - Recommendation 1 - Delineation of Roles and Responsibilities

It is recommended, in alignment with the Disaster Risk Reduction National Plan of Strategic Action (NSPoA) 2018-2030, that the National Council of Disaster Risk Reduction and Management chaired by Rt. Hon. Prime Minister of Nepal, establish a clear delineation of roles and responsibilities among federal, provincial, district and local governments within the constitutional and legal frameworks of disaster relief and recovery. Emphasis should be placed on effective decentralization to the local level, and the establishment of coordination mechanisms to prevent duplication of efforts.

- **Disaster Relief and Recovery - Sub-Recommendation 1.a**

It is recommended for the Ministry of Home Affairs (MoHA) to more clearly define the role of District Administration Office (DAO) in the coordination and monitoring of all relief and recovery activities implemented in respective districts, via endorsement of the National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA) Executive Committee.

- **Disaster Relief and Recovery - Sub-Recommendation 1.b**

It is recommended to maintain a uniform delineation of roles and responsibilities within all Disaster Management Committees (DMC), wherein the elected chair of the District Coordination Committee (DCC) leads District Disaster Management Committees (DDMC) at the local level.

- **Disaster Relief and Recovery - Sub-Recommendation 1.c**

In line with the NSPoA, for the coordinated efforts of Government of Nepal (GoN) and Partners it is recommended that the NDRRMA in consultation with Federal Parliament develop national guidelines for mobilizing GoN Partners with defined roles and responsibilities to collaborate with government efforts for the relief, reconstruction and recovery process of those multi-hazard affected homes and settlements.

- **Disaster Relief and Recovery – Sub-Recommendation 1.d**

It is recommended for the longer-term reconstruction and recovery process that the NDRRMA Executive Committee in consultation with the Ministry of Urban Development (MoUD), Ministry of Women, Children and Senior Citizen (MoWCSC), and the Ministry of Physical Infrastructure (MoPI) establish a mechanism for involving elected provincial and federal parliament members, along with representatives from opposition parties, in the Province and District Disaster Management Committee (DDMC) in district to aid in facilitating and addressing disaster risk reduction and management (DRRM) solutions.

5.2.2 Disaster Relief and Recovery – Recommendation 2 – Prioritization of Vulnerable and Marginalized

It is recommended as a key priority for National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA) in collaboration with relevant ministries such as Ministry of Women, Children and Senior Citizen (MoWCSC), Ministry of Home Affairs (MoHA), and Ministry of Urban Development (MoUD) to incorporate Gender Equality, Disability and Social Inclusion (GEDSI) provisions for inclusive housing design(s) and livelihood support into the current Multi-Hazards Recovery and Reconstruction Guidelines.

- **Disaster Relief and Recovery – Sub-Recommendation 2.a**

As an integral key priority component to ensuring GEDSI provisions in the Multi-Hazards Recovery and Reconstruction Guidelines, it is recommended that NDRRMA include standard guidance regarding identification and inclusion in providing support to the ‘most vulnerable households’ (e.g., additional top-up, etc.) into the Guidelines, to meet the housing needs and livelihood support of the most vulnerable and marginalized

- **Disaster Relief and Recovery - Sub-Recommendation 2.b**

As an integral key priority component to ensuring inclusive Multi-Hazards Recovery and Reconstruction process, it is recommended that Government of Nepal (GoN) Partners prioritize socio-technical assistance and other support to the ‘most vulnerable households’ (e.g., additional top-up, etc.) to meet their housing needs as well as livelihood support

5.2.3 Disaster Relief and Recovery - Recommendation 3 – Resources Management and Tracking

As a key priority, it is recommended that a dedicated unit be established within NDRRMA and coordinate with SWC for protocols around transfer of disaster funding (shelter, housing, land, and relocation) to local municipalities or districts aligned with the scale of the emergency (per disaster grading scale categories L0-L3).

- **Disaster Relief and Recovery - Sub-Recommendation 3.a**

As an integral component of the disaster funding transfer process, to achieve an expedited reconstruction process, it is recommended as a key priority to simplify the fund mobilization process in the case of small-scale emergencies (disaster grading scale L0) by directing grants and resources directly to municipal governments rather than through District Administration Offices (DAO).

- **Disaster Relief and Recovery - Sub-Recommendation 3.b**

It is recommended that the Ministry of Finance in coordination with NDRRMA streamline the disaster fund tracking system for improved efficiencies in implementation and coordination of post-disaster relief and recovery. Specifically, it is recommended that a single budget code be created at the Ministry of Finance as well as sub-codes for all relevant ministries and departments for tracking the disaster response and recovery funds.

- **Disaster Relief and Recovery – Sub-Recommendation 3.c**

As an integral component of the disaster funding transfer process, to achieve an expedited reconstruction process, it is recommended as a key priority to simplify the fund mobilization to the municipal level, in the case of small-scale emergencies (BIPAD disaster grading scale L0) by establishing a separate department or unit for municipal fund mobilization and developing and issuing corresponding guidelines.

5.2.4 Disaster Relief and Recovery – Recommendation 4 – Effective localization of Disaster Relief and Recovery requires standardized tools and techniques.

Recommended actions to support this include:

- **Disaster Relief and Recovery – Sub-Recommendation 4.a**

As a key priority, it is recommended that National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA) establish a post-disaster needs assessment framework for multi-hazards which includes Detailed Damage Assessments and Geo-Hazard Assessments. These procedures should provide a consistent framework for early disaster response and for longer term recovery and reconstruction efforts.

- **Disaster Relief and Recovery – Sub-Recommendation 4.b**

To further promote local leadership in relief and recovery, it is recommended that NDRRMA, in consultation with line ministries, develop comprehensive and integrated national guidelines for reconstruction and recovery with active consultation and participation among Government of Nepal (GoN) and GoN Partners, including National Ministries, I/NGOs, UN, Province Government, Local Government, and Private Sector etc. These guidelines should serve as a framework for housing reconstruction and settlement recovery processes and livelihood support.

- **Disaster Relief and Recovery – Sub-Recommendation 4.c**

To enable channelized disaster communication, it is recommended that NDRRMA establish a single communication mechanism which allows individuals at all levels including at community level to understand, analyze, and communicate risks before, during, and after an emergency.

- **Disaster Relief and Recovery – Sub-Recommendation 4.d**

To ensure Gender Equality, Disability and Social Inclusion (GEDSI) integration in all Disaster Risk Reduction, it is recommended that NDRRMA to the develop GEDSI Guidelines for implementation of DRRM actions by local Government and GoN Partners. This is recommended to be accompanied by capacity building

of provincial, municipal government and recovery stakeholders to support the prioritization of GEDSI mainstreaming in implementation of DRRM plans and procedures.

- **Disaster Relief and Recovery – Sub-Recommendation 4.e**

To ensure green and climate priorities in DRRM, it is recommended that NDRRMA develop the Green Resilient Inclusive Development (GRID) implementation strategy. The GRID strategy should provide the clear communication and guidelines for local government and partners to integrate GRID priorities in all project design and implementation.

- **Disaster Relief and Recovery - Sub-Recommendation 4.f**

As an integral component of standardized post-disaster needs assessment framework for multi-hazards, it is recommended that NDRRMA account Loss and Damage and track the economical and physical impact with disaggregated data per municipality, district, province, and per disaster type in a defined timeline. These data will provide evidence for the Government of Nepal to advocate for accessing global loss and damage fund established at the COP28, especially to support climate vulnerable countries. Furthermore, the NDRRMA and partner organizations should jointly work in strengthening capacity of municipal and provincial authorities to understand the concept of loss and damage, the associated fund and its application for disaster preparedness, response, and recovery.

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8.1 Annexes: Literature Review

Annex 8.1.1 Localization in Nepal

In 2015, Nepal adopted a new constitution, which defined it as “a democratic, federal, and secular republic”, and in 2017, Nepal built a new federal structure, devolving authority to 7 provinces and 753 local governments, known as Municipalities, or *Palikas*.¹¹ In a country where “domestic connectivity is a challenge” and there is a wide range of ethnic and linguistic diversity, federalism is seen as a “more inclusive and fairer representation (which) offers the potential to address geographic and social inequities in access to basic services.”¹²

However, there are concerns that “federalism may increase implementation challenges if responsibilities among different levels of governments in the new structure are unclear, if adequate fiscal resources for delegated services are not provided, or if implementation capacity at the newly created subnational levels is not built. Capacity building at local levels is particularly vital given that “the new responsibilities of planning and financial management in local governments (will) require new skills to ensure service delivery is maintained.”¹³

In the same year as the new constitution, 2015, Nepal was also struck by a devastating earthquake. Over 9000 people died in the *Gorkha* earthquake, and there was widespread destruction and damage to property and resources across the country, with over half a million homes affected.¹⁴ The scale of the disaster, the government’s lack of preparedness, and a “systemic delink” between the government and the people in understanding local needs for reconstruction and recovery are widely believed to be the reasons for the inadequate response and slow reconstruction.¹⁵ A study looking at post-earthquake reconstruction blames the lackluster post-earthquake recovery process on two factors: first, on a political level, “overly centralized decision-making” made it difficult to effectively address local concerns regarding reconstruction-related resources, & second, “at a procedural level”, the study found that the recovery process did not fully understand “the socio-economic aspects of the affected communities”.¹⁶ Both these concerns point to a centralized response being inadequate to an effective reconstruction and recovery effort, in early post-earthquake recovery.

Annex 8.1.2 Federalism and Disaster Risk Reduction Management

The Sendai Framework, adopted in early 2015, seeks to address disaster risk by implementing integrated and inclusive measures institutionally at each level of government and across all

11 Nepal: systematic country diagnostic. (2018). World Bank. Retrieved from: <http://documents.worldbank.org/curated/en/361961519398424670/Nepal-Systematic-country-diagnostic>

12 Nepal environment sector diagnostic: path to sustainable growth under federalism. (2019). World Bank. Retrieved from: <http://documents.worldbank.org/curated/en/141591574193407696/Nepal-Environment-Sector-Diagnostic-Path-to-Sustainable-Growth-under-Federalism>

13 Pokharel, T. et al. (2018). Political economy analysis of post-earthquake reconstruction in Nepal: an assessment of emerging role of local governments. Nepal Administrative Staff College & The Asia Foundation. Retrieved from: <https://asiafoundation.org/wp-content/uploads/2019/02/Political-Economy-Analysis-of-Post-Earthquake.pdf>

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16 Bhandari, D., et al. (2020). Disaster risk reduction and management in Nepal: delineation of roles and responsibilities. Oxford Policy Management. Retrieved from: <https://reliefweb.int/report/nepal/disaster-risk-reduction-and-management-nepal-delineation-roles-and-responsibilities>

sectors with the goal of reducing overall exposure and vulnerability to disasters.¹⁷ Some of the guiding principles of the *Framework* include the aforementioned ‘Build Back Better’, recognizing States as the primary bodies responsible for preventing and reducing disaster risk, a shared responsibility between different levels of government for the full engagement in DRR, and most relevantly, empowerment of “the local authorities and communities through resources, incentives and decision-making responsibilities”.

The Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Act of 2017 (DRRM Act)¹⁸ was the major legal national “arrangement” to the Sendai Framework, incorporating several preparedness measures and forming a new authority to be in charge of DRR at the national level, and creating Disaster Management Committees at local levels. The main objectives of this policy are to increase understanding and awareness of disaster risks at all levels, to strengthen governance for DRR, to integrate it with climate change activities, and to improve systems such as information management and early warning systems.¹⁹ Further, the DRRM Act mandated local levels to form DM Committees, create Strategic Action Plans for DRM and set aside a portion of their annual budgets to implement DRM activities.

8.2 Annexes: Study Methodology and Tools

Annex 8.2.1: Study Sampling Design Supporting Documentation

Table 1: Total Number of Different Types of Local Governments in Nepal				
Metropolitan	Sub-Metropolitan	Municipalities	Rural Municipalities	Total
6	11	276	460	753

Table 2: Types of Local Governments in the Study Area						
Province	Number of districts	Number of Metropolitan	Number of Sub-Metropolitan	Number of Municipalities	Number of Rural Municipalities	Total
Bagmati	13	3	1	41	74	119
Gandaki	11	1	0	26	58	85
Lumbini	12	0	4	32	73	109
<i>*Adapted from MOFAGA, 2023 and website of Bagmati, Gandaki and Lumbini Province 2023</i>						

17 Sendai framework for disaster risk reduction 2015-2030. (2015). UNDRR. Retrieved from: <https://www.undrr.org/publication/sendai-framework-disaster-risk-reduction-2015-2030>

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19 Accelerating localization through partnerships: recommendations for operational practices that strengthen the leadership of national and local actors in partnership-based humanitarian action in Nepal. (2019) Tearfund, Christian Aid, CARE, ActionAid, CAFOD, Oxfam. Retrieved from: <https://reliefweb.int/report/nepal/accelerating-localisation-through-partnerships-recommendations-operational-practices>

Table 3: Municipal Selection Criteria for the Study

Parameters	Description
Ecological Belt	Terai, Inner Terai, Hill, and Himalayan
Multi Hazard Recovery and Reconstruction Case Load	Includes the highest damage caseload affected and eligible for government multi hazard recovery and reconstruction programs.
Disaster Ranking	Includes frequency of disaster incident, casualties, injury, missing persons, number of affected people, total estimated losses due to the eight major disasters (avalanche, earthquake, fire, flood, forest fire, landslide, lightning, windstorm).
Strategic Provinces	Bagmati, Gandaki and Lumbini

Table 4: Selected Districts and Municipalities for the Study

Province	District	Ecological Belt	Disaster Rank	Case Load	Full Name of Provincial Authority	Full Name of District Authority	Full name of Local Authority
Bagmati	Makwanpur	Inner Madesh	11	1	Chief Minister Office - Bagmati Province	District Administration Office, Makwanpur	Hetauda Sub-metropolitan
	Chitwan	Inner Madesh	126	0	Ministry of Internal Affairs and Law, Makwanpur	District Administration Office, Chitwan	Ichakamana Rural Municipality
	Dhading	Hilly	4	0	Division of Housing Building and Urban Development	Armed police force/Nepal Police	Benighat RM
	Kathmandu	Kathmandu Valley	177	0			Shankharapur Municipality
	Sindhupalchok	Hilly	2	416		District Administration Office, Sindhupalchok	Barhabise Municipality
	Sindhupalchok	Hilly	5	395			Helambu Rural Municipality
	Makwanpur	Inner Madesh	89	1			Manahari Rural Municipality
	Nuwakot	Hilly	206	96			Dupcheshwor Rural Municipality

Table 4: Selected Districts and Municipalities for the Study

Province	District	Ecological Belt	Disaster Rank	Case Load	Full Name of Provincial Authority	Full Name of District Authority	Full name of Local Authority
	Makwanpur	Inner Madesh	30	23			Makawanpurgadhi Rural Municipality
Gandaki	Kaski	Hilly	6	38	Chief Minister Office -Kaski		Pokhara Metropolitan city office
	Kaski	Hilly	175	131	Ministry of internal Affairs and law-Gandaki Province	District Administration Office, Kaski	Madi Rural Municipality
	Baglung	Hilly	3	95			Dhorpatan Municipality
	Lamjung	Hilly	31	112		District Administration Office, Lamjung	Marsyangdi Rural Municipality
	Kaski	Hilly	244	170			Rupa Rural Municipality
	Syangja	Hilly	104	484		District Administration Office, Syangja	Palungtar Municipality
	Baglung	Hilly	118	0			Malika Rural Municipality
	Syangja	Hilly	112	132			Waling Municipality

Table 4: Selected Districts and Municipalities for the Study							
Province	District	Ecological Belt	Disaster Rank	Case Load	Full Name of Provincial Authority	Full Name of District Authority	Full name of Local Authority
Lumbini	Rupandehi	Terai	84	0	Ministry of Internal affair and communication	District Administration Office, Rupandehi	Siddharthanagar Municipality
	Rupandehi	Terai	22	0	Ministry of Physical Infrastructure Development	District Coordination Committee, Rupandehi	Butwal Sub-metropolitan City
	Rupandehi	Terai	106	0			Suddhodhan Rural Municipality
	Dang	Inner Madesh, Provincial HQ	15	0			Tulsipur Sub-metropolitan City
	Palpa	Hilly	85	32			Tansen Municipality
	Rupandehi	Terai	113	0			Tilottama Municipality
	Gulmi	Hilly	140	88		District Administration Office, Gulmi	Resunga Municipality
	Rolpa	Hilly	178	17		District Administration Office, Rolpa	Madi Rural Municipality

Table 4: Selected Districts and Municipalities for the Study							
Province	District	Ecological Belt	Disaster Rank	Case Load	Full Name of Provincial Authority	Full Name of District Authority	Full name of Local Authority
	Arghakhanchi	Hilly	105	224		District Administration Office, Arghakhanchi	

Source: NDRRMA Reconstruction MIS system, Bipad Portal, Local Government Institutional Capacity Self-Assessment (LISA)

Table 5: Indicators and Criteria for Grading Disasters				
1. General disaster (Minor Disaster) Statistic Code - L0	2. Moderate disaster (Major Disaster) Statistics Code – L1			
3. Big disaster (Severe Disaster) Statistics Code – L2	4. Mega disaster (Catastrophic Disaster) Statistics Code – L3 (Examples: mega pandemic, mega earthquake etc.)			
Table 6: Disaster Level: Building Integrated Information Platform Against Disaster (BIPAD Portal)				
Indicators of hazard and disasters	Level of disaster			
	General level disaster L0	Moderate disaster L1	Major disaster L2	Mega disaster L3
Number of people killed or missing due to disasters	zero	From zero to 5 people	From 5 to 50 people	More than 50 people
Number of people injured or sick due to disaster	From zero to 10 people	From 10 to 50 people	50 to 200	More than 200 people
Number of disaster-affected families to be kept in shelter (minimum for the period of seven days)	Family number from zero to 10	Family size from 10 to 50	Number of families ranging from 50 to 500	More than 500 families number
Number of families to be provided with food (minimum for the period of at least seven days)	Family number from zero to 10	Family size from 10 to 50	Number of families ranging from 50 to 500	More than 500 families number
Disaster-prone or disaster-affected areas	A local level	More than one local level	More than one district	More than one province
Loss of property and livelihoods	The affected people can recover	The affected people can recover loss &	The local level alone cannot provide	The province level alone cannot provide

	the loss & damages by themselves.	damages through the help of local level.	recovery support to the affected people	recovery support to the affected people.
Availability of disaster response and emergency assistance services (human resources, equipment, material, physical structure)	The necessary resources to deal with the incident are available at the local level.	Available at the local level. If more is needed, the local level can make arrangements.	The local level needs emergency assistance.	The province needs support from the federal level
Potential direct or indirect cascading impact in other areas (causing or leading to other disasters)	Low	Moderate	High	Serious
Contagious, risk of spreading communicable diseases	Low	Moderate	High	Destructive
Primary responsibility for leading disaster response	Local level	Local level (City/sub-metro/metropolitan city) and, DDMC	Province level	Federal level
Possible cooperation	District Disaster Management Committee	DDMC and Province Government	Federal level	Request to international sector/agencies

Annex 8.2.2: Tools Developed and Used for RQ1_Network Analysis

Network Analysis Questionnaire

Section I: Questionnaire for the Network Analysis, Part 1

- 1. Organization full name / Acronym:**
- 2. Office Location (City, District, Province):**
- 3. Focal point name for the network analysis:**
- 4. Focal point position:**
- 5. Focal point email address:**
- 6. Please briefly describe the mandate of your organization:**
- 7. What is the type of your organization? (single answer)**
 - A) Nonprofit
 - B) Government
 - C) Private
 - D) Donors
 - E) Non-Governmental Organizations (NGO and INGO)
 - F) International organizations
- 8. What is the number of staff of your organization?**
 - A) Less than 5
 - B) Between 5 and 50
 - C) Between 50 and 100
 - D) More than 100
- 9. What is the geographic focus of your organization's interventions?**
 - A) International
 - B) National
 - C) Provincial
 - D) District
 - E) Community
 - F) Other
- 10. What are the main programmatic focuses of your organization?**
 - A) Disaster Risk Management
 - B) Housing and Settlements
 - C) Agriculture & Livelihoods
 - D) Education
 - E) Emergency response
 - F) Health
 - G) Justice & Peacebuilding
 - H) Microfinance
 - I) Partner Capacity Strengthening
 - J) WASH
 - K) Governance
 - L) GESI
 - M) Other, specify: _____

11. Briefly describe the role of your organization within the DRM policy implementation.

Section II: Questionnaire for the Network Analysis, Part 2

TO BE FILLED-IN FOR EACH PARTNERING ORGANIZATION - This section of the questionnaire intends to identify all the organizations and actors your institutions are collaborating with in the framework of DRM localization and the post-disaster housing and settlement recovery process. We therefore invite you to fill this questionnaire for each organization you are collaborating with and to provide as many details as you can.

Respondent's name: _____

Organization full name / Acronym: _____

1. Name of the partnering organization

2. Is it a current or potential partnership?

- A) Current B) Potential

3. How can you best describe the type of your partnering organization?

- A) International B) National C) Provincial D) District E) Community
F) Other

4. What partnership have you established with the partnering organization?

- A) Organizational B) Functional C) Implementing

5. Are the roles and responsibilities of each organization and the scope of the collaboration clearly defined in a partnership document?

- A) Yes B) No

6. What type of partnership agreement exists between both organizations?

____ Contract, MoU, Letter, Emails, Others

7. What is the partnership geographic focus?

- A) International B) National C) Provincial D) District E) Community F) Other

8. What is the partnership's programmatic focus?

- A) Disaster Risk Management
B) Housing and Settlements
C) Agriculture & Livelihoods
D) Education

- E) Emergency response
- F) Health
- G) Justice & Peacebuilding
- H) Microfinance
- I) Partner Capacity Strengthening
- J) WASH
- K) Governance
- L) GESI
- M) Other, specify: _____

9. What is your perception regarding your working relationship?

- A) Excellent B) Good C) Fair D) Weak

10. What is the importance of the partnership in the localization process?

- A) Very important B) Important C) Somehow important D) Not important

11. Please list the information and resources shared with the partnering organization over the past 12 months (data, documents, MEAL data, reports, newsletter, emails...)

12. Can you list some examples of collaborations or activities implemented in the framework of this partnership over the past 12 months?

13. Do you have any comments or observations to share for our considerations or to help us better understanding this partnership?

Annex 8.2.3: Tools Developed and Used for RQ2_Capacity Assessments

Questionnaire for Capacity Assessment

1	Identity and Governance	Score	Comments
	Institutional Mandate and Function: The agency/department / ministry has a clearly defined and documented mandate and function.		
1.1	THE ORGANISATION HAS CLEARLY DEFINED STRATEGY FOR EFFECTIVE ENGAGEMENT WITH PARTNERS		

1.2	THE ORGANIZATION HAS LAWS, RULES, POLICIES, ACTION PLAN, GUIDELINES, AND MANUALS FOR DRRM LOCALIZATION.		
1.3	THE ORGANIZATION HAS AN INSTITUTIONAL STRUCTURE (DISASTER DEPARTMENT/DIVISION/UNIT/SECTION) TO LOOK AFTER THE IMPLEMENTATION OF THE ORGANIZATION'S DRRM RELATED ACTIVITIES.		
1.4	THE ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES OF THE DISASTER DEPARTMENT/DIVISION/UNIT/SECTION ARE CLEARLY DEFINED UNDER THE EXISTING POLICY FRAMEWORK, LAWS.		
1.5	THE STAFF MEMBERS HAVE A UNIFORM UNDERSTANDING OF THEIR ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES WITHIN EXISTING POLICY FRAMEWORK, LAW AND BY-LAWS FOR DRR.		
1.6	THE ORGANIZATION STAFF MEMBERS HAVE CLARITY ON THEIR ROLES, RESPONSIBILITIES, RIGHTS, AND DUTIES.		
2	Human Resource Management	Score	Comments
	Human Resource Management: the agency/department/directorate/ministry manages its Human Resources as laid down in regulations and procedures that are known to all staff		
2.1	THE EXISTING INSTITUTIONAL ARRANGEMENT OF HUMAN RESOURCES ARE SUFFICIENT TO IMPLEMENT DRR AND EMERGENCY RESPONSE PROGRAM ACTIVITIES.		
2.2	THE EXISTING INSTITUTIONAL ARRANGEMENT OF EQUIPMENTS ARE SUFFICIENT TO IMPLEMENT DRR AND EMERGENCY RESPONSE PROGRAM ACTIVITIES.		
2.3	THE EXISTING INSTITUTIONAL ARRANGEMENT OF FINANCIAL RESOURCES ARE SUFFICIENT TO IMPLEMENT DRR AND EMERGENCY RESPONSE PROGRAM ACTIVITIES.		
2.4	THE STAFF LOOKING AFTER DRR, AND EMERGENCY RESPONSE HAVE THE REQUIRED CAPACITY AND RESOURCES TO IMPLEMENT THEIR RESPONSIBILITIES.		
2.5	THE STAFF LOOKING AFTER DRR, AND EMERGENCIES ARE TRAINED WITH REFRESHER DRR COURSES FOR KNOWLEDGE AND SKILL ENHANCEMENT.		

3	Finance and Operations	Score	Comments
	Financial Planning: the agency/department/directorate/ministry has translated its strategic objectives into multi-annual plans that are drawn up to achieve these objectives. Within this framework annual budgets are approved before the start of their respective periods		
3.1	THE ORGANISATION ADEQUATELY ALLOCATES BUDGET FOR THE IMPLEMENTATION OF DRR AND EMERGENCY RESPONSE PLANS.		
3.2	THE EMERGENCY RESPONSE GUIDELINES/STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE CLEARLY OUTLINES THE EMERGENCY PROCUREMENT AND ASSET MANAGEMENT PROCEDURES FOR EFFECTIVE AND TIMELY RESPONSE		
4	Programming, Services and Results	Score	Comments
	Program Management: the agency/department/directorate/ministry ensures that all activities are in line with its mandate and are carried out in accordance with the needs, vulnerabilities and capacities of the targeted beneficiaries.		
4.1	THE ORGANISATION HAS DEVELOPED DRR ANNUAL ACTION PLAN FOR OUTCOME RESULTS ALIGNED WITH NDRRMA DRR PLAN OF ACTION 2018-2030.		
4.2	THE ORGANISATION HAS DEVELOPED DRR AND EMERGENCY RESPONSE PLANS.		
4.3	YOUR DRR AND EMERGENCY RESPONSE PLAN ARE UPDATED AND REVIEWED.		
4.4	STAKEHOLDERS' CAPACITIES TO RESPOND IN DRR AND EMERGENCIES ARE MAPPED. (INCLUDES GOVERNMENT AGENCIES, I/NGOS, CBOS, PRIVATE SECTOR, GROUPS).		
4.5	THE ORGANISATION HAS STRATEGY/GUIDELINES IN PLACE TO COORDINATE WITH OTHER NATIONAL/INTERNATIONAL HUMANITARIAN AGENCIES AND GOVERNMENT AGENCIES/DEPARTMENTS FOR DRR AND EMERGENCY RESPONSE.		
4.6	THE ORGANISATION IDENTIFIES AND PRIORITISE THE NEEDS OF THE MOST VULNERABLE COMMUNITY MEMBERS IN THEIR PROGRAMMES.		

4.7	THE ORGANISATION SUPPORTS HOUSING RECOVERY AND RECONSTRUCTION WORK OF THE MULTI- DISASTER AFFECTED HOUSEHOLDS.		
4.8	THE ORGANISATION COLLECTS AND MANAGES THE DISASTER RISK (HAZARD, EXPOSURE, VULNERABILITY, CAPACITY) INFORMATION FOR THE DECISION MAKING ON DRR AND EMERGENCY RESPONSE.		
5	Monitoring and Evaluation	Score	Comments
	Monitoring and Evaluation		
5.1	THE ORGANISATION HAS DEVELOPED A MONITORING AND EVALUATION SYSTEM FOR DRM.		
5.2	ANALYSIS OF EVALUATIONS, AUDITS, REVIEWS, FEEDBACK, AND COMPLAINTS ARE UNDERTAKEN FOR LEARNING PURPOSES AND SHARED WITH RELEVANT STAKEHOLDERS.	3	
5.3	THE ORGANISATION HAS A CLEAR REPORTING MECHANISM FROM LOCAL LEVEL TO PROVINCIAL AND CENTRAL LEVEL.	3	
5.4	BENEFICIARIES ARE INVOLVED DURING PLANNING, IMPLEMENTATION, AND MONITORING OF DRR AND EMERGENCY RESPONSE ACTIVITIES.	3	
5.5	THE ORGANISATION COLLECTS DRR DATA DISAGGREGATED BY SEX, AGE, ETHNICITY, VULNERABILITY TYPES (SENIOR CITIZEN, PWDS, CHILD HEADED HOUSEHOLD).	3	
6	Communications	Score	Comments
	Information sharing: the agency/department/directorate/ministry informs stakeholders in an ordered and transparent way about its work and performance		
6.1	THE ORGANISATION USES EFFECTIVE COMMUNICATION CHANNELS AND APPROPRIATE LANGUAGE TO INFORM DIFFERENT GROUPS AND AT-RISK PEOPLE AND COMMUNITIES ABOUT THE DISASTER RISK, RECOMMENDED MITIGATIVE ACTIONS, AND SITUATION UPDATES.	2	
6.2	THE ORGANISATION ENSURES THAT BENEFICIARIES HAVE ACCESS TO ACCURATE AND TIMELY	3	

	INFORMATION AND ENCOURAGES PARTICIPATION IN EVERY STAGE OF DRR AND EMERGENCY RESPONSE.		
6.3	THE ORGANISATION COORDINATES AND COMMUNICATES WITH DRR ACTORS FOR SHARING AND LEARNING PROCESS.	4	
6.4	THE COORDINATION BETWEEN THE LOCAL GOVERNMENT AND DISTRICT LEVEL STAKEHOLDERS FOR DRR AND EMERGENCY RESPONSE ARE EFFECTIVE AND EFFICIENT.	4	
6.5	THE DELINEATION OF ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES BETWEEN FEDERAL, PROVINCIAL, AND LOCAL GOVERNMENT ARE CLEARLY DEFINED AND COMMUNICATED.	4	
7	Safeguarding	Score	Comments
	Ethics and staff conduct: the Institution adheres to a Code of Ethics and Code of Conduct for Staff based on international standards		
7.1	A FORMAL AND APPROPRIATE COMPLAINTS HANDLING PROCEDURES FOR STAFF AND STAKEHOLDERS ARE IN PLACE AND APPLIED.	4	
7.2	ALL RESPONSES ARE REVIEWED AGAINST PAST RESPONSES, COMPLAINTS, AND ALLEGATIONS FOR NECESSARY CORRECTIVE ACTIONS.	4	
8	Information Communication Technology (ICT)	Score	Comments
8.1	CAPACITY ON DATA COLLECTION USING ICT.	3	
8.2	CAPACITY ON DATA, IT EQUIPMENT MANAGEMENT AND TROUBLESHOOTING.	3	
8.3	CAPACITY TO ANALYSE LONGITUDINAL DATABASES AND PROVIDE ANALYTICS FOR DECISION MAKING.	3	
8.4	CAPACITY TO VISUALISE THE INFORMATION USING INFOGRAPHICS AND MAPS.	4	
8.5	CAPACITY FOR WEBSITE MANAGEMENT AND BIPAD PORTAL UPDATES FOR – DRR INFORMATION AND UPDATES DISSEMINATION.	3	
8.6	DATA COLLECTION USING ICT (DATA ON VULNERABILITY, CAPACITY, EXPOSURE ETC)	3	

8.7	PROPER AND SECURE MANAGEMENT OF IT EQUIPMENT AND POPULATION DATABASE.	3	
8.8	USING INFORMATION FOR DECISION MAKING.	3	
8.9	VISUALISING THE INFORMATION USING INFOGRAPHICS AND MAPS.	3	
8.10	SHARING DRR INFORMATION AND UPDATES THROUGH WEBSITES AND OTHER PUBLIC CHANNELS.	4	

Annex 8.2.4: Tools Developed and Used for RQ3_Policy Alignment - National, Provincial and Local Government

Form 1: Guiding Questions for OPMCM	
1	Is there a dedicated division/section available for DRRM?
2	How is operating the Prime Minister's DM Fund through OPMCM?
3	Is there good cooperation to look after DRRM among all ministries (based on Work Divisions Regulations, 2074)?
Form 2: Questionnaire for NDRRMA and MOHA	
I	POLICY
1	Do NDRRMA consider gaps or missing of any act, policy, guideline especially focusing on reconstruction and recovery? What are the identified gaps in terms of its effective DRM process?
II	STRUCTURE
2	Is there a separate Division/Sections in NDRRMA to look after the reconstruction and recovery process?
III	OPERATION, COORDINATION & COLLABORATION
3	How NDRRMA is implementing DRRM activities and what are such DRRM activities? What are the differences in implementation of disaster risk reduction, response, and recovery and reconstruction activities?
4	How the NDRRMA is implementing reconstruction and recovery process? What is the fund allocated for reconstruction and recovery?
5	Do NDRRMA have a provision of program partnership? If yes, do NDRRMA did program partnership with other government and non-governmental organizations? How does NDRRMA partnership with governmental and non-governmental organizations in normal times and during disasters?
6	How does NDRRMA coordinate and communicate with the provincial government for reconstruction and recovery?
7	How does NDRRMA government coordinate and communicate with DAO for reconstruction and recovery?
8	How does NDRRMA government coordinate and communicate with LDMC for reconstruction and recovery?
9	What are the challenges faced by NDRRMA for monitoring and reporting for reconstruction and recovery programs?

10	How NDRRMA is coordinating and collaborating with donors and partner organization for reconstruction and recovery program?
11	How NDRRMA is coordinating and collaborating with line ministries for reconstruction and recovery?
IV	FUNDING
10	What are the different budget sources for NDRRMA?
11	Does NDRRMA have a fund mobilization guideline? If yes, when it is formed? Is it implemented?
12	What is the mechanism for fund management? If yes, do they have funds for implementation on DRRM activities?
13	Does NDRRMA have a fund disbursement guideline? If yes, when it is formed? Is it implemented?
Form 3: Guiding Questions for MOFAGA	
I	POLICY
1	What are the documents available or developed by MoFAGA for localization of DRRM Act? Implementation status at local level?
2	What are the challenges faced for effective implementation of DRRM Act, especially in terms of COVID situation/Emergency/Crisis and normal situation)
II	STRUCTURE
3	How does MoFAGA coordinate and collaborate with the inter ministry, MoHA, and NDRRMA for development of model laws on DRRM? (Horizontal coordination)
4	How does MoFAGA coordinate and collaborate with the local government for effective implementation of DRRM laws developed at national level? (Vertical coordination) Vertical Coordination – Linkage and coordination with municipal government for effective implementation of DRRM law, acts.
Form 4: Questionnaire for Respondents at Provincial Government Level	
I	POLICY
1	Are you aware of DRRM Acts, Regulations, Procedures, Standards (By-laws) developed at National level? If yes, could you please mention?
2	Has your Province Government developed DRRM Acts, Regulations, Procedures, Standards (By-laws) aligned with National level DRRM By-laws? If yes, please list the name of available DRRM By-laws? a. DRRM Act b. DRR Policy c. DRR Regulation d. DRR Guideline e. DM Fund Mobilization Procedures f. LDCRP g. Reconstruction and Recovery Guideline h. Others - If others, please tell?
3	Are there human resources available to develop DRRM By-laws? If yes, do they have enough technical and financial resources for development of DRRM By-law. If they do not have human resources, how Palika is developing such DRRM By-laws?
II	STRUCTURE
4	Do Provincial Governments have a Provincial Disaster Management Executive Committee (PDMEC)? If yes, what is the composition of PDMEC? Is PDMC formed

	as per DRRM Act, 2017? Is there integration of GEDSI in PDMC? What is the frequency of PDMEC meetings? What are the decisions made and implemented by PDMEC for disaster risk reduction and management in this 1-year time-period?
5	Does the provincial government have a special wing to look after reconstruction and recovery of disaster affected households? If yes, how are they functioning? If not, how is the reconstruction and recovery process monitored at the community level?
6	Does the provincial government have PEOC? If yes, when was PEOC established? Is PEOC functional (Implementation Status)? What are the challenges for operationalization of PEOC? Is PEOC linked with LEOC, DEOC, and NEOC? How does PEOC communicate with DEOC and PEOC? What is the frequency of communication with LEOC, DEOC, NEOC? Frequency of communication: 1. Monthly 2. Quarterly 3. Bi-Monthly 4. Annually 5. Disaster Event Wise 6. Others (Please specify)
7	Does the provincial government have an emergency warehouse? If yes, is the emergency warehouse in an accessible location? Does the emergency warehouse have stockpiling of emergency equipment and search and rescue materials for monsoon induced and fire disasters? Does the emergency warehouse have stockpiling of emergency equipment, search and rescue materials, WASH Kit, NFI Kit, Health Kit? Is their emergency warehouse management guideline or SOP? Is their emergency warehouse management guideline or SOP?
8	Does the provincial government have a provision for DRR volunteers? Please list the DRR Volunteers: 1. first aid task force, 2. search and rescue task force, 3. early warning task force 4. CADRE Others (Please specify)
9	Are DRR volunteers trained enough for disaster response? Are they equipped with necessary search and rescue and emergency equipment? Is there provision of volunteer's mobilization guidelines?
10	Is there enough budget allocated by the provincial government for DRR volunteers management? If yes, what is the allocated budget?
III	OPERATION, COORDINATION & COLLABORATION
11	How is the provincial government coordinating and collaborating with LDMC, DDMC and National Government for implementation of disaster preparedness activities?
12	How is the province government coordinating and collaborating with LDMC, DDMC and the National Government for disaster response?
13	How is the provincial government/PDMEC coordinating and collaborating with DDMC, LDMC and the federal government for the reconstruction and recovery? What are the challenges faced by provincial governments in coordination with different tiers of governments for reconstruction and recovery activities?

14	In the past year, have provincial governments implemented disaster preparedness activities? If yes, what kind of disaster preparedness activities were implemented? What are the challenges faced in implementation of disaster preparedness activities?
15	In the past year, have provincial government implemented reconstruction and recovery activities? If yes, what kind of reconstruction and recovery activities were implemented? What are the challenges faced in implementation of reconstruction and recovery activities?
IV	FUNDING
16	Does the Province have a dedicated fund as well as annual budget allocations on DRRM?
17	Is there a fund mobilization guideline developed by the Province Government?
18	Does the provincial government have allocated a dedicated fund for reconstruction and recovery? How was the reconstruction and recovery fund mobilized? What are the challenges faced in mobilization of reconstruction and recovery funds? Are there enough funds for recovery and reconstruction as per guideline?
19	What is the process for implementation of disaster risk reduction and management activities? What are the differences in implementing disaster preparedness, response, and reconstruction and recovery activities?
20	Does the provincial government have a provision of distribution of cash and commodities? If yes, do they distribute both cash and commodities or they only distribute either cash or commodities?
21	Does the provincial government have allocated a budget on DRRM? If yes, does the allocated budget on DRRM is 0.5% of total budget or more than 0.5% of total budget? What kind of DRRM program is being implemented by the municipal government?
Open-ended question - What are the recommendations at provincial level to make the reconstruction and recovery tasks more effective?	
Form 5: Questionnaire for Respondents at District Government Level	
I	POLICY
1	Does the district have district disaster preparedness and response plan? Are district disaster preparedness and response plan implemented and endorsed by the DDMC?
II	STRUCTURE
2	Do DDMC/DAO have dedicated human resources for search and rescue? If yes, what is the minimum number of human resources available with DDMC?
3	Is there an emergency warehouse at district level? If yes, is the emergency warehouse in an accessible location? Does the emergency warehouse have stockpiling of emergency equipment, search and rescue materials, WASH Kit, NFI Kit, Health Kit? Is their emergency warehouse management guideline or SOP?
4	Do DDMC/DAO have a dedicated section for recovery and reconstruction? Does this section have enough human resources as per the guideline/as per the role? In upcoming days, what roles should DDMC/DAO play to have a good impact on recovery and reconstruction processes?
III	OPERATION, COORDINATION & COLLABORATION
5	Coordination/Linkage mechanism between DDMC and local GoN/LDMC:
6	What is the regularity of DDMC meetings? How frequently do DDMC meet with LDMC and PDMEC?

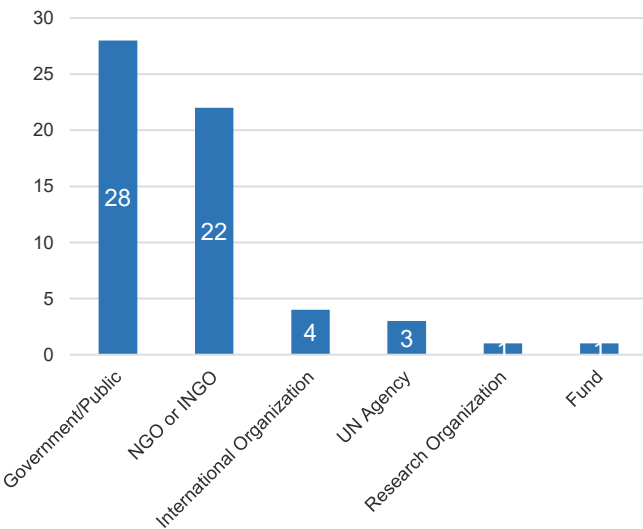
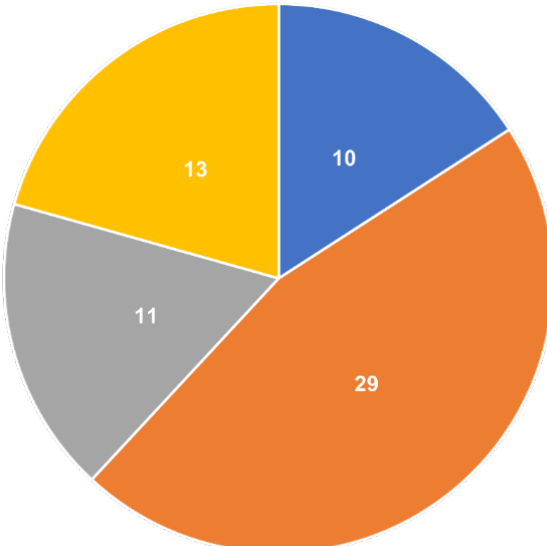
7	What are the roles of DDMC/DAO in the recovery and reconstruction process for disaster affected houses? What is the relationship of DAO with federal, provincial and local governments? What are the challenges for the implementation of recovery and reconstruction work at field level? What is the way forward for the effectiveness of this process?
8	Is the current private housing reconstruction and rehabilitation guideline sufficient to address the existing needs at field level? What are challenges faced? Are there any recommendations for effective implementation?
9	Is it possible to engage other district level government agencies in reconstruction and recovery processes? What are the advantages of involving them and what are the challenges involving such govt. agencies?
IV	FUNDING
10	What roles DDMC plays in fund mobilization for recovery and reconstruction processes of affected private households?
11	What are your opinions on ongoing fund mobilization and joint contribution processes for recovery and reconstruction processes of affected private households?
12	Do DDMC have a fund disbursement mechanism? If yes, through Palika or DAO?
13	In upcoming days, what roles should DDMC/DAO play to have a good impact on recovery and reconstruction processes?
Only for DEOC	Is there a DEOC? If yes, when was DEOC established? Is DEOC fully functional 24/7? Is DEOC equipped with IT and emergency equipment? Do DEOC communicate with LEOC, PEOC, NEOC? If yes, what is the regularity of communication such as monthly, quarterly, bi-monthly or need basis? Mechanism of coordination and communication between these emergency operation centers?
Open-ended question - What are the recommendations at district level to make the reconstruction and recovery tasks more effective?	
Form 6: Questionnaire for Respondents at Local Government Level	
I	POLICY
1	Are you aware of DRRM Acts, Regulations, Procedures, Standards (By-laws) developed at National level? If yes, could you please mention?
2	Has your Palika developed DRRM Acts, Regulations, Procedures, Standards (By-laws) aligned with National level DRRM By-laws? If yes, please list the name of available DRRM By-laws? a. DRRM Act b. DRR Policy c. DRR Regulation d. DRR Guideline e. DM Fund Mobilization Procedures f. LDCRP g. Reconstruction and Recovery Guideline h. Others - If others, please tell?
3	Do local governments have local disaster preparedness and response planning? Are local disaster preparedness and response planning implemented and endorsed by the municipal government? Are local disaster preparedness and response plan mainstreamed into an annual development plan?

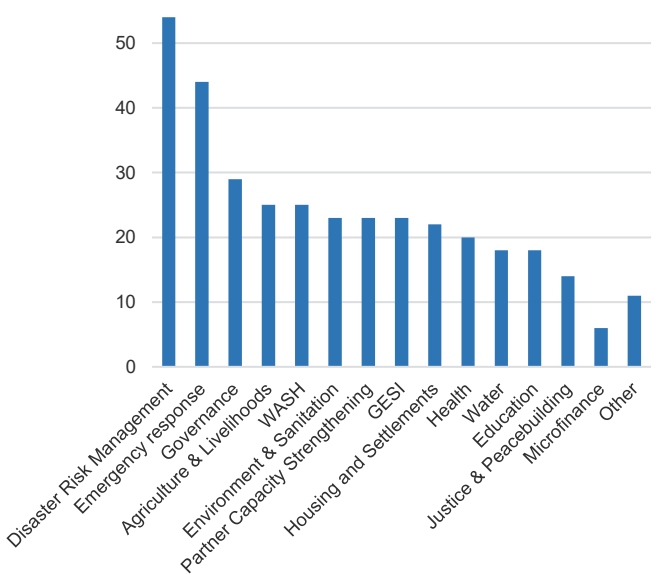
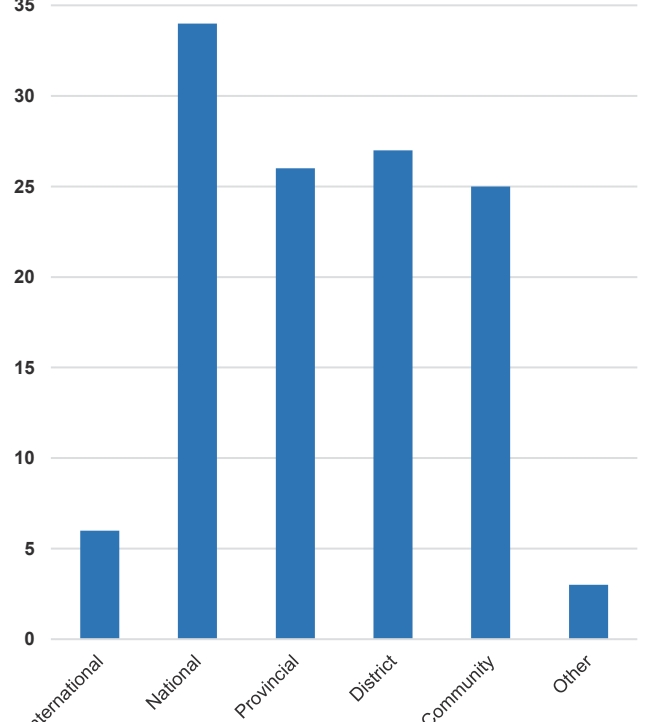
4	Are there human resources available to develop DRRM By-laws? If yes, do they have enough technical and financial resources for development of DRRM By-law. If they do not have human resources, how Palika is developing such DRRM By-laws?
II	STRUCTURE
1	Has this Palika formed its Local Disaster Management Committee (LDMC)? - If yes, what is the composition of LDMC? Is LDMC formed as per DRRM Act, 2017? Is there integration of GEDSI in LDMC? - What is the frequency of LDMC meetings? - What were the decisions made and implemented by LDMC for disaster risk reduction and management in the last one-year time-period?
2	Does your Palika have a special wing to look after reconstruction and recovery of disaster affected households? If yes, how are they functioning? If not, how is the reconstruction and recovery process implemented at the local level?
3	Is there a Ward level Disaster Management Committee (WDMC) formed? If yes, what is the composition of WDMC? - Is WDMC formed as per DRRM Act, 2017 or Palika's DRRM Act, Regulation? Is there integration of GEDSI in WDMC? What is the frequency of WDMC meetings? - How do you maintain a cohesive relationship between WDMCs and LDMC? - Is there a dedicated committee/unit/wing at the local level for disaster response?
4	Does this municipality have LEOC? If yes, when was LEOC established? Is LEOC functional (Implementation Status)? What are the challenges for operationalization of LEOC? Is LEOC linked with DEOC, PEOC, and BIPAD portal? How does LEOC communicate with DEOC and PEOC? What is the frequency of communication with DEOC, PEOC, and BIPAD Portal? Frequency of communication: 1. Monthly 2. Quarterly 3. Bi-Monthly 4. Annually 5. Disaster Event Wise 6. Others (Please specify)
5	Does the municipal government have an emergency warehouse? If yes, is the emergency warehouse in an accessible location? Does the emergency warehouse have stockpiling of emergency equipment and search and rescue materials for monsoon induced and fire disasters? Does the emergency warehouse have stockpiling of emergency equipment, search and rescue materials, WASH Kit, NFI Kit, Health Kit? Is it an emergency warehouse management guideline or SOP? G. Does the municipal government have a provision of DRR volunteers? Please list the types of DRR Volunteers available: 1. First aid task force, 2. Search and rescue task force, 3. early warning task force 4. CADRE 5. Others (Please specify)
6	Are DRR volunteers adequately trained for disaster response? How are they communicated and mobilized during emergencies? Are they equipped with necessary

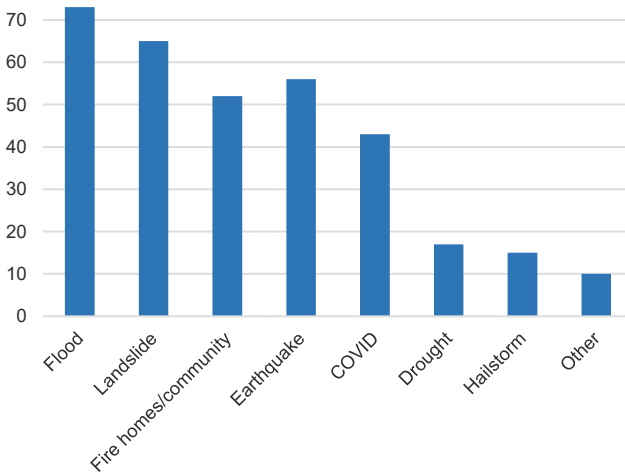
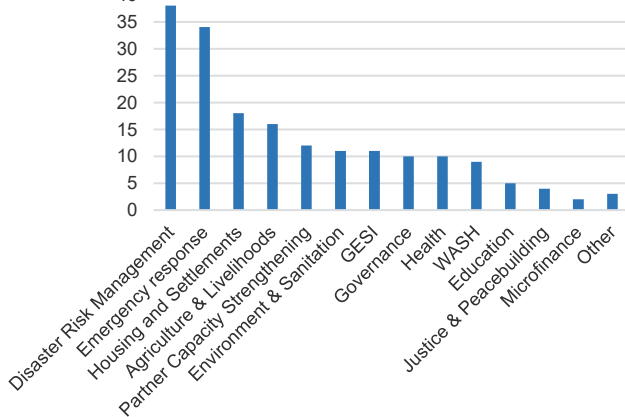
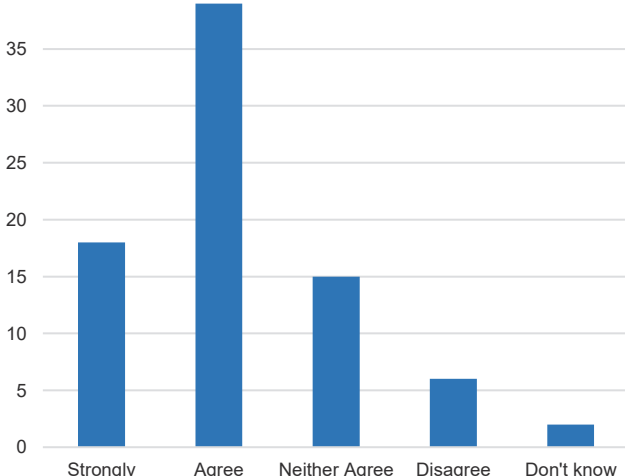
	search and rescue and emergency equipment? Is there provision of volunteer's mobilization guidelines? Is there enough budget allocated by the municipal government for DRR volunteers management? If yes, what is the allocated budget?
7	Does the municipal government have DRRM Networks? What is the name of the existing network and who are the members? Are they regularly working on Disaster Risk Reduction and Management? What are the activities carried out by DRRM networks?
III	OPERATION, COORDINATION & COLLABORATION
8	How is your municipal government coordinating and collaborating with DDMC and Province Government for implementation of disaster preparedness activities?
9	How is your municipal government/LDMC coordinating and collaborating with DDMC/Local Administration (CDO) and the Province Government for disaster response?
10	How is the local government coordinating and collaborating with DDMC, Province Government, and the federal government reconstruction and recovery? What are the challenges faced by local governments in coordination with different tiers of governments for reconstruction and recovery activities? Are there sufficient technical human resources for reconstruction and recovery activities? Are they trained or oriented on the process?
11	In the past year, have local governments implemented disaster preparedness activities? If yes, what kind of disaster preparedness activities are implemented? What are the challenges in implementation of disaster preparedness activities?
12	In the past year, have local governments implemented reconstruction and recovery activities? If yes, what kind of reconstruction and recovery activities are implemented? What are the challenges in implementation of reconstruction and recovery activities?
IV	FUNDING
13	Does Palika have both a dedicated fund (bipad kosha) and annual budget allocations on DRRM?
14	How is the municipal DRM fund mobilized? Is their fund mobilization guideline developed by Palika? What is the process for implementation of disaster risk reduction and management activities? What are the differences in implementing disaster preparedness, response, and reconstruction and recovery activities?
15	Does the local government have allocated a dedicated fund for reconstruction and recovery? How was the reconstruction and recovery fund mobilized? What are the challenges in mobilization of reconstruction and recovery funds?
16	Does the municipal government have a provision of cash distribution and in-kind support? If yes, do they distribute both cash and commodities or just one of the two?
17	Does the municipal government have allocated a budget on DRRM? If yes, is the allocated budget on DRRM 0.5% of total budget or more? What type of DRRM program/ initiatives is implemented by the municipal government?
Open-ended question - What are the recommendations at local level to make the reconstruction and recovery tasks more effective?	

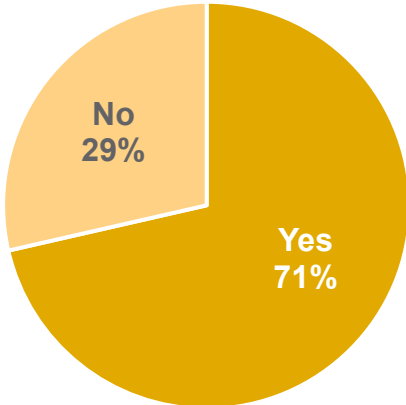
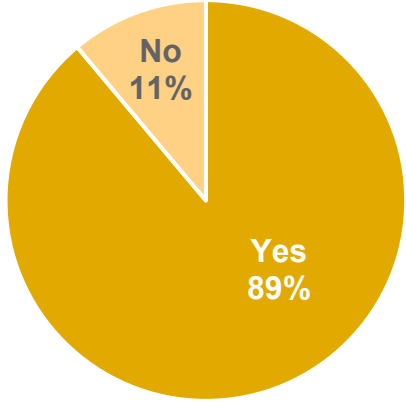
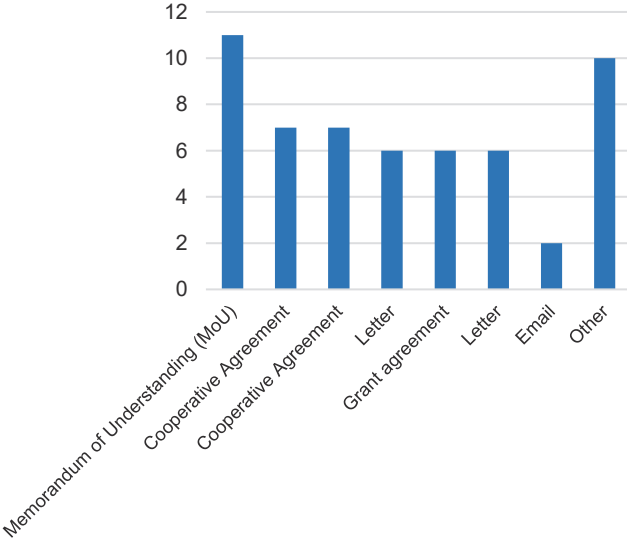
8.3 Annexes: Network Analysis (RQ1 Annexes)

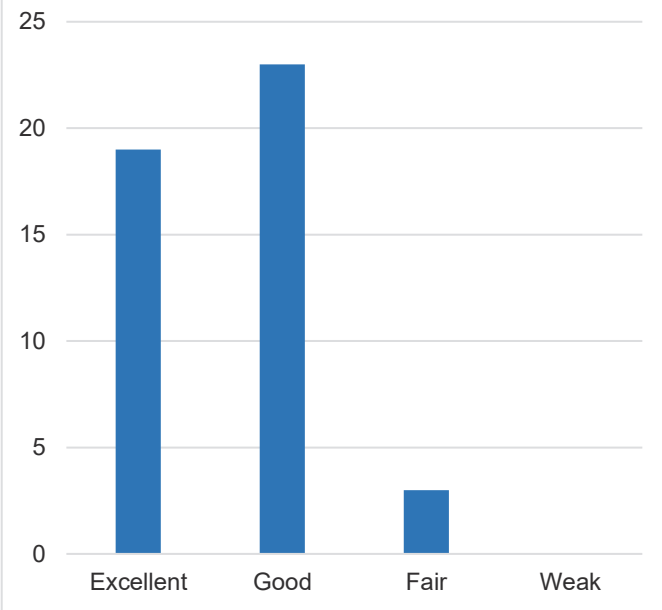
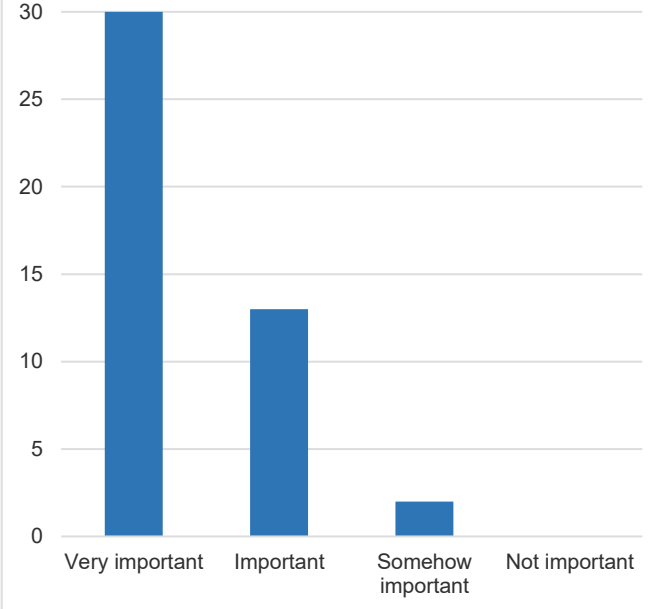
Annex 8.3.1: Results to the Network Analysis Questionnaire

Key Findings from the Inter-Relationship mapping done through Network Analysis																
Q1: What is the type of your organization?	Among 67 organizations, 28 were government/ public organizations, 22 were non-governmental organizations (NGOS), 4 international organizations, 3 were UN agencies, 1 research organization and 1 Fund donor.	 <table><thead><tr><th>Organization Type</th><th>Count</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>Government/Public</td><td>28</td></tr><tr><td>NGO or INGO</td><td>22</td></tr><tr><td>International Organization</td><td>4</td></tr><tr><td>UN Agency</td><td>3</td></tr><tr><td>Research Organization</td><td>1</td></tr><tr><td>Fund</td><td>1</td></tr></tbody></table>	Organization Type	Count	Government/Public	28	NGO or INGO	22	International Organization	4	UN Agency	3	Research Organization	1	Fund	1
Organization Type	Count															
Government/Public	28															
NGO or INGO	22															
International Organization	4															
UN Agency	3															
Research Organization	1															
Fund	1															
Q2: What is the number of staff in your organization?	The number of staff in each of the organizations were explored. In 13 organizations, the total number of staff was more than 100. For 29 organizations, the number of staff were found between 5-50. Around 11 organizations had a number of staff ranging between 50-100. While in 10 organizations, number of staff was less than 5 in number.	 <table><thead><tr><th>Staff Count Range</th><th>Count</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>Less than 5</td><td>10</td></tr><tr><td>Between 5 and 50</td><td>29</td></tr><tr><td>Between 50 and 100</td><td>11</td></tr><tr><td>More than 100</td><td>13</td></tr></tbody></table>	Staff Count Range	Count	Less than 5	10	Between 5 and 50	29	Between 50 and 100	11	More than 100	13				
Staff Count Range	Count															
Less than 5	10															
Between 5 and 50	29															
Between 50 and 100	11															
More than 100	13															

Q3: What are the main programmatic focuses of your organization?	Among 67 organizations, disaster risk management was the programmatic focus of 54 organizations, 44 were focused on emergency response while 22 were found to be focused on Housing and settlements	 <table><tr><th>Programmatic Focus</th><th>Number of Organizations</th></tr><tr><td>Disaster Risk Management</td><td>54</td></tr><tr><td>Emergency response</td><td>44</td></tr><tr><td>Governance</td><td>29</td></tr><tr><td>Agriculture & Livelihoods</td><td>25</td></tr><tr><td>WASH</td><td>25</td></tr><tr><td>Environment & Sanitation</td><td>23</td></tr><tr><td>Partner Capacity Strengthening</td><td>23</td></tr><tr><td>GESI</td><td>23</td></tr><tr><td>Housing and Settlements</td><td>22</td></tr><tr><td>Health</td><td>20</td></tr><tr><td>Water</td><td>18</td></tr><tr><td>Education</td><td>18</td></tr><tr><td>Justice & Peacebuilding</td><td>14</td></tr><tr><td>Microfinance</td><td>6</td></tr><tr><td>Other</td><td>11</td></tr></table>	Programmatic Focus	Number of Organizations	Disaster Risk Management	54	Emergency response	44	Governance	29	Agriculture & Livelihoods	25	WASH	25	Environment & Sanitation	23	Partner Capacity Strengthening	23	GESI	23	Housing and Settlements	22	Health	20	Water	18	Education	18	Justice & Peacebuilding	14	Microfinance	6	Other	11
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GESI	23																																	
Housing and Settlements	22																																	
Health	20																																	
Water	18																																	
Education	18																																	
Justice & Peacebuilding	14																																	
Microfinance	6																																	
Other	11																																	
Q4: What is the geographic focus of your organization's interventions?	Among 67 organizations, 34 were geographically focused at national level, 26 at province, 27 at district level, and 25 at community level. There were 6 organizations which were geographically present at international level.	 <table><tr><th>Geographic Focus</th><th>Number of Organizations</th></tr><tr><td>International</td><td>6</td></tr><tr><td>National</td><td>34</td></tr><tr><td>Provincial</td><td>26</td></tr><tr><td>District</td><td>27</td></tr><tr><td>Community</td><td>25</td></tr><tr><td>Other</td><td>3</td></tr></table>	Geographic Focus	Number of Organizations	International	6	National	34	Provincial	26	District	27	Community	25	Other	3																		
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Q5: What are the most significant disasters in your location?	Floods were the most significant disasters for 73 organizations in their working areas. It was followed by a landslide for 65 organizations, for 56 it was an earthquake and for 52 it was fire risk. (See graph- xx)	 <table><tr><th>Disaster Type</th><th>Number of Organizations</th></tr><tr><td>Flood</td><td>73</td></tr><tr><td>Landslide</td><td>65</td></tr><tr><td>Fire homes/community</td><td>56</td></tr><tr><td>Earthquake</td><td>52</td></tr><tr><td>COVID</td><td>43</td></tr><tr><td>Drought</td><td>17</td></tr><tr><td>Hailstorm</td><td>15</td></tr><tr><td>Other</td><td>10</td></tr></table>	Disaster Type	Number of Organizations	Flood	73	Landslide	65	Fire homes/community	56	Earthquake	52	COVID	43	Drought	17	Hailstorm	15	Other	10												
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Drought	17																															
Hailstorm	15																															
Other	10																															
Q6: What is the partnership programmatic focus?	Out of total organizations 38 (57%) organizations had their partnership focused on disaster management while 34 (51%) organizations had their partnership focused on emergency response.	 <table><tr><th>Partnership Programmatic Focus</th><th>Number of Organizations</th></tr><tr><td>Disaster Risk Management</td><td>38</td></tr><tr><td>Emergency response</td><td>34</td></tr><tr><td>Housing and Settlements</td><td>18</td></tr><tr><td>Agriculture & Livelihoods</td><td>16</td></tr><tr><td>Partner Capacity Strengthening</td><td>12</td></tr><tr><td>Environment & Sanitation</td><td>11</td></tr><tr><td>GESI</td><td>11</td></tr><tr><td>Governance</td><td>10</td></tr><tr><td>Health</td><td>10</td></tr><tr><td>WASH</td><td>9</td></tr><tr><td>Education</td><td>5</td></tr><tr><td>Justice & Peacebuilding</td><td>4</td></tr><tr><td>Microfinance</td><td>2</td></tr><tr><td>Other</td><td>3</td></tr></table>	Partnership Programmatic Focus	Number of Organizations	Disaster Risk Management	38	Emergency response	34	Housing and Settlements	18	Agriculture & Livelihoods	16	Partner Capacity Strengthening	12	Environment & Sanitation	11	GESI	11	Governance	10	Health	10	WASH	9	Education	5	Justice & Peacebuilding	4	Microfinance	2	Other	3
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Microfinance	2																															
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Q7: Does your organization have a clearly defined strategy for effective engagement with partners?	For this research question, 39 (58%) organizations agreed while 18 (27%) had strongly agreed that they have clearly defined strategy for effective engagement with partners. Only 6 (9%) organizations had disagreed. While 2 organizations had no idea.	 <table><tr><th>Agreement Level</th><th>Number of Organizations</th></tr><tr><td>Strongly Agree</td><td>18</td></tr><tr><td>Agree</td><td>39</td></tr><tr><td>Neither Agree nor Disagree</td><td>15</td></tr><tr><td>Disagree</td><td>6</td></tr><tr><td>Don't know</td><td>2</td></tr></table>	Agreement Level	Number of Organizations	Strongly Agree	18	Agree	39	Neither Agree nor Disagree	15	Disagree	6	Don't know	2																		
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Disagree	6																															
Don't know	2																															

Q8: Are you collaborating with any organization in the localization of DRM and the post disaster housing and settlement recovery process?	Among total organizations, 71% were involved in collaboration for localization of DRM and post disaster housing and settlement recovery processes. Only 29% were not involved.	 <table><tr><th>Response</th><th>Percentage</th></tr><tr><td>Yes</td><td>71%</td></tr><tr><td>No</td><td>29%</td></tr></table>	Response	Percentage	Yes	71%	No	29%												
Response	Percentage																			
Yes	71%																			
No	29%																			
Q9: Are the roles and responsibilities of each organization and the scope of the collaboration clearly defined in the partnership document?	The answer to this question was replied as yes by 89% while 11% replied no.	 <table><tr><th>Response</th><th>Percentage</th></tr><tr><td>Yes</td><td>89%</td></tr><tr><td>No</td><td>11%</td></tr></table>	Response	Percentage	Yes	89%	No	11%												
Response	Percentage																			
Yes	89%																			
No	11%																			
Q10: What type of partnership agreement exists between both organizations?	The type of partnership agreement was found to be MOU between the partners in 11 organizations, cooperative agreement in 7, cooperative agreement in 7, (?) letter in 6, grant agreement in 6, email in 2 and the remaining 10 had others.	 <table><tr><th>Partnership Agreement Type</th><th>Count</th></tr><tr><td>Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)</td><td>11</td></tr><tr><td>Cooperative Agreement</td><td>7</td></tr><tr><td>Cooperative Agreement</td><td>7</td></tr><tr><td>Letter</td><td>6</td></tr><tr><td>Grant agreement</td><td>6</td></tr><tr><td>Letter</td><td>6</td></tr><tr><td>Email</td><td>2</td></tr><tr><td>Other</td><td>10</td></tr></table>	Partnership Agreement Type	Count	Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)	11	Cooperative Agreement	7	Cooperative Agreement	7	Letter	6	Grant agreement	6	Letter	6	Email	2	Other	10
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Cooperative Agreement	7																			
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Grant agreement	6																			
Letter	6																			
Email	2																			
Other	10																			

Q11: What is your perception regarding your working relationship?	The working relationship between partner organizations was found good in the majority (23 out of total) of the organizations. In 19 organizations, the working relationship was found excellent and in three organizations it was fair. None of the organizations had weak relationships with their partners.	 <table><tr><th>Perception</th><th>Count</th></tr><tr><td>Excellent</td><td>19</td></tr><tr><td>Good</td><td>23</td></tr><tr><td>Fair</td><td>3</td></tr><tr><td>Weak</td><td>0</td></tr></table>	Perception	Count	Excellent	19	Good	23	Fair	3	Weak	0
Perception	Count											
Excellent	19											
Good	23											
Fair	3											
Weak	0											
Q12: What is the importance of the partnership in the DRM localization and the post – disaster housing and settlement recovery process?	The importance of the partnership in DRM localization and post disaster housing and settlement recovery process was found very important by the majority of the organizations, which is around 45%. Around 19% of the organizations considered it important and 3% considered somehow important. None of the respondent organizations said that partnership is not important for them.	 <table><tr><th>Importance</th><th>Count</th></tr><tr><td>Very important</td><td>30</td></tr><tr><td>Important</td><td>13</td></tr><tr><td>Somehow important</td><td>2</td></tr><tr><td>Not important</td><td>0</td></tr></table>	Importance	Count	Very important	30	Important	13	Somehow important	2	Not important	0
Importance	Count											
Very important	30											
Important	13											
Somehow important	2											
Not important	0											

Annex 8.3.2: Network Analysis Graphics

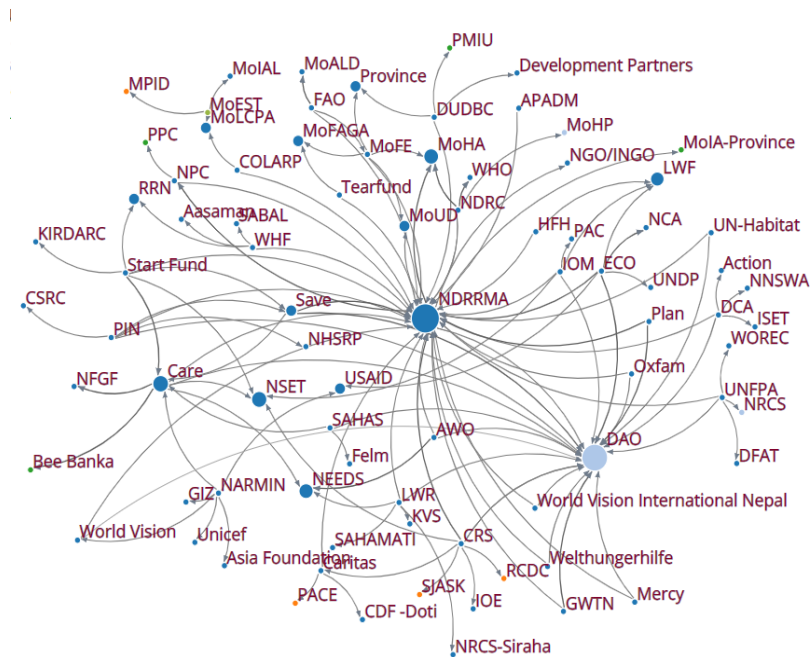


Diagram 1: Network Map of Collaboration at National Level

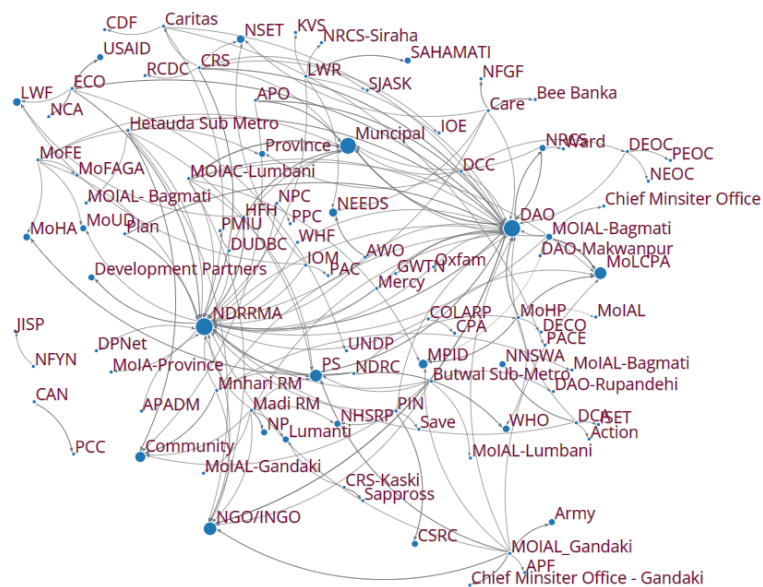
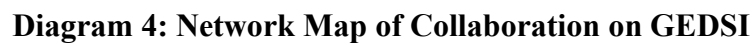


Diagram 2: Network Map of Collaboration on Disaster Risk



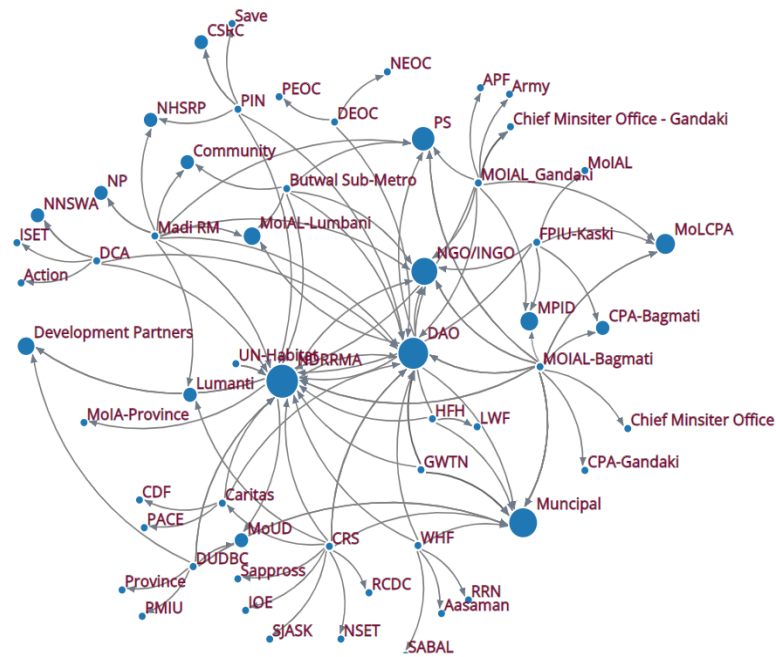


Diagram 5: Network Map of Collaboration on Housing and Settlement

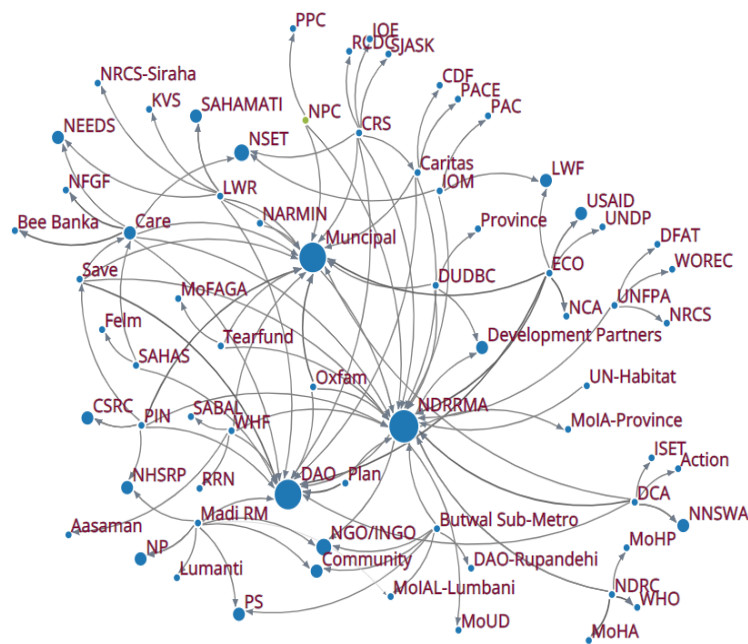
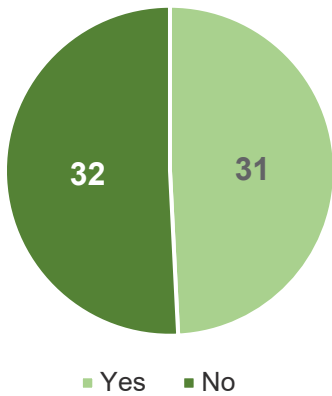
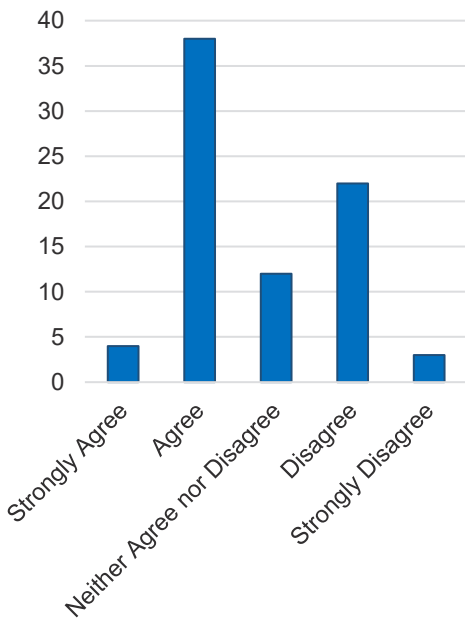
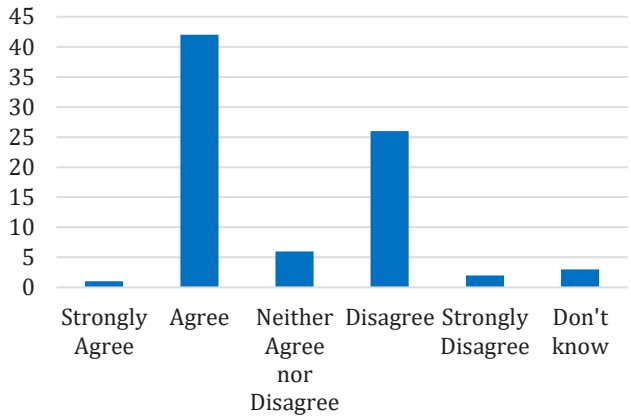
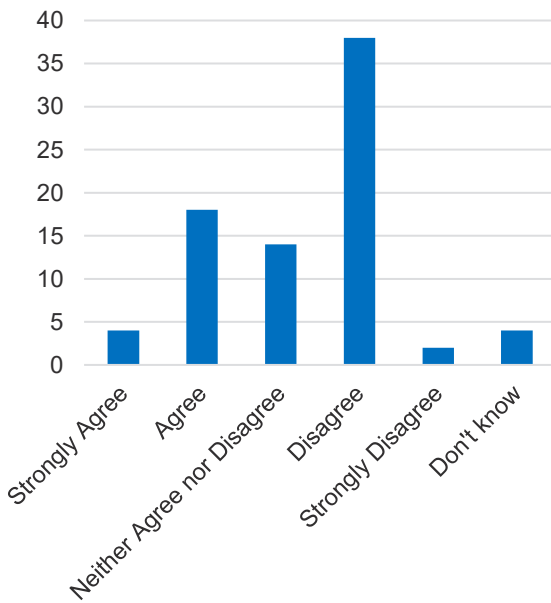


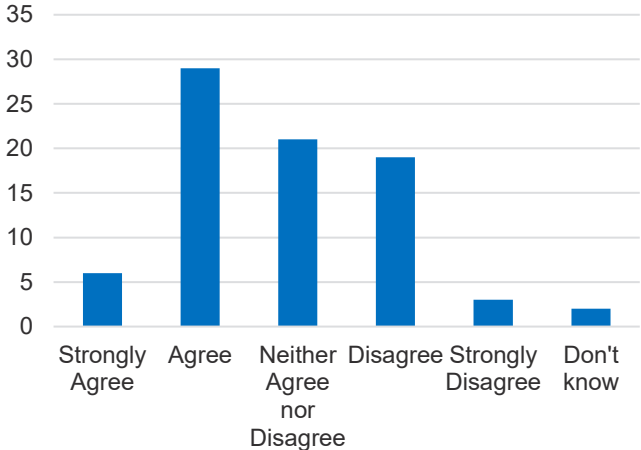
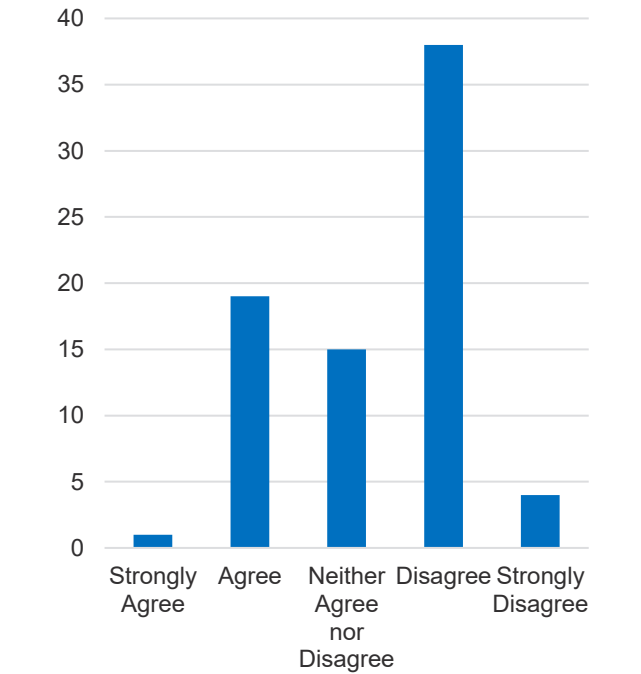
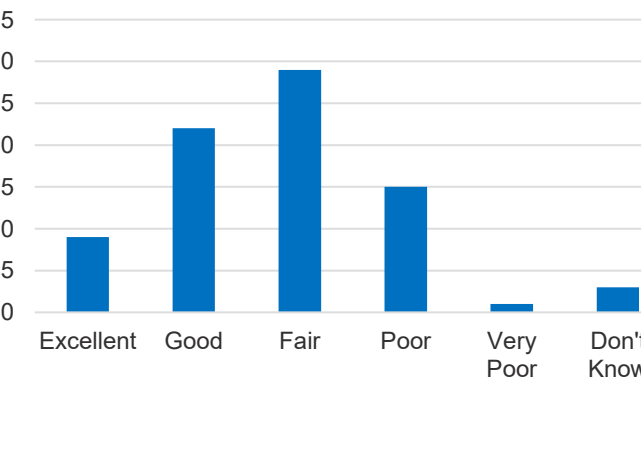
Diagram 6: Network Map of Collaboration on Partner Capacity Strengthening

8.4 Annexes: Capacity Assessments (RQ2 Annexes)

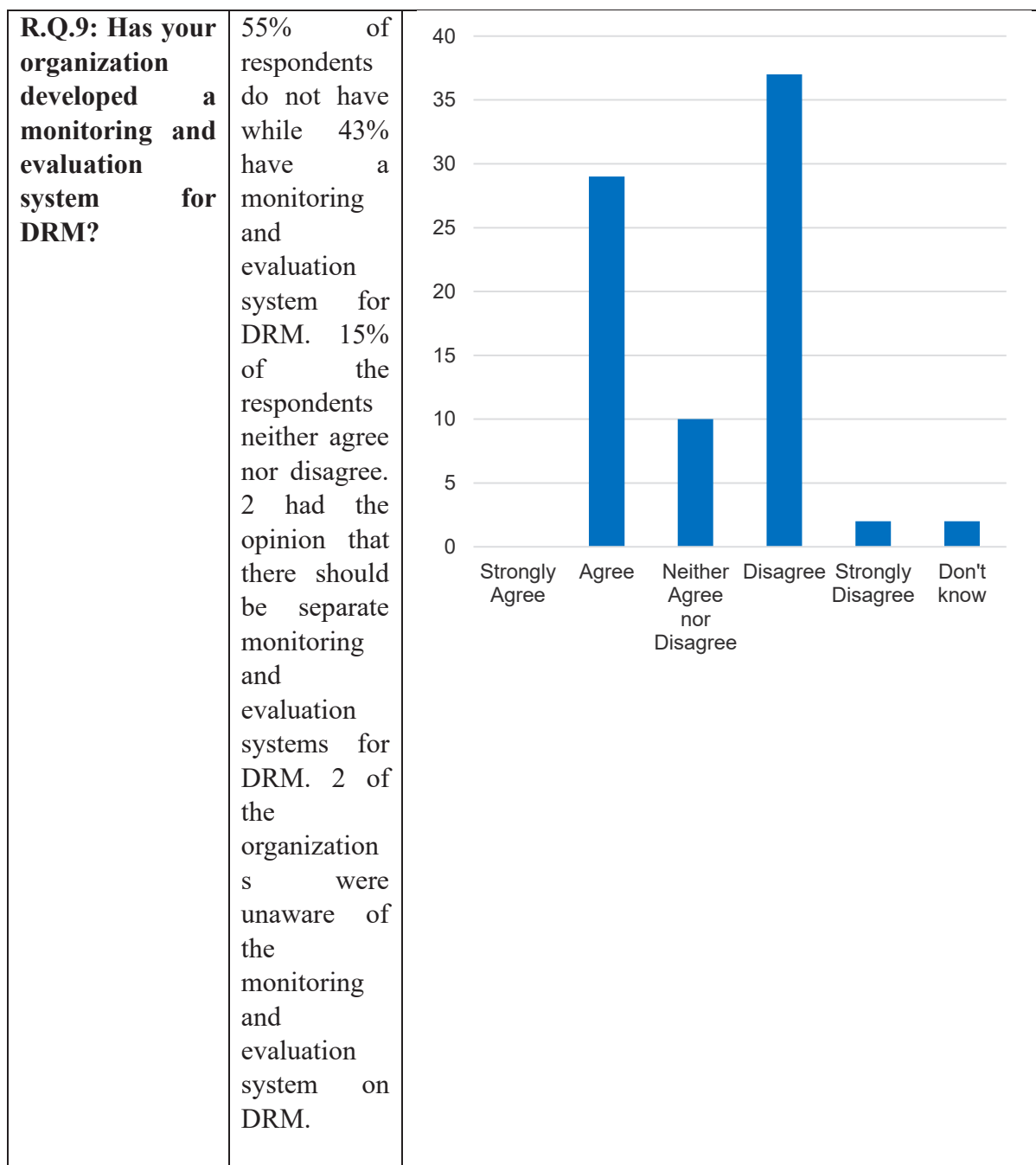
Annex 8.4.1: Results to the Capacity Self-Assessment Questionnaire (by Individual Question)

R.Q.1: Your organization has a separate section established for DRR and emergency response?	To the first question, more than half the organization s (50.79%) involved in the localization process answered that there is no dedicated section or division for DRR within their organization.	 <table><thead><tr><th>Response</th><th>Count</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>Yes</td><td>31</td></tr><tr><td>No</td><td>32</td></tr></tbody></table>	Response	Count	Yes	31	No	32						
Response	Count													
Yes	31													
No	32													
R.Q.2: Are the staff looking after DRR and emergency response have the required capacity and resources to implement their responsibilities.	The majority of organization s involved in the localization process have the required capacities to address DRR and emergency response but 46% of the organization s would require capacity strengthenin g support to meet the NDRRMA technical capacity benchmarks.	 <table><thead><tr><th>Response</th><th>Count</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>Strongly Agree</td><td>4</td></tr><tr><td>Agree</td><td>38</td></tr><tr><td>Neither Agree nor Disagree</td><td>12</td></tr><tr><td>Disagree</td><td>22</td></tr><tr><td>Strongly Disagree</td><td>3</td></tr></tbody></table>	Response	Count	Strongly Agree	4	Agree	38	Neither Agree nor Disagree	12	Disagree	22	Strongly Disagree	3
Response	Count													
Strongly Agree	4													
Agree	38													
Neither Agree nor Disagree	12													
Disagree	22													
Strongly Disagree	3													

R.Q.3: Does your organization have strategy in place to coordinate with other humanitarian agencies and government agencies for DRR and emergency response?	A large majority of the organization s have strategy in place for coordination with humanitarian and government agencies for DRR and emergency response.	 <table><tr><th>Response</th><th>Count</th></tr><tr><td>Strongly Agree</td><td>1</td></tr><tr><td>Agree</td><td>42</td></tr><tr><td>Neither Agree nor Disagree</td><td>6</td></tr><tr><td>Disagree</td><td>26</td></tr><tr><td>Strongly Disagree</td><td>2</td></tr><tr><td>Don't know</td><td>3</td></tr></table>	Response	Count	Strongly Agree	1	Agree	42	Neither Agree nor Disagree	6	Disagree	26	Strongly Disagree	2	Don't know	3
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Neither Agree nor Disagree	6															
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Don't know	3															
R.Q.4: Does your organization have developed DRR annual action plan for outcome results aligned with National government Strategic Action Plan on DRR 2018-2030?	Majority of organization s have not developed annual action plan in line with Strategic Action Plan on DRR 2018-2030	 <table><tr><th>Response</th><th>Count</th></tr><tr><td>Strongly Agree</td><td>4</td></tr><tr><td>Agree</td><td>18</td></tr><tr><td>Neither Agree nor Disagree</td><td>14</td></tr><tr><td>Disagree</td><td>38</td></tr><tr><td>Strongly Disagree</td><td>2</td></tr><tr><td>Don't know</td><td>4</td></tr></table>	Response	Count	Strongly Agree	4	Agree	18	Neither Agree nor Disagree	14	Disagree	38	Strongly Disagree	2	Don't know	4
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Neither Agree nor Disagree	14															
Disagree	38															
Strongly Disagree	2															
Don't know	4															

R.Q.5: Does your organization have a delineation of roles and responsibilities between federal, provincial and local government clearly defined and communicated?		 <table><tr><th>Response</th><th>Count</th></tr><tr><td>Strongly Agree</td><td>6</td></tr><tr><td>Agree</td><td>29</td></tr><tr><td>Neither Agree nor Disagree</td><td>21</td></tr><tr><td>Disagree</td><td>19</td></tr><tr><td>Strongly Disagree</td><td>3</td></tr><tr><td>Don't know</td><td>2</td></tr></table>	Response	Count	Strongly Agree	6	Agree	29	Neither Agree nor Disagree	21	Disagree	19	Strongly Disagree	3	Don't know	2
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Agree	29															
Neither Agree nor Disagree	21															
Disagree	19															
Strongly Disagree	3															
Don't know	2															
R.Q.6: Does your organization have an existing institutional arrangement of financial resources sufficient to implement DRR and emergency response program activities?	Majority of the organization s (56.71%) have financial constraints to implement DRR and emergency response program activities.	 <table><tr><th>Response</th><th>Count</th></tr><tr><td>Strongly Agree</td><td>1</td></tr><tr><td>Agree</td><td>19</td></tr><tr><td>Neither Agree nor Disagree</td><td>15</td></tr><tr><td>Disagree</td><td>38</td></tr><tr><td>Strongly Disagree</td><td>4</td></tr></table>	Response	Count	Strongly Agree	1	Agree	19	Neither Agree nor Disagree	15	Disagree	38	Strongly Disagree	4		
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Strongly Agree	1															
Agree	19															
Neither Agree nor Disagree	15															
Disagree	38															
Strongly Disagree	4															
R.Q.7: What is your organization's capacity level on data collection using ICT?	Among total organization s 43% had ranked themselves as an organization with medium level, 33% with good capacity and 13% only had excellent capacity on	 <table><tr><th>Response</th><th>Count</th></tr><tr><td>Excellent</td><td>9</td></tr><tr><td>Good</td><td>22</td></tr><tr><td>Fair</td><td>29</td></tr><tr><td>Poor</td><td>15</td></tr><tr><td>Very Poor</td><td>1</td></tr><tr><td>Don't Know</td><td>3</td></tr></table>	Response	Count	Excellent	9	Good	22	Fair	29	Poor	15	Very Poor	1	Don't Know	3
Response	Count															
Excellent	9															
Good	22															
Fair	29															
Poor	15															
Very Poor	1															
Don't Know	3															

	ICT for data collection. One of the organization s had very poor capacity while three were unaware on ICT.															
R.Q.8: What is your organization's capacity level on data, IT equipment management and troubleshooting ?	Most of the respondents had fair, followed by good and few had excellent capacity. The trend in R.Q. 2.7 and 2.8 is same as both are based on the ICT capacity of the stakeholders.	<table><tr><th>Capacity Level</th><th>Frequency</th></tr><tr><td>Excellent</td><td>6</td></tr><tr><td>Good</td><td>20</td></tr><tr><td>Fair</td><td>30</td></tr><tr><td>Poor</td><td>20</td></tr><tr><td>Very Poor</td><td>1</td></tr><tr><td>Don't Know</td><td>2</td></tr></table>	Capacity Level	Frequency	Excellent	6	Good	20	Fair	30	Poor	20	Very Poor	1	Don't Know	2
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Good	20															
Fair	30															
Poor	20															
Very Poor	1															
Don't Know	2															



Annex 8.4.2: Comparison Overview of Results from RQ2 Self-Assessment/Guided Capacity Questionnaires

Table 7. Capacity Self-Assessment Scores at National, Provincial and Municipal Levels				
Capacity Area	National Level	Provincial Level	Municipal Level	Average
Identity & Governance	76.84	75	68.94	73.6
Human Resources Management	65.47	62	52	59.8

Finance & Operations	72.11	71	64.44	69.2
Programming	72.89	63	60.81	65.6
Monitoring & Evaluation	76.42	64	55.80	65.4
Communications	77.47	68	64.15	69.9
Safeguarding	82.63	72	62.59	72.4
ICT	77.68	64	57.60	66.4
Average Score	75.19	67.38	60.79	

Graphic 1: Self-Assessment Results Overview at National, Provincial, and Municipal levels

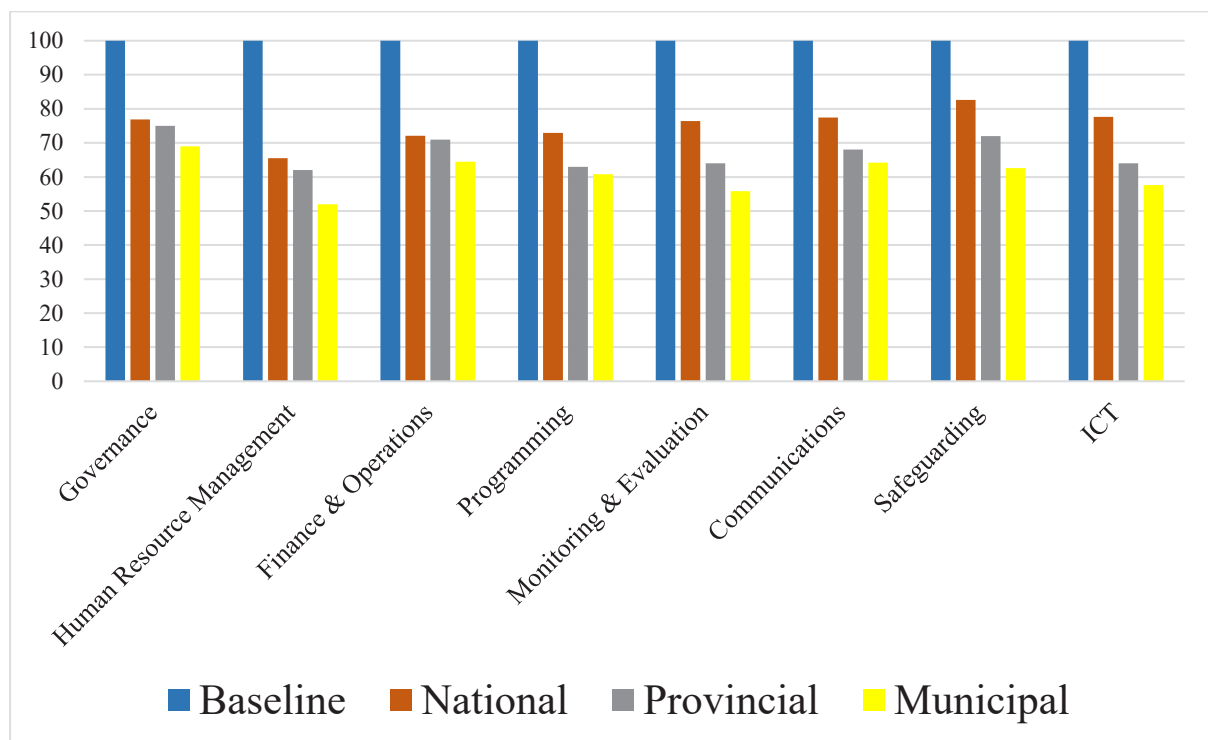
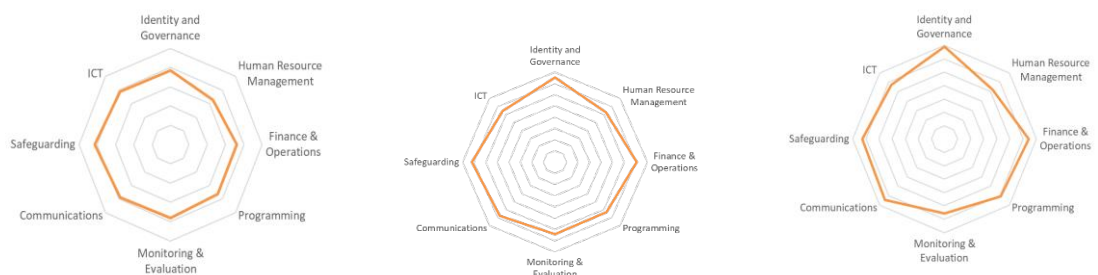


Diagram 1: Below, from Left to Right: National Level, Provincial Level, Municipal Level



8.5 Annexes: Supporting RQ3

Annexes 8.5.1: Supporting Documentation to Findings from National Level Consultations

Table 8: Institutional Capacity of National Level Ministry and Departments on DRRM					
Agency	Policy	Operation/Coordination	Structure	Funding	Residual
OPMC	Prime Minister Relief Fund Operation Regulation, 2063 Government of Nepal (Works Division) Regulations, 2074 DRRM Act, 2074	Coordination for PM Fund Operation Coordination with concerned ministries Getting approval from the cabinet while required.	Disaster Management Section	Not clear	Residual duties to do as per required
MoHA	DRRM Act, 2074 Government of Nepal (Work Divisions) Regulations, 2074	Nodal ministry to look after on DRRM	DM Division 2 dedicated sections	Not clear	Residual duties on DRRM as per need.
MoFA GA	Government of Nepal (Work Division) Regulation, 2074 Local Governance Operation Act, 2074	Nodal ministry to facilitate to local governments	Dedicated section to look after on disaster management	Not clear	
MoUD	Government of Nepal (Work Division) Regulation, 2074	Nodal ministry to look after on urban development	DUDBC is the dedicated department to look after on urban development	Not clear	
NPC	PM Relief Fund Operation Regulations, 2074	PM Relief Fund will operate in the chairmanship of the	Dedicated section to look after	Not clear	

		Vice Chair of the NPC	disaster management		
NDRRMA	DRRM Act, 2074 DRRM Regulations, 2076	National lead agency to look after DRRM Secretariat of the National Council and Executive Committee for DRRM	Chief Executive, two divisions are dedicated to look after on DRRM	1.63 billion regular budgets for fiscal year 2022/23 3.45 billion dedicated Central DM Fund onward	NDRRMA is an authorized agency with delegated powers of the Executive Committee for DRRM

Table 9: Study-Developed Benchmarks for Measuring Capacity at Different Levels-RQ3

	National	Provincial	District	Municipal
Policy	MoHA/NDRRMA 1) Gaps or missing of any act, policy, guideline especially focusing on reconstruction and recovery? What are the identified gaps in terms of its effective DRM process? MoFAGA 2) What are the documents available or developed by MoFAGA for localization of DRRM Act? Implementation status at local level? 3) What are the challenges faced for effective implementation of DRRM Act, especially Especially in terms of COVID situation/Emergency/Crisis and normal situation) MoUD/DUDBC: 1. What are the documents available or developed by MoUD for localization of DRRM Act? Implementation status at local level? 2) What are the challenges faced for effective implementation of DRRM Act, especially in terms of COVID situation/Emergency/Crisis and normal situation)	1) Awareness of DRRM Acts, Regulations, Procedures, Standards (By-laws) developed at National level 2) Availability of Human resources to develop DRRM By-laws 3) Enough technical and financial resources for development of DRRM By-law	1) Availability of disaster preparedness and response plan? 2) Implementation and endorsement of disaster preparedness and response plan.	1) Awareness of DRRM Acts, Regulations, Procedures, Standards (By-laws) developed at National level. 2) Development of DRRM By-laws by Palika 3) Local disaster preparedness and response planning endorsed and implemented by local government? 4) Local disaster preparedness and response plan mainstreamed into an annual development plan. 5) Availability of Human resources to develop DRRM By-laws 6) Enough technical and financial resources for development of DRRM By-law. 7) How Palika is developing DRRM By-laws in absence of trained human resources

Structure	NDRRMA 1) Is there a separate Division/Sections in NDRRMA to look after the reconstruction and recovery process? OPMCM: 2) Is there a dedicated division/section available for DRRM? MoFAGA: 3) Vertical Coordination – Linkage and coordination with municipal government for effective implementation of DRRM law, acts. MoUD/DUDBC: 4) How does MoUD coordinate and collaborate with the local government for effective implementation of DRRM laws developed at national level? (Vertical coordination) 5) Vertical Coordination – Linkage and coordination with municipal government for effective implementation of DRRM law, acts.	1) Availability of PDMC at Palika 2) Composition of PDMC 3) GEDSI Integration into PDMC 4) Availability of PEOC 5) PEOC linked with DEOC, LEOC, and BIPAD portal 6) Availability of an emergency warehouse 7) Availability of an emergency warehouse management guideline or SOP 8) Provision of DRR volunteers at Provincial government 9) Provision of volunteer's mobilization guidelines 10) Allocated budget for DRR Volunteer Mobilization	1) Availability of dedicated human resources for search and rescue. 2) Status of emergency warehouse at district level. 3) Availability of stockpiling of emergency equipment, search and rescue materials, WASH Kit, NFI Kit, Health Kit. 4) Emergency warehouse management guideline or SOP? 5) Do DDMC/DAO have a dedicated section for recovery and reconstruction? 6) Does this section have enough human resources as per the guideline/as per the role? 7) In upcoming days, what roles should DDMC/DAO play to have a good impact on recovery and reconstruction processes?	1) Availability of LDMC at Palika 2) Frequency of LDMC Meetings 3) Availability of a special wing to look after reconstruction and recovery of disaster affected households. 4) Availability of WDMC at Palika 5) Frequency of WDMC Meetings 6) A dedicated committee/unit/wing at the local level for disaster response 7) Availability of LEOC 8) Availability of an emergency warehouse 9) Stockpiling of emergency equipment, search and rescue materials, WASH Kit, NFI Kit, Health Kit 10) Availability of an emergency warehouse management guideline or SOP 11) Provision of DRR volunteers at municipal government.
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				12) DRR volunteers adequately trained for disaster response. 13) DRR Volunteers equipped with necessary search and rescue and emergency equipment.
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Operation, Coordination and Collaboration	NDRRMA: 1) How is the NDRRMA implementing DRRM activities, and what are these activities? 2) What are the differences in implementing disaster risk reduction, response, recovery, and reconstruction activities? 3) How is the NDRRMA managing the reconstruction and recovery process, and what funds are allocated for these efforts? 4) Does the NDRRMA have provisions for program partnerships? MoUD/DUDBC: 1) Recommendations for NDRRMA based on past recovery and reconstruction work from the Gorkha earthquake. 2) How NDRRMA and MoUD collaborate to support recovery and reconstruction activities. 3) Strategies to engage more partners in the recovery and reconstruction process, given the current low partner engagement. 4) Additional recommendations for the ongoing recovery and reconstruction of multi-hazard affected households.	1) Coordination and collaboration of Provincial government with DDMC and LDMC and National level for implementation of disaster preparedness activities. 2) Coordination and collaboration of Provincial government with DDMC and LDMC and National level for implementation of disaster Response activities. 3) Provincial government coordination and collaboration with DDMC, LDMC, and the federal government reconstruction and recovery. 4) Disaster preparedness activities	1) Coordination/Linkage mechanism between DDMC and local GoN/LDMC. 2) What is the regularity of DDMC meetings? 3) How frequently do DDMC meet with LDMC and PDEC? 4) What are the roles of DDMC/DAO in the recovery and reconstruction process for disaster affected houses? 5) What is the relationship of DAO with federal, provincial and local governments? 6) Is the current private housing reconstruction and rehabilitation guideline sufficient to address the existing needs at field level? 7) Is it possible to engage other district level government agencies in reconstruction and recovery processes?	1) Coordination and collaboration of municipal government with DDMC and Province Government for implementation of disaster preparedness activities. 2) Municipal government/LDMC coordination and collaboration with DDMC/Chief Administrative Officer (CAO) and the Province Government for disaster response. 3) Local government coordination and collaboration with DDMC, Province Government, and the federal government reconstruction and recovery. 4) Sufficient technical human resources for reconstruction and recovery activities at Palika. 5) Human resources trained on the process of reconstruction and recovery.
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		implemented (Yes/No). 5) Reconstruction and recovery activities implemented (Yes/No) 6) Provincial Government have both a dedicated fund (Bipad kosh) and annual budget allocations on DRRM		6) Disaster preparedness activities implemented by Palika (Yes/No). 7) List of Disaster Preparedness Activities implemented by Palika. 8) Challenges for implementation of Disaster Preparedness activities. 9) Reconstruction and recovery activities implemented by Palika (Yes/No) 10) List of Reconstruction and Recovery Activities implemented by Palika
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Funding	NDRRMA: 1) What are the different budget sources for NDRRMA? 2) Does NDRRMA have a fund mobilization guideline? If yes, when it is formed? Is it implemented? 3) What is the mechanism for fund management? If yes, do they have funds for implementation on DRRM activities? 4) Does NDRRMA have a fund disbursement guideline? If yes, when it is formed? Is it implemented? OPMCM: 5) How is operating the Prime Minister's DM Fund through OPMCM?	1) Provincial Government have both a dedicated fund (Bipad kosh) and annual budget allocations on DRRM 2) How DRRM fund is mobilized 3) Fund mobilization guideline developed. 4) Have allocated a dedicated fund for reconstruction and recovery 5) How was the reconstruction and recovery fund mobilized? 6) Have a provision of cash distribution and in-kind support	1) What roles DDMC plays in fund mobilization for recovery and reconstruction processes of affected private households? 2) What are your opinions on ongoing fund mobilization and joint contribution processes for recovery and reconstruction processes of affected private households? 3) Do DDMC have a fund disbursement mechanism? 4) In upcoming days, what roles should DDMC/DAO play to have a good impact on recovery and reconstruction processes?	1) Palika has both a dedicated fund (Bipad kosh) and annual budget allocations on DRRM. 2) Fund mobilization guideline developed by Palika? 3) Local government have allocated a dedicated fund for reconstruction and recovery. 4) Municipal government have a provision of cash distribution and in-kind support. 5) Allocated budget on DRRM 0.5% of total budget or more 6) What type of DRRM program/ initiatives is implemented by the municipal government
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Annex 8.5.2: Supporting Documentation regarding Status of Policy, Structures, Operations and Fund (Province)

Table 10: Status of Existing DRRM Policy at Provincial Level (February 2023)			
DRRM Document (Benchmark)	Bagmati Province	Gandaki	Lumbini
DRRM Act	Yes	No	No
DRR Regulation	No	Yes	No
DRRM Policy	Yes	No	No
Strategic Action Plan	Yes	Yes	Yes
Relief Standard	No	No	Yes
Fund Mobilization Procedure	Yes	Yes	Yes
Recovery and Reconstruction	No	No	No
Rescue and Relief Distribution	No	No	Yes
Provincial disaster response plan	No	No	No
Disaster Risk Insurance Procedure	No	No	No

Table 11: Status of Structures at Provincial Level (February 2023)

Benchmarks – Structures	Bagmati	Gandaki	Lumbini
Availability of Local Level Disaster Management Committee (LDMC) at Palika	Yes	Yes	Yes
Gender, Disability and Social Inclusion (GEDSI) Integration	No	No	No
Availability of Provincial Emergency Operating Center (PEOC)	Yes	Yes	Yes
PEOC linked with DEOC, LEOC, and BIPAD Portal	Yes	Yes	Yes
Availability of an emergency warehouse	Yes	Yes	Yes
Availability of an emergency warehouse management guideline	Yes	Yes	Yes
Provision of DRR volunteers at Provincial government	Yes	No	No
Provision of volunteer's mobilization guidelines	No	No	No
Allocated budget for DRR volunteer mobilization	Yes	No	No

Table 12: Status of Operation, Coordination and Collaboration at Provincial Level (February 2023)

Benchmarks – Operation, Coordination and	Bagmati	Gandaki	Lumbini
Coordination and collaboration of Provincial government with DDMC and LDMC and National level for implementation of disaster preparedness activities	Yes	Yes	Yes
Coordination and collaboration of Provincial government with DDMC and LDMC and National level for implementation of disaster Response activities	Yes	Yes	Yes
Provincial government coordination and collaboration with DDMC, LDMC, and the federal government reconstruction and recovery	Yes	Yes	Yes
Disaster preparedness activities implemented	Yes	Yes	Yes
Reconstruction and recovery activities implemented	Yes	Yes	Yes
Establish Separate unit for recovery and reconstruction	No	No	No

Table 13: Status of Funding at Provincial Level (February 2023)

Benchmarks – Funding	Bagmati	Gandaki	Lumbini
Provincial government have both a dedicated fund (bipad kosh) and annual budget allocations on DRRM	yes	yes	yes
Fund mobilization guideline developed	yes	Yes	yes
Have allocated a dedicated fund for reconstruction and	yes	yes	Yes
Have a provision for cash distribution and in-kind support	No	No	No

Annex 8.5.3: Supporting Documentation regarding Status of Policy, Structures, Operations and Fund (Local Level)

Table 14: Status of Existing DRRM Policy at Local Level (February 2023)

Benchmarks – Policy	Municipal ity	Rural Municipal ity	Sub Metropolit an	Metropolit an
Awareness of DRRM Acts, Regulations, Standards (By-laws) developed at National	100%	80%	100%	100%
Development of DRRM By-laws by Palika	75%	38%	50%	100%
Local disaster preparedness and response planning endorsed and implemented by local	50%	50%	100%	100%
Local disaster preparedness and response plan mainstreamed into and annual	25%	13%	0%	0%
Availability of human resources to develop DRRM by-laws	0%	0%	50%	100%
Enough technical and financial resources for development of DRRM By-laws	25%	0%	0%	0%

Table 15: Status of Structures at Local Level (February 2023)

Benchmarks – Structures	Municipal ity	Rural Municipal ity	Sub Metropolit an	Metropolit an
Availability of LDMC at Palika	100%	100%	100%	100%
GEDSI Integration into LDMC	50%	25%	50%	100%
Availability of a special wing to look after reconstruction and recovery of disaster affected households	25%	25%	50%	0%
Availability of WDMC at Palika	25%	13%	50%	0%
A dedicated committee/unit/wing at the local level for disaster response	100%	100%	100%	100%
Availability of LEOC	75%	0%	100%	100%
Availability of an emergency warehouse	75%	25%	50%	100%
Stockpiling of emergency equipment, search and rescue materials, WASH Kit, NFI Kit,	75%	25%	50%	100%
Availability of an emergency warehouse management guideline or SOP	50%	0%	0%	100%
Provision of DRR volunteers at municipal government	25%	0%	50%	0%
DRR volunteers adequately trained for disaster response	25%	0%	50%	0%
DRR Volunteers equipped with necessary search and rescue and emergency equipment	0%	0%	50%	0%

Table 16: Status of Operation, Coordination and Collaboration at Local Level (February 2023)

Benchmarks – Operation, Coordination and Collaboration	Municipal ity	Rural Municipal ity	Sub Metropolit an	Metropolit an
Municipal government/LDMC coordination and collaboration with DDMC/Chief Administrative Officer (CAO) and the Province Government for disaster response	75%	100%	100%	100%
Local government coordination and collaboration with DDMC, Province Government and the federal government	75%	100%	100%	100%
Sufficient technical human resources for reconstruction and recovery activities at Palika	0%	0%	0%	0%
Human resources trained on the process of reconstruction and recovery	25%	13%	0%	0%
Disaster preparedness activities implemented by Palika	50%	0%	50%	100%
Reconstruction and recovery activities implemented by Palika	75%	100%	100%	100%

Table 17: Status of Funding at Local Level (February 2023)

Benchmarks – Funds	Municipal ity	Rural Municipal ity	Sub Metropolit an	Metropolit an
Palika has both a dedicated fund (Bipad kosh) and annual budget allocations from the local government	50%	100%	100%	100%
Fund mobilization guideline developed by Palika	75%	100%	100%	100%
Local government have allocated a dedicated fund for reconstruction and recovery	50%	50%	100%	100%
Municipal government have a provision of cash distribution and in-kind support	100%	100%	100%	100%

Allocated budget on DRRM 0.5% of total budget or more	50%	63%	100%	0%
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8.6 Annexes Supporting RQ4

Annex 8.6.1 - V9 RQ4 bullets for internal reference to support crafting RQ4 Discussion Section

- The Constitution of Nepal and DRRM Act, 2017 has clearly assigned most of DRM roles to municipalities. So federal and provincial governments should focus on strengthening DRM capacity of local governments. Fund mobilization (grant distribution) should be provided to the municipal government rather than to DAO in order to simplify and effectively implement the reconstruction process and on time.
- In the context of exacerbating climate change impacts, DRM mainstreaming should be prioritized by Federal, Provincial and local governments.
- There are existing issues, gaps, and challenges on accessing the resources needed for reconstruction.
- Relief and response actions at the local level are duplicated. This should be avoided by delineation of roles.
- DRM actions lack alignment between local government and also between district and province. Similarly, there is also a lack of connection between MOHA and NDRRMA. There are no proper response mechanisms on other types of disasters especially the monsoon oriented. The necessary alignment should be mentioned in the policy.
- Lack of fund mobilization guidelines at local level to track the funds received by local level for response and recovery. The federal policies somehow exist; however, such policies are not translated into action at the local level and in fact, there is weak implementation at local level.
- There is a lack of mechanisms at local and district level that mentions prioritization to the vulnerable and marginalized people during preparedness as well as in post disaster situations.
- At local level mechanisms, there is missing part of SWOT analysis in the 9-points indicators of localization. Local levels show inadequate management in capacity enhancement and are hesitant to use their own resources. Rather the local government tends to depend on and execute only if external sources like funds from development partners are available.
- Local levels should be capacitated enough to utilize their own resources to respond to minor level of response initiatives so that in large scale disasters partners are prepositioned always to support local levels. Therefore, the fact of building its own capacity at the local level and its ownership should come forward.
- There is a need for policy and at least a local level directive that mentions prioritization of vulnerable people. Pre-identification of vulnerable people is needed which is the prerequisite in effectiveness of anticipatory actions and also in early actions too.
- In several parts of monsoon affected areas of low-lying areas in Bardiya, disaster affected houses were rebuilt from an owner driven approach for which advocacy from beneficiaries' level were triggered with local levels.
- There should be mechanisms and measures mentioned in DRR Act from the government on jurisdictions of local levels (Palikas) that all for partners is done from local levels only in the case of capacity is lacking at Palikas.

- At the operations level of local levels and district levels, there should be a sound DRM structure that has proper mechanisms to withstand the disasters. Partner organizations should have enough understanding on the DRM structure of the local level where interventions are targeted. Such as- presence of task force committees, LDMC, DDMC etc.....Similarly, the task force members & committees should have clear understanding on the roles and responsibilities that they have to undertake.
- There should be PDNA done from the local level to undertake recovery programs. *Palikas* should do PDNA either with partner organizations or request NDRRMA to take lead in conducting that.
- Policies and Acts are made from federal level, while there is less and ineffective implementation at local level. This ineffectiveness should be viewed from two aspects. 1st as – formulating Plans and Acts and 2nd as- how to implement it.
- Civil society or partner organizations should look into SWOT analysis of the local level where programs are targeted to implement so that proper implementation can be done, proper way out can be formalized as well as the exit mechanisms, sustainability measures tracking etc.
- While considering interventions for people with disabilities (PWDs), the fact of whether they have accessed the free houses for them from governments or from partners/ or the accessible house for them (with presence of accessibility features). The consideration and inclusion of accessibility features for PWD calls for an integrated recovery mechanism.
- The DRM structures at local levels should be well defined with their capacity to address various sorts of disasters. This calls for mainstreaming of the reconstruction or construction mechanisms which can be done through sensitizing the local masons for making disaster resilient structures and engaging the traders for selling of efficient construction materials to make disaster resilient structures. #diffusion of knowledge and capacity.
- DRR fund mobilization is mainly limited to the response and relief process. The newly elected local bodies have limited knowledge. This signifies that capacities and knowledge gained by previous elected officials have not been transferred. There is a lack of institutionalization in transfer of knowledge and capacities.
- The DRR Act and several other relevant policies mentions that local bodies not only have to work on response features only, but also have to spend the investment and resources on preparedness too. But the slow impact of policies at local levels signifies that those local capacities are still inadequate.
- The grievances and caseloads of disaster affected people are missing and not addressed yet particularly those during the cases of national level priorities (November national level elections etc.), therefore the proper measures should be there to address such insignificance too.
- There are gaps in policy implementation and at practice level. We need to address the bottlenecks. Policy has not obstructed anywhere for supporting the people. The obstruction lies at the bureaucratic process of implementing the programs.
- NDRRMA owns the authority to mobilize the DRM fund to all 77 districts which need to be mainstreamed properly and should be backstopped by policies and this is the area where interested partners can intervene.

- The government's support of 3 lakhs, 4 lakhs and 5 lakhs are not sufficient always and there are loopholes in this support in the sense that people intend to access the government fund without realizing the importance of resilient structures.
- The government mechanisms should be focused on reducing disaster risk rather than always responding in the first place. For this, the capacity building of different levels of governments is needed. For e.g. at local level, available trained masons, contractors, volunteers. The trained masons from NRA times should be tracked and mobilized when needed.
- There are several learnings and best practices to carry on from partner's level. The funding mechanisms of partners and donors are evolving through changes in the priority.

8.7 Annexes Supporting Recommendations

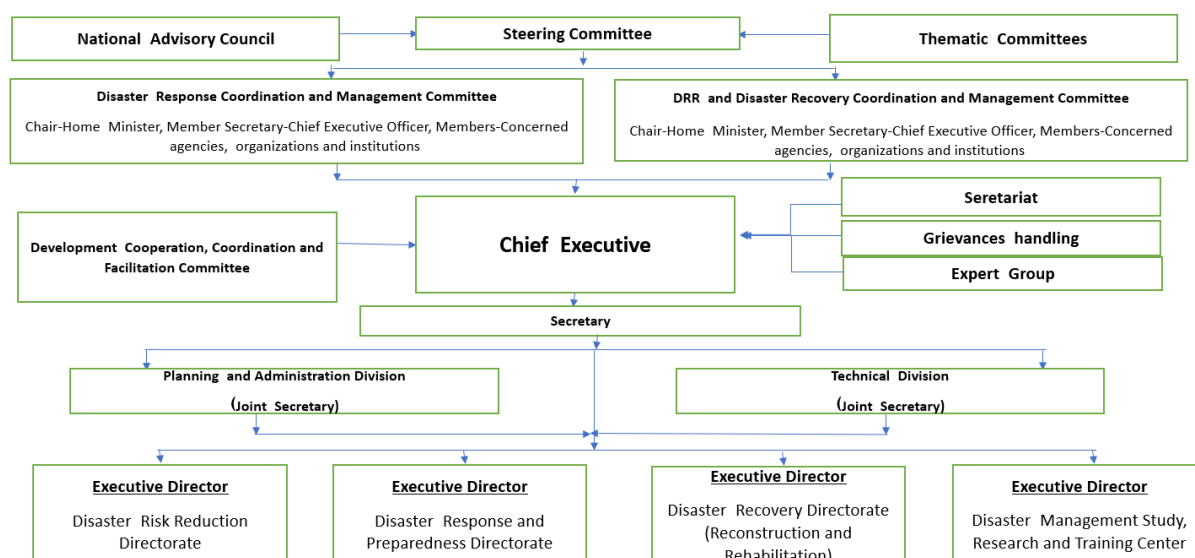


Figure 5: Proposed restructure of NDRRMA



Nepal Government
Ministry of Home Affairs
National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority
Singhadurbar, Kathmandu